



RKDF UNIVERSITY, BHOPAL

Open Distance Learning Program

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.)

Fourth Semester

Course – B.A. History

Course	Category	Subject	Subject Code
B.A.	Minor	NATIONALISM IN INDIA	BA HS -402
Total Credit: 6		Max.Marks:100 (Internal:40+External:60)	

Course Outcomes (CO):

After completing this course student will be able to:

CO1:-Students will acquire knowledge regarding the primitive life and cultural status of the people of India.

They can gather knowledge about the society, culture, religion and political history of India. They will also acquire the Knowledge of changing socio-cultural scenarios of India.

CO2:-studying this paper, students will get to know the golden past of India and feel proud of them selve.

Units	Topic	Duration (In Hours)	Marks
I	First War of independence : I. causes II. Impact III. Nature	18	20
II	Factor leading to the growth of Nationalism in India : I. Indian national congress II. Dada Bhai Naurozi III. Firozshah Mehta VI. Lokmany Tilak	18	20
III	Early phase : I. The ideology, Programme and Policy of Moderates II. Formation of the Muslim League III. Partition of Bengal.	18	20
IV	Extremist phase : I. Rise and Development of extremist in India II. Swadeshi Movement. III. Congress split in Surat IV. congress unification and Muslim League pact	18	20
V	National awakening during First World War : I. Home rule Movement. II. Revolutionary Movement. III Chandra Shekhar Azad, Bhagat Singh. IV Subhas Chandra Bos and Azad hind fauj.	18	20

Part- C Learning Resource

Text Books, Reference Books, Other Resources

Suggested Readings:

1. Majumdar, R.C. The History and Culture of Indian People Vol. 1. Vedic Age, Bhartiya Vidya Bhavan, Bombay, 1954
2. Majumdar, R.C.. The History and Culture of Indian People Vol. II. The Age of Imperial Unity, Bhartiya Vidya Bhavan, Bombay, 1954
3. Majumdar, R.C. The History and Culture of Indian People, Vol III. The Classical Age. Bhartiya Vidya Bhavan, Bombay, 1954 \
4. Majumdar R.C. The History of Indian People, Vol IV, The Age Imperial Kanauj. Bhartiya Vidya Bhavan, Bombay, 1954
5. Majumdar R.C. The History of Indian People, vol. V. The Struggle for Empire, Bhartiya Vidya Bhavan, Bombay, 1954
6. Jayaswal, Vidula: Bhartiya Itihas Ke Adi Chara ki Rooprekha, Delhi, 1987
7. Pandey, Rajbali: Prachin Bharat, Vishwavidyalaya Prakashan, Varanasi, 2010.
8. Raychaudhary, H.C. Political History of Ancient India) 1996. Also, in Hindi.
9. Sankalia, HD. Prehistory and Prohistory of India and Pakistan, Poona 1974
10. Sastri, K.A Nilakanta: A History of South India, from Prehistoric Times to the fall of Vijayanagar, Oxford University Press, 1955; Also, in Hindi.
11. Singh, Kripa Shankar: Rigveda, Harrappa Sabhiyata and Sanskrit Nirantana, Kitab Ghar publication, New Delhi, 2007.
12. Singh, Upinder: A history of Ancient and Early Medieval India, 2008, Pearson India, New Delhi, Hindi
13. Thapar, Romila: Early India from the Beginnings to 1300, London, 2002.
14. Tripathi R. S.: History of Ancient India, Motilal Banarasidas, Delhi. Also in Hindi
15. Suggested Readings:
16. 1. National Missionary Society of India Archives, Chennai – 600014, India. “Correspondence and files of The National Missionary Society of India”.
17. 2. Forrester Paton, Ernest. The Govt. of India’s Attitude Towards Indian National Movement, A Case Study: (Church History Association of India: Kerala, 1985).
18. 3. Paul, K.T., The British Connection With India: (SCM, London, 1927, reprinted Anmol Publications, Delhi, 1986).
19. 4. The National Missionary Society of India – Annual Sale 2000 – Tambaram Souvenir, NMSI, Chennai, 2000.
20. 5. Lawey, Bashir, NMSI Missionary and S/O Tahir Masih, Personal Interview, New Delhi, 1st December, 2004.
21. 6. Samue. G. History of Tranquebar Mission: AD 1706-1955 : (Tranquebar Printing and Publishing House, Madras, 1955).
22. 7. Sen, S.P. Ed. Social and Religious Reform Movements in the Nineteenth and Twentieth Centuries: (Institute of Historical Studies, Calcutta, 1979).
23. 8. Pal Chandra Bipin India’s struggle for Independence.
24. .Pal Chandra Bipin History of Modern India . 10. Sarkar Sumit Modern India 1885-1947
25. National Missionary Society of India Archives, Chennai – 600014, India. “Correspondence and files of The National Missionary Society of India”.
26. Forrester Paton, Ernest. The Govt. of India’s Attitude Towards Indian National Movement, A Case Study: (Church History Association of India: Kerala, 1985).
27. Paul, K.T., The British Connection With India: (SCM, London, 1927, reprinted Anmol Publications, Delhi, 1986).
28. The National Missionary Society of India – Annual Sale 2000 – Tambaram Souvenir, NMSI, Chennai, 2000.
29. Lawey, Bashir, NMSI Missionary and S/O Tahir Masih, Personal Interview, New Delhi, 1st December, 2004.
30. Samue. G. History of Tranquebar Mission: AD 1706-1955 : (Tranquebar Printing and Publishing House, Madras, 1955).
31. Sen, S.P. Ed. Social and Religious Reform Movements in the Nineteenth and Twentieth Centuries: (Institute of

- Historical Studies, Calcutta, 1979). 8. Pal Chandra Bipin India's struggle for Independence.
32. Pal Chandra Bipin History of Modern India .
33. Sarkar Sumit Modern India 1885-1947.

Suggested Equivalent On line Courses:

1. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/culture_of_India
2. <https://xaviers.edu/main/index.php/ancient-Indian-culture>
3. <https://vidyaonline.org/dl/cutddk.pdf>
4. <https://www.livescience.com/28638-indian-culture.html>
5. <https://www.india-in-your-home.comt-India-Culture.html>
6. <https://www.indianculture.gov.in/rarebooks/ancient-indian-historical-tradition>
7. <https://www.culturalindia.net/indian-history/ancient-india/index.html>

Suggestive digital platforms web links:

1. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/History_of_India
2. <https://knowindia.gov.in/culture-and-heritage/ancient-history.php>
3. <https://www.history.com/tag/india>
4. <https://byjus.com/free-ias-prep/ncert-ancient-history-notes/>
5. <https://www.clearias.com/indian-history-chronology/>
6. <https://www.jagranjosh.com/general-knowledge/history-of-ancient-india-a-complete-study-material-1464928278-1>
7. <https://sourcebooks.fordham.edu/india/indiasbook.asp>
8. <https://www.worldhistory.org/india/>
9. <https://asiasociety.org/india-historical-overview>

Bibliography

Ahmad, Manazir. *Sultan Firoz Shah Tughlaq, 1351-1388 A.D.* Chugh Publications, 1978

Ashrafi, Anjum. *The Khilji and Tughlaq dynasties.* Shree Publishers, New Delhi, 2022

Husain, Agha M. . *Tughlaq dynasty.* Spink, Calcutta, 1963

Khan, Ahmad N. *Islamic architecture in South Asia: Pakistan, India, Bangladesh.* Oxford University Press, Karachi, 2003

Majumdar, R. C., ed. . *The Delhi Sultanate (1300-1526 AD).* vol 6. . Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Bombay, 1989

Mishra, Patit P. . " "Delhi Sultanate"." *Berkshire Encyclopedia of World History.* vol. 2. , edited by William H. McNeill, ed. Berkshire Publishing Group, Great Barrington, Massachusetts, 2005, 506-7.

[Ramprakash Mathur. *Medieval Indian History.* Murari Lal & Sons, 1970.](#)

Rani, Abha. *Tughlaq Architecture of Delhi.* Bharati Prakashan, Varanasi, 1991

[Ray, Aniruddha. *The Sultanate of Delhi .* Routledge, 2019.](#)

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1. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/culture_of_India
2. <https://xaviers.edu/main/index.php/ancient-Indian-culture>
3. <https://vidyaonline.org/dl/cutddk.pdf>
4. <https://www.livescience.com/28638-indian-culture.html>
5. <https://www.india-in-your-home.comt-India-Culture.html>
6. <https://www.indianculture.gov.in/rarebooks/ancient-indian-historical-tradition>
7. <https://www.culturalindia.net/indian-history/ancient-india/index.html>

Unit 1-

First War of independence :

I. causes

II. Impact

III. Nature

The First War of Independence

The First War of Independence, also known as the Indian Rebellion of 1857 or the Sepoy Mutiny, was a significant uprising against British colonial rule in India. It marked a pivotal moment in Indian history and had far-reaching consequences for the country's struggle for independence. Here's an overview of the nature, causes, events, results, and impact of the First War of Independence:

Nature:

Nature of the First War of Independence, also known as the Indian Rebellion of 1857 or the Sepoy Mutiny, was multifaceted and complex, reflecting a convergence of political, economic, social, cultural, and military factors. Understanding the nature of the rebellion provides insight into its origins, motivations, and significance in Indian history. Here are some key aspects of the nature of the First War of Independence:

1. Resistance to British Colonial Rule:

- At its core, the rebellion was a widespread and coordinated uprising against British colonial rule in India. It represented a collective response to decades of British economic exploitation, political subjugation, and cultural imposition.
- Indian society, comprising diverse communities and regions, rose up in revolt against perceived injustices and grievances inflicted by British colonial policies.

2. Nationalist Sentiments:

- The rebellion was fueled by a burgeoning sense of nationalism and patriotism among Indian communities. It marked a significant shift from localized opposition to British rule to a broader sense of Indian identity and solidarity.
- Participants in the rebellion saw themselves as defenders of Indian sovereignty and cultural heritage against foreign domination.

3. Sepoy Mutiny and Civil Uprising:

- The uprising initially began as a mutiny among Indian sepoys (soldiers) of the British East India Company's army, triggered by the introduction of the Enfield rifle cartridges greased with animal fat.

- However, the rebellion quickly spread beyond the military to encompass a broader civil uprising involving peasants, landlords, intellectuals, and religious leaders across different regions of India.
- 4. Social and Religious Factors:**
- Social and religious factors played a significant role in shaping the nature of the rebellion. Grievances related to land revenue policies, heavy taxation, and economic exploitation contributed to widespread discontent among Indian peasants and landlords.
 - Religious sensitivities were inflamed by British policies perceived as disrespectful or threatening to traditional Indian customs and beliefs. The issue of the Enfield rifle cartridges, with their alleged use of animal fat, deeply offended Hindu and Muslim sepoys.
- 5. Leadership and Coordination:**
- While the rebellion lacked centralized leadership or coordination, local leaders, including zamindars (landlords), taluqdars, and princes, emerged to provide direction and mobilize support for the uprising in different regions.
 - Despite diverse interests and agendas, these leaders rallied around the common goal of expelling British rule from India and restoring indigenous authority.
- 6. Brutal Repression and Consequences:**
- The nature of the British response to the rebellion was marked by brutal repression, widespread atrocities, and indiscriminate reprisals against Indian civilians.
 - Following the suppression of the rebellion, the British East India Company's rule over India was formally ended, and India came under direct British Crown rule (British Raj) in 1858.

In summary, the nature of the First War of Independence encompassed a complex interplay of resistance, nationalism, social grievances, and religious sensitivities. It represented a watershed moment in Indian history, marking the beginning of a concerted struggle against British colonialism and laying the groundwork for India's eventual independence.

- The First War of Independence was a widespread and coordinated revolt that involved various groups across India, including sepoys (Indian soldiers serving in the British East India Company's army), princely states, peasants, landlords, and intellectuals.
- It was characterized by a combination of political, economic, social, and cultural grievances against British colonial rule, as well as a spirit of nationalism and resistance.

Causes:

The First War of Independence, also known as the Indian Rebellion of 1857 or the Sepoy Mutiny, was a significant uprising against British colonial rule in India. The causes of the rebellion were multifaceted and rooted in various political, economic, social, cultural, and

military grievances. Understanding these causes provides insight into the underlying factors that fuelled the rebellion. Here are some key causes of the First War of Independence:

1. Political Grievances:

- British political control and domination over India were resented by many Indians, who saw British rule as oppressive and exploitative. The annexation of Indian princely states, the imposition of British law, and the suppression of Indian political institutions eroded traditional systems of governance and autonomy.

2. Economic Exploitation:

- British economic policies, including land revenue systems, taxation, and trade regulations, imposed heavy burdens on Indian peasants, artisans, and merchants. Land revenue demands often led to impoverishment and debt bondage, exacerbating rural discontent.
- The British East India Company's monopoly over trade and commerce limited economic opportunities for Indians and undermined indigenous industries and livelihoods.

3. Social Injustice:

- The rigid caste system and social hierarchies prevalent in Indian society were perpetuated and reinforced by British colonial policies. Discrimination, marginalization, and social inequalities were exacerbated under British rule, leading to resentment among lower-caste communities and marginalized groups.

4. Religious Offenses:

- British actions perceived as disrespectful or threatening to religious sensibilities contributed to widespread outrage and anger among Indian communities. The issue of the Enfield rifle cartridges greased with animal fat, which offended Hindu and Muslim sepoys' religious beliefs, served as a catalyst for the rebellion.

5. Military Grievances:

- The Indian sepoys (soldiers) of the British East India Company's army were deeply discontented due to various grievances, including low pay, poor working conditions, lack of career advancement opportunities, and discriminatory treatment compared to British soldiers.
- The introduction of the Enfield rifle cartridges, which required biting off the tips greased with animal fat, sparked widespread rumors and fears among sepoys about British intentions to undermine their religious beliefs and forcibly convert them to Christianity.

6. Resentment against Foreign Rule:

- The imposition of British colonial rule over India was seen as a violation of Indian sovereignty and cultural identity. Indians resented foreign domination and yearned for self-rule and independence, fueling nationalist sentiments and aspirations for freedom.

7. Preceding Revolts and Unrest:

- The First War of Independence was preceded by various localized revolts, uprisings, and acts of resistance against British rule in different parts of India. These incidents, along with simmering discontent and grievances, contributed to the build-up of tension and unrest across the country.

In summary, the causes of the First War of Independence were deeply rooted in the political, economic, social, religious, and military dimensions of British colonial rule in India. The rebellion represented a collective response to decades of exploitation, oppression, and injustice, as well as a broader aspiration for freedom, dignity, and self-determination.

- The causes of the rebellion were multifaceted and included resentment towards British economic policies, such as land revenue reforms and the imposition of heavy taxes.
- Cultural and religious factors, such as the perceived threat to Indian customs and traditions, also fueled discontent among Indian communities.
- The introduction of the Enfield rifle, which required soldiers to bite off the tips of cartridges greased with animal fat (cow and pig fat), offended the religious sensibilities of Hindu and Muslim sepoys, leading to widespread outrage and mutinies.

Events:

The events of the First War of Independence, also known as the Indian Rebellion of 1857 or the Sepoy Mutiny, unfolded over a span of several months and involved a series of significant battles, sieges, and uprisings across various regions of India. These events were characterized by widespread resistance against British colonial rule and marked a pivotal moment in Indian history. Here are some key events of the First War of Independence:

1. May 10, 1857 - Sepoy Mutiny in Meerut:

- The rebellion began on May 10, 1857, in Meerut, when Indian sepoys of the British East India Company's army refused to use the newly introduced Enfield rifle cartridges.
- The sepoys were subsequently court-martialed and sentenced to severe punishments, sparking widespread anger and mutinies among Indian soldiers.

2. Spread of Rebellion:

- The mutiny in Meerut quickly spread to other parts of North India, including Delhi, Lucknow, Kanpur, Jhansi, Bareilly, and Allahabad.
- Indian soldiers, civilians, and local leaders joined the rebellion, leading to widespread uprisings against British authorities and symbols of colonial power.

3. Siege of Delhi:

- In May 1857, Indian rebels besieged Delhi, the capital of British India, and expelled British officials and soldiers from the city.

- Delhi became a focal point of resistance, with the last Mughal emperor, Bahadur Shah II, symbolically proclaimed as the leader of the rebellion.
4. **Siege of Lucknow:**
 - Lucknow, the capital of the Indian state of Oudh (Awadh), witnessed a prolonged siege and intense fighting between Indian rebels and British forces.
 - The British Residency in Lucknow, under the leadership of Sir Henry Lawrence and later Sir Henry Havelock and Sir Colin Campbell, endured a siege for several months before being relieved by British reinforcements.
 5. **Siege of Cawnpore (Kanpur):**
 - Cawnpore (Kanpur) witnessed one of the most infamous incidents of the rebellion, known as the Massacre of Cawnpore.
 - British men, women, and children, who had sought refuge in the besieged British garrison, were killed by Indian rebels led by Nana Sahib after an agreement to surrender went awry.
 6. **Battles and Uprisings:**
 - Several battles and uprisings took place across different regions of India, including the Battle of Badli-ki-Serai, Battle of Agra, Battle of Jhansi, Siege of Arrah, and Siege of Bareilly, among others.
 - Indian rebels, comprising sepoys, peasants, zamindars (landlords), and local leaders, engaged in guerrilla warfare and skirmishes against British forces.
 7. **British Suppression and Reprisals:**
 - The British response to the rebellion was marked by brutal repression, indiscriminate reprisals, and punitive measures against Indian rebels and civilians.
 - British forces, under the command of generals such as Sir Hugh Rose, Sir Colin Campbell, and Sir John Lawrence, launched counteroffensives to suppress the rebellion and regain control of rebel-held territories.
 8. **End of the Rebellion:**
 - Despite initial successes and widespread support, the rebellion ultimately faltered due to internal divisions, lack of coordination, and superior British firepower and military tactics.
 - The rebellion was gradually suppressed by British forces, and by mid-1858, most of the major centers of rebellion had been recaptured and brought under British control.

In summary, the events of the First War of Independence constituted a protracted and bloody struggle between Indian rebels and British colonial authorities, with significant battles, sieges, and uprisings occurring across different regions of India. The rebellion had far-reaching consequences for India's future trajectory and the broader struggle against British colonial rule.

- The rebellion began in Meerut on May 10, 1857, when Indian sepoys refused to use the new cartridges and were subsequently punished by the British authorities.

- The uprising quickly spread to other parts of North India, including Delhi, Lucknow, Kanpur, and Jhansi, as well as to regions in Central and Eastern India.
- Several key battles and sieges took place during the rebellion, including the Siege of Delhi, the Siege of Lucknow, and the Siege of Cawnpore (Kanpur).
- Despite initial successes, the rebellion was ultimately suppressed by British forces through a combination of military strength, brutal reprisals, and divide-and-rule tactics.

Results and Impact:

The First War of Independence, also known as the Indian Rebellion of 1857 or the Sepoy Mutiny, had significant consequences and outcomes that shaped the course of Indian history and British colonial rule. While the rebellion ultimately failed to overthrow British rule in India, it had far-reaching implications for both India and the British Empire. Here are some of the key results of the First War of Independence:

1. End of the East India Company's Rule:

- One of the immediate outcomes of the rebellion was the formal end of the British East India Company's rule over India. The British government passed the Government of India Act 1858, transferring the administration of India from the East India Company to the British Crown.
- India came under direct British Crown rule, known as the British Raj, with the British government assuming direct responsibility for governing India.

2. Reforms and Policy Changes:

- The British government introduced several administrative, political, and military reforms in response to the rebellion. These reforms aimed to address some of the grievances that had contributed to the uprising and to prevent future unrest.
- Reforms included the abolition of the East India Company, the reorganization of the Indian administration, and the appointment of a Viceroy and Secretary of State for India to oversee British rule.

3. Punitive Measures and Retribution:

- The British response to the rebellion was marked by brutal reprisals, punitive measures, and widespread violence against Indian rebels and civilians.
- British forces carried out summary executions, mass hangings, and other forms of punishment against perceived instigators and participants of the rebellion.

4. Reassertion of British Control:

- The rebellion resulted in the reassertion of British control and dominance over India. British forces regained control of rebel-held territories, suppressed remaining pockets of resistance, and strengthened colonial rule.
- The British implemented a policy of divide and rule, exploiting divisions among Indian communities and employing strategies to prevent future uprisings.

5. Impact on Indian Society and Politics:

- The rebellion had a profound impact on Indian society and politics, fueling nationalist sentiments, and fostering a sense of collective identity and resistance against British colonialism.
- It laid the groundwork for future movements for independence and self-rule, inspiring subsequent generations of Indian nationalists and freedom fighters.

6. Legacy and Memory:

- The First War of Independence left a lasting legacy in Indian memory as a symbol of resistance against colonial oppression and exploitation. It is commemorated annually in India as a day of remembrance and homage to the sacrifices made by those who participated in the rebellion.
- The rebellion served as a rallying point for the Indian nationalist movement and contributed to the broader struggle for independence, which ultimately led to India's liberation from British rule in 1947.

In summary, while the First War of Independence did not achieve its immediate goal of overthrowing British rule, it had profound and far-reaching consequences for India's future trajectory and the struggle for independence. It marked a turning point in Indian history and served as a catalyst for the broader movement against British colonialism in India.

The First War of Independence, also known as the Indian Rebellion of 1857 or the Sepoy Mutiny, had a profound impact on India, shaping its society, politics, and trajectory towards independence. The rebellion represented a watershed moment in Indian history and had far-reaching consequences for the country. Here are some of the key impacts of the First War of Independence on India:

1. Nationalist Awakening:

- The rebellion ignited nationalist sentiments and fostered a sense of collective identity and pride among Indians. It served as a wake-up call for Indians to unite against British colonial rule and assert their rights and dignity.
- The uprising inspired subsequent generations of Indian nationalists and freedom fighters to continue the struggle for independence and self-rule.

2. Resurgence of Indian Pride and Identity:

- The rebellion challenged the perception of Indian inferiority and subjugation under British rule. It demonstrated the resilience, courage, and determination of Indians to resist foreign domination and assert their cultural and national identity.
- Indians celebrated the heroes and martyrs of the rebellion, turning them into symbols of resistance and inspiration for future generations.

3. Impact on Social and Religious Reform:

- The rebellion exposed the injustices and inequalities perpetuated by British colonial rule, including social and religious discrimination.

- It fueled social reform movements aimed at addressing caste-based discrimination, promoting religious harmony, and advocating for social justice and equality.
- 4. Legacy of Resistance:**
- The rebellion left a lasting legacy of resistance against colonial oppression and exploitation. It inspired subsequent acts of defiance and rebellion against British rule, including peasant uprisings, labor strikes, and civil disobedience movements.
 - The memory of the rebellion served as a rallying point for future movements for independence, contributing to the broader struggle against British colonialism in India.
- 5. Changes in British Colonial Policy:**
- The British government implemented administrative and military reforms in response to the rebellion, aiming to prevent future unrest and consolidate British control over India.
 - Reforms included the abolition of the British East India Company, the reorganization of the Indian administration, and the introduction of policies aimed at addressing Indian grievances.
- 6. Impact on British Imperialism:**
- The rebellion exposed the vulnerabilities of British colonial rule and highlighted the challenges of governing a vast and diverse empire like India.
 - It prompted British authorities to adopt a more cautious and repressive approach towards Indian dissent, leading to increased surveillance, censorship, and repression of nationalist activities.
- 7. Long-term Consequences for Indian Independence:**
- While the rebellion was ultimately suppressed by British forces, its legacy endured and contributed to the broader movement for Indian independence.
 - The uprising laid the groundwork for future nationalist movements, culminating in India's eventual liberation from British rule in 1947.

In summary, the First War of Independence had a profound and enduring impact on India, shaping its nationalist consciousness, social dynamics, and struggle for independence. It served as a catalyst for change and laid the foundation for the eventual emergence of an independent India.

- The British East India Company's rule over India was formally ended following the rebellion, and India came under direct British Crown rule (British Raj) in 1858.
- The British government launched extensive reforms in response to the rebellion, including the abolition of the East India Company, the reorganization of the Indian administration, and the introduction of policies aimed at appeasing Indian grievances.
- The rebellion had a profound impact on Indian society and politics, leading to the emergence of nationalist sentiments and the demand for self-rule and independence.

- It also highlighted the need for unity among different Indian communities and laid the groundwork for future movements against British colonialism, such as the Indian National Congress and the struggle for independence led by Mahatma Gandhi.

Legacy:

- The First War of Independence left a lasting legacy in Indian memory as a symbol of resistance against colonial oppression and exploitation.
- It inspired subsequent generations of freedom fighters and nationalists to continue the struggle for independence, ultimately leading to India's liberation from British rule in 1947.
- The rebellion also highlighted the importance of unity, courage, and sacrifice in the pursuit of freedom and justice, serving as a source of inspiration for movements for social justice and human rights around the world.

Overall, the First War of Independence was a watershed moment in Indian history, marking the beginning of the end of British colonial rule and laying the foundation for India's emergence as an independent nation.

First War of independence, Nature

The nature of the First War of Independence, also known as the Indian Rebellion of 1857 or the Sepoy Mutiny, was multifaceted and complex, reflecting a convergence of political, economic, social, cultural, and military factors. Understanding the nature of the rebellion provides insight into its origins, motivations, and significance in Indian history. Here are some key aspects of the nature of the First War of Independence:

1. Resistance to British Colonial Rule:

- At its core, the rebellion was a widespread and coordinated uprising against British colonial rule in India. It represented a collective response to decades of British economic exploitation, political subjugation, and cultural imposition.
- Indian society, comprising diverse communities and regions, rose up in revolt against perceived injustices and grievances inflicted by British colonial policies.

2. Nationalist Sentiments:

- The rebellion was fueled by a burgeoning sense of nationalism and patriotism among Indian communities. It marked a significant shift from localized opposition to British rule to a broader sense of Indian identity and solidarity.
- Participants in the rebellion saw themselves as defenders of Indian sovereignty and cultural heritage against foreign domination.

3. Sepoy Mutiny and Civil Uprising:

- The uprising initially began as a mutiny among Indian sepoys (soldiers) of the British East India Company's army, triggered by the introduction of the Enfield rifle cartridges greased with animal fat.
 - However, the rebellion quickly spread beyond the military to encompass a broader civil uprising involving peasants, landlords, intellectuals, and religious leaders across different regions of India.
- 4. Social and Religious Factors:**
- Social and religious factors played a significant role in shaping the nature of the rebellion. Grievances related to land revenue policies, heavy taxation, and economic exploitation contributed to widespread discontent among Indian peasants and landlords.
 - Religious sensitivities were inflamed by British policies perceived as disrespectful or threatening to traditional Indian customs and beliefs. The issue of the Enfield rifle cartridges, with their alleged use of animal fat, deeply offended Hindu and Muslim sepoys.
- 5. Leadership and Coordination:**
- While the rebellion lacked centralized leadership or coordination, local leaders, including zamindars (landlords), taluqdars, and princes, emerged to provide direction and mobilize support for the uprising in different regions.
 - Despite diverse interests and agendas, these leaders rallied around the common goal of expelling British rule from India and restoring indigenous authority.
- 6. Brutal Repression and Consequences:**
- The nature of the British response to the rebellion was marked by brutal repression, widespread atrocities, and indiscriminate reprisals against Indian civilians.
 - Following the suppression of the rebellion, the British East India Company's rule over India was formally ended, and India came under direct British Crown rule (British Raj) in 1858.

In summary, the nature of the First War of Independence encompassed a complex interplay of resistance, nationalism, social grievances, and religious sensitivities. It represented a watershed moment in Indian history, marking the beginning of a concerted struggle against British colonialism and laying the groundwork for India's eventual independence.

Unit 2-

Factor leading to the growth of Nationalism in India :

I. Indian national congress

II. Dada Bhai Naurozi

III. Firozshah Mehta

VI. Lokmany Tilak

The growth of nationalism in India was influenced by a combination of factors that evolved over time, reflecting the complex socio-political landscape of colonial India. These factors played a crucial role in shaping the nationalist movement and fostering a sense of collective identity and solidarity among Indians. Here are some key factors leading to the growth of nationalism in India:

1. Impact of Colonial Rule:

The impact of colonial rule on the growth of nationalism in India was profound and multifaceted, shaping the trajectory of the nationalist movement and fostering a sense of collective identity and solidarity among Indians. Colonial rule not only imposed political, economic, and social constraints on Indian society but also served as a catalyst for resistance and the articulation of nationalist aspirations. Here are some key ways in which colonial rule influenced the growth of nationalism in India:

1. Political Oppression and Resentment:

- British colonial rule imposed political subjugation and centralized control over India, eroding indigenous political institutions and governance structures.
- Indians were excluded from political decision-making processes, and their voices were marginalized in matters of governance. This exclusion fueled resentment and a desire for self-rule and political autonomy among Indians.

2. Economic Exploitation and Dispossession:

- British economic policies, such as the land revenue system, taxation, and trade regulations, resulted in the economic exploitation and impoverishment of Indian peasants, artisans, and merchants.
- Economic exploitation fueled grievances against colonial rule and heightened anti-colonial sentiments. Indians sought economic self-reliance and control over their resources as a means of resisting British economic domination.

3. Cultural and Social Hegemony:

- British colonialism imposed cultural hegemony and undermined traditional Indian social structures and values. The imposition of Western education, legal

systems, and social norms eroded indigenous knowledge systems and cultural practices.

- Indians perceived British cultural imperialism as a threat to their identity and cultural heritage, leading to efforts to preserve and promote indigenous languages, customs, and traditions.

4. Emergence of Nationalist Consciousness:

- Colonial rule contributed to the emergence of nationalist consciousness and a sense of collective identity among Indians. The experience of colonial oppression and exploitation fostered a shared sense of grievance and solidarity among diverse Indian communities.
- Intellectuals, reformers, and leaders articulated nationalist aspirations and advocated for political reforms, social justice, and cultural revivalism. They promoted the idea of India as a nation with a shared history, culture, and destiny.

5. Resistance and Mobilization:

- British colonial rule provoked various forms of resistance and dissent, ranging from localized protests and uprisings to organized political movements and revolutionary activities.
- Movements such as the Indian National Congress (INC), founded in 1885, provided a platform for nationalist mobilization and advocacy for political reforms and self-government.

6. Impact of Repressive Measures:

- British authorities responded to nationalist activities with repressive measures, including censorship, surveillance, and the suppression of dissent.
- Repressive actions, such as the partition of Bengal in 1905 and the Jallianwala Bagh massacre in 1919, galvanized public outrage and intensified nationalist sentiments.

In summary, the impact of colonial rule on India played a central role in shaping the growth of nationalism. Colonial oppression, economic exploitation, cultural imperialism, and political exclusion fueled nationalist aspirations and mobilized Indians to demand self-rule, independence, and the restoration of their dignity and sovereignty.

- British colonial rule in India imposed economic exploitation, political subjugation, and cultural hegemony on the Indian populace. The policies of the British East India Company and later the British Crown led to the impoverishment of Indian society and the erosion of traditional institutions.
- Indians experienced discrimination, marginalization, and suppression of their rights under British rule, leading to widespread resentment and discontent.

2. Introduction of Western Education and Ideas:

The introduction of Western education and ideas played a significant role in the growth of nationalism in India. Western education, which was introduced by the British colonial authorities, exposed Indians to Enlightenment ideals, liberal values, and nationalist movements in Europe. This exposure had profound implications for Indian society, fostering a sense of political consciousness, intellectual awakening, and cultural resurgence. Here are some key ways in which Western education and ideas contributed to the growth of nationalism in India:

1. Dissemination of Liberal and Enlightenment Values:

- Western education introduced Indians to Enlightenment ideals such as liberty, equality, and fraternity. Indian students were exposed to the works of European philosophers, thinkers, and political theorists advocating for democratic governance, individual rights, and social justice.
- The study of Western literature, philosophy, and political science provided Indians with new perspectives on governance, society, and human rights, inspiring critical thinking and questioning of colonial authority.

2. Development of Nationalist Consciousness:

- Western education played a crucial role in the development of nationalist consciousness among Indians. Educated Indians, including students, professionals, and intellectuals, became aware of India's rich cultural heritage, history, and contributions to world civilization.
- The study of India's past glory and achievements instilled a sense of pride and identity among Indians, fostering a collective sense of nationhood and solidarity against colonial rule.

3. Formation of Political Associations and Organizations:

- Western-educated Indians played a central role in the formation of political associations and organizations advocating for political reforms and self-government. These organizations provided platforms for nationalist mobilization, intellectual exchange, and collective action.
- The Indian National Congress (INC), founded in 1885, emerged as a political forum for educated Indians to articulate nationalist aspirations, demand political representation, and advocate for constitutional reforms.

4. Role of Indian Intellectuals and Reformers:

- Western-educated Indian intellectuals and reformers played a pivotal role in the growth of nationalism. Figures such as Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar, and Swami Vivekananda promoted social reform, educational advancement, and cultural revivalism.
- These intellectuals used their Western education to challenge colonial stereotypes, promote Indian identity and values, and advocate for political emancipation and social justice.

5. Spread of Print Culture and Journalism:

- Western education facilitated the spread of print culture and journalism in India, enabling the dissemination of nationalist ideas, critiques of colonial policies, and calls for political reforms.

- Indian-owned newspapers and journals, many of which were founded and edited by Western-educated Indians, became important vehicles for nationalist discourse and the mobilization of public opinion.

In summary, Western education and ideas played a transformative role in shaping the growth of nationalism in India. They provided Indians with the intellectual tools, political awareness, and organizational infrastructure to challenge colonial rule, assert their identity, and demand self-rule and independence. The legacy of Western education continues to influence Indian society and politics, reflecting the enduring impact of colonialism on India's nationalist consciousness.

- The spread of Western education in India introduced Indians to Enlightenment ideals, liberal values, and nationalist movements in Europe. Indian intellectuals, students, and reformers were exposed to concepts of democracy, equality, and nationalism through Western literature, philosophy, and political thought.
- Institutions such as universities, colleges, and newspapers became platforms for the dissemination of nationalist ideas and the mobilization of educated Indians.

3. Emergence of Middle Class and Intellectuals:

The emergence of the middle class and intellectuals played a pivotal role in the growth of nationalism in India during the colonial period. This segment of society, often Western-educated and exposed to Enlightenment ideals, contributed significantly to the development of nationalist consciousness, political activism, and social reform. Here's how the emergence of the middle class and intellectuals fueled the growth of nationalism in India:

1. Western Education and Enlightenment Values:

- The middle class and intellectuals were beneficiaries of Western education introduced by the British colonial authorities. They were exposed to Enlightenment ideals such as liberty, equality, and fraternity, as well as concepts of democracy, individual rights, and social justice.
- Western-educated Indians embraced these values and applied them to the Indian context, advocating for political reforms, constitutional governance, and the protection of civil liberties.

2. Leadership in Political Movements:

- The middle class and intellectuals emerged as leaders and activists in the nationalist movement. They founded political organizations, such as the Indian National Congress (INC), and played key roles in shaping the agenda of the movement.
- Figures like Dadabhai Naoroji, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, and Bal Gangadhar Tilak were prominent leaders of the nationalist movement, articulating nationalist aspirations, demanding political representation, and advocating for self-rule.

3. Advocacy for Social Reform:

- The middle class and intellectuals championed social reform initiatives aimed at addressing social inequalities, caste discrimination, and other social injustices prevalent in Indian society.
- Social reform movements, such as the Brahmo Samaj, Arya Samaj, and Prarthana Samaj, were led by intellectuals who sought to promote social equality, religious tolerance, and women's rights.

4. Role in Cultural Renaissance:

- The middle class and intellectuals played a crucial role in the cultural renaissance of India, promoting indigenous arts, literature, and traditions. They sought to revive and celebrate India's rich cultural heritage as a means of asserting national identity and pride.
- Cultural organizations, literary societies, and educational institutions founded by intellectuals became centers of cultural revivalism and nationalist sentiment.

5. Advocacy for Economic Self-Reliance:

- The middle class and intellectuals advocated for economic self-reliance and industrialization as a means of challenging British economic dominance and fostering national development.
- They promoted Swadeshi (indigenous) industries, boycotts of British goods, and economic empowerment of Indian artisans, workers, and entrepreneurs as strategies for economic independence and self-sufficiency.

6. Contribution to Intellectual Discourse:

- The middle class and intellectuals enriched intellectual discourse in India through their writings, speeches, and debates. They critiqued colonial policies, analyzed socio-economic conditions, and proposed alternative visions for India's future.
- Indian-owned newspapers, journals, and literary works became platforms for nationalist discourse and the exchange of ideas among intellectuals and the wider public.

In summary, the emergence of the middle class and intellectuals played a transformative role in the growth of nationalism in India. Their leadership, activism, and advocacy for political, social, cultural, and economic reform helped galvanize nationalist sentiment and laid the foundation for India's struggle for independence from British colonial rule.

- The growth of a Western-educated middle class and intelligentsia played a significant role in the rise of Indian nationalism. Educated Indians, including lawyers, journalists, teachers, and professionals, became leaders and advocates of the nationalist cause.
- Influential figures such as Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Dadabhai Naoroji, Surendranath Banerjee, and Gopal Krishna Gokhale contributed to the articulation of nationalist aspirations and the mobilization of public opinion.

4. Impact of Socio-Religious Reform Movements:

The socio-religious reform movements in 19th and early 20th century India had a significant impact on the growth of nationalism in the country. These movements, characterized by their emphasis on social equality, religious revivalism, and cultural rejuvenation, played a crucial role in fostering nationalist sentiments and mobilizing Indians against British colonial rule. Here are some key ways in which the socio-religious reform movements contributed to the growth of nationalism in India:

1. Promotion of Social Equality:

- Socio-religious reform movements advocated for social equality and the abolition of discriminatory practices such as caste-based discrimination, untouchability, and social hierarchy.
- Leaders of these movements, such as Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Jyotirao Phule, and Periyar E.V. Ramasamy, campaigned for the rights and dignity of marginalized communities and called for the upliftment of the oppressed.

2. Assertion of Indian Identity:

- Socio-religious reform movements emphasized the revival and promotion of Indian cultural traditions, languages, and customs as a means of asserting national identity and pride.
- Movements like the Brahmo Samaj, Arya Samaj, and Ramakrishna Mission sought to promote a sense of cultural nationalism by celebrating India's ancient heritage and spiritual wisdom.

3. Cultural Renaissance:

- The reform movements played a pivotal role in the cultural renaissance of India, promoting literature, art, music, and education as vehicles for social reform and national regeneration.
- They established educational institutions, libraries, and publishing houses to disseminate knowledge and promote modern education among Indians.

4. Advocacy for Women's Rights:

- Many socio-religious reform movements advocated for women's rights and gender equality. They challenged patriarchal norms and practices that restricted women's education, freedom, and social mobility.
- Leaders such as Pandita Ramabai and Tarabai Shinde campaigned for women's education, widow remarriage, and the abolition of child marriage, contributing to the empowerment of women in Indian society.

5. Mobilization for Social and Political Reform:

- Socio-religious reform movements mobilized Indians for social and political reform by raising awareness, organizing public meetings, and launching campaigns against social evils.
- They created a platform for dialogue and collaboration among diverse communities and regions, fostering a sense of unity and solidarity among Indians.

6. Influence on Nationalist Leaders and Movements:

- Many leaders of the socio-religious reform movements, such as Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Swami Vivekananda, and Dayananda Saraswati, were influential figures in the nationalist movement.
- Their ideas and principles, including social reform, cultural revivalism, and religious tolerance, influenced the ideology and agenda of nationalist leaders and organizations like the Indian National Congress (INC).

In summary, the socio-religious reform movements played a crucial role in shaping the growth of nationalism in India by promoting social equality, cultural revivalism, and political activism. These movements provided a moral and intellectual foundation for the nationalist movement and contributed to the development of a cohesive sense of Indian identity and solidarity among diverse communities.

- Socio-religious reform movements, such as the Brahmo Samaj, Arya Samaj, and Ramakrishna Mission, advocated for social reform, religious revivalism, and cultural rejuvenation in Indian society.
- These movements promoted ideas of social equality, religious tolerance, and cultural pride, laying the groundwork for nationalist sentiments and the assertion of Indian identity.

5. Role of Press and Literature:

The role of the press and literature was instrumental in fostering the growth of nationalism in India during the colonial period. Newspapers, journals, and literary works served as powerful tools for disseminating nationalist ideas, mobilizing public opinion, and challenging colonial authority. Here are some key aspects of the role of press and literature in the growth of nationalism in India:

1. Dissemination of Nationalist Ideas:

- Indian-owned newspapers and journals played a crucial role in disseminating nationalist ideas and critiques of British colonial rule. They provided platforms for nationalist leaders, intellectuals, and activists to articulate their views and advocate for political reforms and self-rule.
- Newspapers such as *The Hindu*, *Amrita Bazar Patrika*, and *Kesari* became influential voices of the nationalist movement, promoting nationalist sentiments and mobilizing public support for the cause.

2. Mobilization of Public Opinion:

- The press played a vital role in mobilizing public opinion against British colonialism. Newspapers and journals published articles, editorials, and letters to the editor criticizing colonial policies, exposing injustices, and calling for political and social reforms.
- The press helped galvanize popular support for nationalist movements, campaigns, and boycotts, shaping public discourse and consciousness on issues of national importance.

3. Cultural Renaissance and Literary Revivalism:

- Literature played a significant role in fostering cultural revivalism and promoting nationalist sentiment. Indian writers, poets, and intellectuals used literature as a means of celebrating India's cultural heritage, history, and traditions.
- Literary works, including novels, poems, essays, and plays, contributed to the articulation of nationalist aspirations and the assertion of Indian identity. Writers such as Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay, Rabindranath Tagore, and Sarojini Naidu infused their literary creations with nationalist themes and ideals.

4. Circulation of Vernacular Literature:

- Vernacular literature in regional languages played a vital role in reaching a wider audience and mobilizing support for the nationalist cause. Regional newspapers, magazines, and literary works enabled the participation of non-English-speaking Indians in the nationalist movement.
- Vernacular literature reflected local concerns, aspirations, and identities, contributing to the diversity and inclusivity of the nationalist movement.

5. Education and Enlightenment:

- The press and literature played a crucial role in educating and enlightening the Indian populace about political, social, and cultural issues. Newspapers and literary works served as vehicles for spreading knowledge, promoting critical thinking, and fostering intellectual engagement.
- They empowered Indians with information, ideas, and perspectives that challenged colonial stereotypes, inspired pride in Indian heritage, and fueled aspirations for self-rule and independence.

In summary, the press and literature played a transformative role in the growth of nationalism in India by disseminating nationalist ideas, mobilizing public opinion, promoting cultural revivalism, and empowering Indians with knowledge and awareness. They served as powerful instruments of resistance against colonial oppression and contributed to the development of a vibrant and resilient nationalist movement that ultimately led to India's independence.

- The proliferation of newspapers, journals, and literature in regional languages and English provided a platform for nationalist discourse and dissent against British colonialism.
- Nationalist leaders and intellectuals used the press to disseminate nationalist ideas, critique British policies, and mobilize public opinion. Newspapers such as *The Hindu*, *Amrita Bazar Patrika*, and *Kesari* played a pivotal role in shaping nationalist consciousness.

6. Impact of Economic Exploitation:

The impact of economic exploitation under British colonial rule had a profound effect on the growth of nationalism in India. Economic exploitation by the British colonial administration, characterized by policies that prioritized British interests at the expense of Indian welfare,

fueled resentment, and resistance among the Indian populace. Here are some key ways in which economic exploitation contributed to the growth of nationalism in India:

1. Deindustrialization and Economic Decline:

- British colonial policies, such as the imposition of heavy tariffs, the destruction of local industries, and the promotion of British manufactured goods, led to the deindustrialization of India.
- Indian artisans, craftsmen, and weavers were displaced and impoverished, contributing to widespread economic hardship and unemployment. The decline of traditional industries eroded local economies and undermined indigenous economic autonomy.

2. Land Revenue System:

- The British colonial administration introduced the Permanent Settlement (in Bengal) and the Ryotwari and Mahalwari systems in other parts of India, which imposed heavy land revenue burdens on Indian peasants.
- High land taxes, coupled with usurious interest rates charged by moneylenders, pushed many peasants into debt bondage and landlessness. The exploitative land revenue system fueled agrarian unrest and peasant uprisings against colonial rule.

3. Exploitative Trade Policies:

- British colonial policies favored the export of raw materials from India to Britain and the import of manufactured goods from Britain to India. This trade imbalance resulted in the drain of wealth from India to Britain.
- Indians were forced to produce cash crops like indigo, cotton, and opium for export, often at the expense of food crops, leading to famines and agrarian distress. The exploitative trade policies contributed to India's economic dependency on Britain and exacerbated poverty and inequality.

4. Economic Discrimination:

- British colonial rule perpetuated economic discrimination and inequality in India. Indians were excluded from high-paying jobs, denied opportunities for economic advancement, and subjected to discriminatory practices in trade and commerce.
- British merchants and officials monopolized key sectors of the economy, controlling trade, finance, and industry, while Indian entrepreneurs faced barriers to entry and competition. Economic discrimination fueled resentment and nationalist sentiments among Indians.

5. Role of Economic Nationalism:

- Economic exploitation under colonial rule fueled the growth of economic nationalism in India. Nationalist leaders and intellectuals advocated for economic self-reliance, industrialization, and protectionism as means of challenging British economic dominance.
- Movements like the Swadeshi Movement, initiated in response to the partition of Bengal in 1905, promoted indigenous industries, boycotts of British goods,

and the use of Indian-made products as strategies for economic empowerment and national regeneration.

In summary, economic exploitation under British colonial rule played a central role in shaping the growth of nationalism in India by fueling resentment, resistance, and demands for economic justice and self-rule. The exploitation of India's resources and labor contributed to the economic impoverishment of the Indian populace and undermined the legitimacy of British colonial authority, galvanizing support for the nationalist movement.

- British economic policies, including land revenue systems, taxation, and trade regulations, impoverished Indian peasants, artisans, and merchants. Economic exploitation and famines exacerbated social inequalities and heightened anti-colonial sentiments.
- Movements against British economic exploitation, such as the Swadeshi Movement and the boycott of British goods, galvanized popular support for the nationalist cause and fostered economic self-reliance.

7. Impact of International Events:

- International events, such as World War I and the Russian Revolution, had a profound impact on Indian nationalism. Indian participation in the war, along with promises of self-government made by the British government, raised expectations for political reforms and increased demands for self-rule.
- The success of nationalist movements in other colonized countries, such as Ireland and Egypt, inspired Indian nationalists and reinforced their determination to achieve independence.

In summary, the growth of nationalism in India was influenced by a complex interplay of colonial oppression, Western education, socio-religious reform, economic exploitation, and international developments. These factors converged to create a fertile ground for the emergence of a vibrant and resilient nationalist movement that ultimately led to India's independence in 1947.

Impact of International Events growth of nationalism in India

The impact of international events on the growth of nationalism in India was significant, as global developments influenced Indian nationalist aspirations, strategies, and tactics. International events served as catalysts for change, inspiring Indians to assert their identity, demand self-rule, and challenge British colonialism. Here are some key ways in which international events contributed to the growth of nationalism in India:

1. World War I:

- India's participation in World War I had a profound impact on the growth of nationalism. Indian soldiers, laborers, and intellectuals contributed to the war effort, hoping for political concessions and reforms in return.
 - The war highlighted the contradictions of British imperialism, as Indians fought and sacrificed for a colonial power that denied them basic rights and freedoms. The experiences of Indian soldiers on the battlefield fostered a sense of solidarity and shared sacrifice, strengthening nationalist sentiments.
- 2. Russian Revolution:**
- The Russian Revolution of 1917 inspired Indian nationalists and revolutionaries, who saw in it a model of successful anti-colonial struggle and socialist transformation.
 - The Bolshevik Revolution challenged the legitimacy of colonial rule and offered alternative visions of governance and social justice. Indian nationalists drew parallels between the struggle of Russian peasants and workers and their own fight against British imperialism.
- 3. Irish Independence Movement:**
- The Irish struggle for independence from British rule in the early 20th century served as a source of inspiration and solidarity for Indian nationalists.
 - The successful tactics employed by Irish nationalists, including boycotts, strikes, and civil disobedience, influenced Indian nationalist leaders like Mahatma Gandhi and Jawaharlal Nehru. The Irish example demonstrated the efficacy of non-violent resistance and mass mobilization in challenging colonial rule.
- 4. Pan-Asianism and Anti-Imperialism:**
- The rise of Pan-Asianism and anti-imperialist movements in Asia, led by figures like Sun Yat-sen in China and Ho Chi Minh in Vietnam, provided ideological and political support for Indian nationalists.
 - Indian nationalists sought alliances and solidarity with anti-colonial movements across Asia, recognizing common interests and shared struggles against Western imperialism. The concept of Asian solidarity resonated with Indian nationalists' aspirations for independence and self-determination.
- 5. League of Nations and Woodrow Wilson's Principles:**
- The establishment of the League of Nations after World War I and US President Woodrow Wilson's principles of self-determination and national sovereignty raised hopes for international support for Indian self-rule.
 - Indian nationalists appealed to the League of Nations and invoked Wilsonian principles to demand political reforms, constitutional changes, and eventual independence from British colonial rule. The international recognition of the rights of nations to self-governance provided legitimacy to the Indian nationalist cause.
- 6. Impact of Diaspora and International Influences:**
- Indian diaspora communities, particularly in countries like the United States, Canada, and Britain, played a significant role in supporting the nationalist movement and advocating for Indian independence.

- International influences, through travel, education, and communication, exposed Indians to new ideas, movements, and perspectives, enriching the intellectual and ideological landscape of the nationalist movement.

In summary, international events had a profound impact on the growth of nationalism in India by inspiring, influencing, and supporting the nationalist cause. They provided Indian nationalists with models of resistance, solidarity, and international legitimacy, shaping the strategies and tactics of the nationalist movement and contributing to the eventual achievement of Indian independence.

The Indian National Congress

The Indian National Congress (INC) is one of the oldest and most significant political organizations in India. Established in 1885, the INC played a pivotal role in the Indian independence movement and subsequently in the nation-building process. Here's an overview of the Indian National Congress:

1. Formation and Early Years:

- The Indian National Congress was founded by Allan Octavian Hume, Dadabhai Naoroji, Dinshaw Wacha, and other prominent leaders during a meeting in Bombay (now Mumbai) in December 1885.
- The initial objectives of the INC were to provide a platform for educated Indians to voice their grievances, promote political reforms, and seek a greater role for Indians in the governance of their country under British rule.
- The early years of the Congress were marked by moderate and constitutionalist approaches, with leaders like Dadabhai Naoroji advocating for gradual reforms and Indian representation in legislative councils.

2. Moderate Phase:

- During its moderate phase, the INC focused on petitioning the British government for administrative and constitutional reforms. Leaders like Gopal Krishna Gokhale and Dadabhai Naoroji emphasized the importance of education, economic development, and political representation for Indians.
- The INC organized annual sessions, where resolutions were passed on various socio-economic and political issues, reflecting the concerns and aspirations of the Indian people.

3. Extremist Phase:

- The early 20th century saw the rise of the extremist faction within the Indian National Congress, led by leaders such as Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal, and Lala Lajpat Rai.
- The extremists advocated for more radical methods of protest and resistance against British colonial rule, including boycotts, strikes, and civil

disobedience. They criticized the moderate approach of the Congress and called for swaraj (self-rule) as the ultimate goal.

4. Role in the Independence Movement:

- The Indian National Congress played a central role in the Indian independence movement, mobilizing millions of Indians across the country in the struggle against British rule.
- The Congress organized mass protests, demonstrations, and civil disobedience campaigns, including the Non-Cooperation Movement (1920-1922) and the Civil Disobedience Movement (1930-1934), under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi.
- The Congress also represented Indian interests at international forums, lobbying for Indian independence and exposing British colonialism on the global stage.

5. Post-Independence Era:

- Following India's independence in 1947, the Indian National Congress emerged as the dominant political party in the newly independent country.
- The Congress provided leadership in the nation-building process, drafting the Indian Constitution, implementing economic and social reforms, and steering India's foreign policy.
- The INC remained in power for much of India's post-independence history, with Jawaharlal Nehru, Indira Gandhi, Rajiv Gandhi, and later leaders serving as Prime Ministers.

6. Evolution and Challenges:

- Over the years, the Indian National Congress has undergone various transformations, adapting to changing political, social, and economic realities.
- The INC has faced challenges from regional and ideological parties, as well as internal divisions and leadership struggles. It has also been criticized for issues such as corruption, inefficiency, and dynastic politics.

In summary, the Indian National Congress has played a central role in India's political evolution and independence movement. From its formation during the colonial period to its prominence in independent India, the Congress has been a key actor in shaping the nation's destiny and political landscape.

The Indian National Congress (INC) has a rich and complex history that is intertwined with the struggle for Indian independence and the socio-political context of colonial India. Here's an overview of the history of the Indian National Congress and the reasons for its formation:

1. Background of Colonial Rule:

- By the mid-19th century, India was under British colonial rule, administered by the British East India Company and later the British Crown. British colonial policies led to economic exploitation, political subjugation, and social discrimination against Indians.

- Indians were excluded from the governance of their own country and subjected to discriminatory laws and practices that favored British interests.
2. **Emergence of Indian Middle Class:**
 - The 19th century saw the emergence of a Western-educated Indian middle class, comprising professionals, intellectuals, and businessmen who were influenced by Western liberal ideas and values.
 - The Indian middle class became increasingly aware of the injustices of colonial rule and sought avenues for political participation and reform.
 3. **Reasons for Formation:**
 - The Indian National Congress was formed in 1885 in response to the growing demand for political representation and reform among educated Indians.
 - One of the primary reasons for its formation was to provide a platform for educated Indians to express their grievances, articulate their demands, and seek redress from the British government.
 - The Congress aimed to represent the interests of all Indians, irrespective of caste, religion, or region, and to foster unity among diverse communities in the face of colonial oppression.
 4. **Role of A.O. Hume:**
 - The idea of forming a national political organization was initiated by Allan Octavian Hume, a retired British civil servant who recognized the need for Indians to have a political voice.
 - Hume convened the first session of the Indian National Congress in Bombay (now Mumbai) in December 1885, where leaders from across India came together to discuss political reform and national unity.
 5. **Early Objectives:**
 - In its early years, the Indian National Congress focused on constitutional reforms, administrative decentralization, and greater Indian participation in governance.
 - The Congress aimed to work within the framework of British colonialism to achieve incremental changes and improvements in the lives of Indians.
 6. **Representation and Advocacy:**
 - The Indian National Congress served as a forum for Indian leaders to represent the interests of their constituents and advocate for issues such as civil liberties, social reform, and economic development.
 - Congress leaders like Dadabhai Naoroji, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, and Bal Gangadhar Tilak played key roles in articulating nationalist aspirations and demanding political concessions from the British government.

In summary, the Indian National Congress was formed in response to the need for political representation and reform in colonial India. It emerged as a leading force in the Indian independence movement, advocating for self-rule, national unity, and socio-economic justice. The Congress provided a platform for Indians to assert their rights and aspirations and played a central role in shaping the course of Indian history towards independence.

Formation of Indian National Congress

The Formation of Indian National Congress INC in 1885 marked a significant milestone in the history of India's struggle for independence. The INC was established to introduce well-educated and affluent Indians to politics. Founder of the Indian national congress was Allan Octavian Hume. He was a retired British Indian Civil Service employee. He founded INC to offer educated Indians a place for civil and political conversation. With the Indian Rebellion of 1857, control of India was transferred from the East India Company to the British Empire. By enlisting the aid of English-educated Indians, who were more familiar with and sympathetic to British culture and political philosophy, the British Raj, or simply the Raj, strove to legitimize and defend its control over India. With the monopoly of British authorities and the expanding class of Indians and Anglo-Indians trained in the English language-based British heritage, Congress grew alongside and survived, notably in the 19th century era of undeniable British domination.

About the Formation of Indian National Congress INC

A national party called the Indian National Congress was formed on December 28th, 1885. A British government employee named Allan Octavian Hume founded the party. A total of 72 delegates from all of India's provinces and presidencies joined forces to form the party. From December 28 to December 30, 1885, they all gathered in Bombay. Hume played a key role in forming the party when he served as its first general secretary. The party was founded specifically to unite all of the educated populace and have an impact on politics.

Formation of Indian National Congress	
Founder	Allan Octavian Hume
Formation Date	28 December 1885, Mumbai
Key People	Dadabhai Naoroji, Dinshaw Edulji Wacha, Surendranath Banerjee, Badruddin Tyabji, Pherozeshah Mehta W. C. Bonnerjee, S. Ramaswami Mudaliar, S. Subramania Iyer, and Romesh Chunder Dutt

History of the Formation of Indian National Congress 1885



The Formation of Indian National Congress INC was the result of a growing sense of national consciousness among the educated elite in India. This consciousness had been slowly but steadily developing over the course of the 19th century. The British colonial administration introduced various reforms and policies that aimed to modernize Indian society and governance. The Formation of Indian National Congress INC in 1885 was a culmination of this sentiment. The organization was founded with the aim of uniting the diverse voices of the Indian people and advocating for their rights. The establishment of the Indian National Congress marked a significant turning point in the country's political landscape. It ushered in a new era of organized resistance and nationalist aspirations.

Reasons for the Formation of Indian National Congress INC

The Formation of Indian National Congress INC was driven by a variety of factors, including:

- The desire for political representation
- The need for economic and social reforms
- The growing discontent with the British colonial rule

The educated and influential members of Indian society, who had been increasingly exposed to Western ideas and values, were frustrated by the lack of political power and decision-making authority in their own affairs. They sought to create a platform through which they could articulate their grievances and advocate for meaningful change. Additionally, the economic policies of the British often favored their own interests over those of the Indian people. This led to widespread resentment and a desire for greater economic autonomy. The Formation of Indian National Congress INC was, therefore, a response to these multifaceted challenges and a manifestation of the growing nationalist sentiment among the Indian population.

Foundation Theories

There are several theories that attempt to explain the Formation of Indian National Congress INC and its underlying motivations:

- The safety valve theory suggests that the British government encouraged the formation of the Congress to provide a platform for the expression of grievances, thereby channeling the growing discontent in a controlled and manageable manner.
- The conspiracy theory posits that the Congress was a deliberate ploy by the British to divide and rule the Indian people, creating an illusion of representative governance while maintaining their ultimate control.
- The lightning conductor theory proposes that the Congress was formed to divert the growing discontent and agitation in the country, acting as a "lightning conductor" to absorb and dissipate the potential for widespread unrest.

Role of A.O. Hume

The Formation of Indian National Congress INC was also heavily influenced by the efforts of A.O. Hume. He was a British civil servant who played a crucial role in the establishment of the organization. Hume, who had served as the Secretary of the Indian National Congress for many years, was deeply committed to the cause of Indian self-governance. He believed that the Congress could serve as a platform for the expression of nationalist aspirations. He worked tirelessly to bring together the diverse voices of the Indian people. He also ensured that the organization remained focused on its core objectives of political and economic reform. Hume's vision and dedication were instrumental in laying the foundation for the Indian National Congress and shaping its early trajectory as a leading force in the independence movement.

Objectives of the Indian National Congress

The Formation of Indian National Congress INC was guided by a set of objectives that included:

- The promotion of political and economic reforms
- The protection of the rights and interests of the Indian people
- The gradual attainment of self-government

The Congress sought to address the grievances of the Indian population. This included the lack of representation in the decision-making process, the inequitable distribution of economic resources, and the erosion of traditional social and cultural practices. By advocating for these reforms, the Congress aimed to create a more equitable and just society, one in which the Indian people would have a greater say in the governance of their own affairs.

Features of the Indian National Congress

The Formation of Indian National Congress INC was characterized by several key features that contributed to its growth and impact. These features, combined with the organization's unwavering dedication to the cause of Indian nationalism, made the Indian National Congress a formidable force in the country's struggle for independence.

- Diverse membership, drawing support from a wide range of social, religious, and economic backgrounds.
- Commitment to non-violence, rejecting the use of force as a means of achieving its goals.
- Focus on the gradual attainment of self-government, recognizing the long and arduous path to independence
- **Historical Context:** The Indian National Congress INC was formed in 1885 during a period of rising political awareness and the spread of nationalist sentiments among Indians, who sought greater participation in governance under British rule.

- **Founding Members:** The INC was founded by Allan Octavian Hume, along with prominent Indian leaders such as Dadabhai Naoroji, Dinshaw Wacha, and Womesh Chunder Bonnerjee, who aimed to create a platform for civil and political dialogue.
- **First Session:** The first session of the INC was held in Bombay (now Mumbai) in December 1885, with 72 delegates attending. Womesh Chunder Bonnerjee was elected as the first president of the Congress.
- **Objectives:** Initially, the INC aimed to promote unity among Indians, provide a platform for dialogue between Indian leaders and the British government, and seek gradual constitutional reforms.
- **Moderate Phase:** During its early years, the INC adopted a moderate approach, focusing on petitions, resolutions, and meetings to advocate for administrative reforms, greater representation, and the redress of grievances.
- **Social and Economic Issues:** The INC also addressed social and economic issues such as poverty, the drain of wealth from India to Britain, and the need for educational reforms and economic development.
- **British Reaction:** Initially, the British viewed the INC with suspicion but allowed its activities, believing it to be a safety valve for expressing discontent. However, as the Congress grew in influence, it faced increasing repression.
- **Evolution and Impact:** Over time, the INC evolved from a platform for elite dialogue to a mass movement for independence, leading to significant political mobilization and the eventual end of British colonial rule in India.
- **Role of Leaders:** Prominent leaders like Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, and later Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru, and Sardar Patel, played crucial roles in shaping the Congress and its strategies.
- **Legacy:** The formation of the INC marked the beginning of organized political activity in India, laying the foundation for the Indian freedom struggle and the eventual establishment of a democratic republic.

Dadabhai Naoroji

Dadabhai Naoroji, also known as the "Grand Old Man of India," was a prominent Indian nationalist leader, educator, and social reformer during the late 19th and early 20th centuries. He was one of the founding members of the Indian National Congress (INC) and played a significant role in the Indian independence movement. Here's an overview of Dadabhai Naoroji's life and contributions:

1. Early Life and Education:

- Dadabhai Naoroji was born on September 4, 1825, in Bombay (now Mumbai), India, into a Parsi family. He belonged to a community of Zoroastrians who had migrated to India from Persia.
- He received his early education in Bombay and later pursued higher studies in mathematics and natural philosophy at Elphinstone College. He also studied at University College London, where he became the first Indian to be appointed as a professor of Gujarati at the age of 27.

2. Career in Education and Commerce:

- Dadabhai Naoroji had a successful career as an educator, writer, and businessman. He served as a professor at Elphinstone College and later as the Principal of the Government Sanskrit College in Bombay.
- Naoroji also had a keen interest in economics and commerce. He established the London Indian Society in 1865 to promote Indian interests in Britain and served as the Director of the Dada-Dadysett Atash Behram, a fire temple in Bombay.

3. Political and Social Activism:

- Dadabhai Naoroji was a staunch advocate for Indian self-rule and played a pivotal role in the Indian nationalist movement. He was one of the founding members of the Indian National Congress (INC) and served as its President in 1886, 1893, and 1906.
- Naoroji was known for his "Drain Theory," which highlighted the economic exploitation of India by the British colonial administration. He argued that India's wealth was being drained to Britain through the export of raw materials and the imposition of heavy taxes.
- He was also a vocal critic of racial discrimination and social inequality in colonial India. He advocated for the rights of Indians to participate in governance, access to education, and economic opportunities regardless of their caste or religion.

4. Member of Parliament in Britain:

- In 1892, Dadabhai Naoroji became the first Indian to be elected as a Member of Parliament (MP) in Britain. He represented the Liberal Party and served as the MP for Finsbury Central.
- As an MP, Naoroji continued to advocate for Indian interests and raised issues related to India's economic and political status in the British Parliament. He used his position to raise awareness about the plight of Indians under British colonial rule.

5. Legacy and Contributions:

- Dadabhai Naoroji's contributions to the Indian independence movement and his advocacy for Indian rights have left a lasting legacy. He inspired future generations of Indian nationalists and leaders, including Mahatma Gandhi and Jawaharlal Nehru.
- Naoroji's emphasis on economic self-sufficiency, social justice, and political representation laid the groundwork for the nationalist struggle against British colonialism. He remains an iconic figure in the history of India's struggle for independence and is remembered as one of its foremost leaders.

Dadabhai Naoroji,

adabhai Naoroji is also known as the 'Grand Old Man of India' and worked as an Ambassador of India. He was a great politician, Indian scholar, and trader. Dadabhai Naoroji was the first Indian-Asian to be a British Member of Parliament. Naoroji was also one of the

founding partners of the Indian National Congress. His book named 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India' carried an awareness for his theory 'DRAIN OF WEALTH' from India to Britain. Being an Indian, his ideology and knowledge focused on the worldwide welfare and prosperity of the people.

DadaBhai Naoroji

Dadabhai Naoroji was born in Bombay. In 1855, he became a Mathematics Professor at Elphinstone College. He was the first Indian to have such a status. Later, he became a Gujarati professor at the University College London. He was married at the age of eleven to a Gulbai family.

Today, In Mumbai, Pakistan, roads are named after Dadabhai Naoroji. In the Finsbury area of London, a road was named Naoroji Street,

A major residential settlement for prominent government servants in Delhi was also named Naoroji Nagar. Naoroji's granddaughters Khurshedben and Perin were also involved in the freedom movement. In 1930, Khurshedben was halted along with other revolutionaries for endeavouring to hoist the Indian flag at Ahmedabad in a Government College.

Contributions of Dadabhai Naoroji

- He also held a partnership in the first Indian Company named the firm Cama & Co., which was established in Britain.
- In 1874 he began his political career as the Diwan of Maharaja of Baroda.
- In 1856 he formed the London Indian Society to establish his views on Indian social, literary, and political sections.
- In 1867 he founded the East Indian Association to emphasise the Indian points to the British forum. This is the first association that consists of members from different Indian regions. The organisation was appreciated by eminent English people and supported to influence the ideas of Indians in the British Council.
- From 1885 to 1888, he became one of the Legislative Council of Mumbai members.
- In 1885 along with Allan Hume and Dinshaw Wacha, he formed the Indian National Congress.
- Naoroji found it is essential to study Anglo-Indian trade to control the impulsive repeal of developing industries to one-sided valuing of goods and services. By permitting industry to develop, evolve, and grow in India, contributions could be paid to Britain in tax and the increase in Indian interest in British goods. Hence as an Imperial Citizen, he framed out the economic hardships faced by Indian people in front of the British.
- He stated that Indians were either enslaved people or matters of the British, which relied on the importance of Britain's wish to give the associations already utilised by them to India.
- In 1892 he was elected for the Liberal party in Finsbury Central.
- In 1896, due to his drain theory, a Royal Commission was set up on Indian Expenditures. He became a member of the commission and reviewed the financial responsibilities of India.

- In 1858 he gave statistical data to prove his drain theory in many papers and speeches. He was the first person who used statistics in politics.
- Dadabhai was the Congress President for 1886, 1893, and 1906.
- In 1851 he founded the Rahnumai Mazdayasnan Sabha to promote the Zoroastrian religion. This association is still running in Mumbai.
- Dadabhai Naoroji was a moderate leader and had a strong voice over the objection to British policies in India.
- Dadabhai was a mentor to Gopal Krishna Gokhale, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, and Mahatma Gandhi.
- In 2014, Deputy PM of UK, Nick Clegg inaugurated the Dadabhai Naoroji Awards for services to India-United kingdom relations.

Dadabhai Naoroji Works

1. “Poverty and Un-British Rule in India” became a critical book because the book talked about the wealth that was drained during British rule.
2. In 1864, ‘The Manners and Customs of the Parsees’ (Bombay).
3. He Started the Rast Goftar Anglo-Gujarati Newspaper in 1854.
4. He also delivered Admission to educated natives into the Indian Civil Service (London, 1868).
5. He also wrote The Wants and means of India (London, 1876) and Condition of India (Madras, 1882)

Dadabhai Naoroji will forever be recalled as the intelligent Indian academician and politician who helped India’s motivation in Britain and other countries and one of the triads who co-founded the Indian National Congress. In 1917 at the age of 91, he died in Bombay.

A major residential settlement for prominent government servants in Delhi was also named Naoroji Nagar. Naoroji’s granddaughters Khurshedben and Perin were also involved in the freedom movement. In 1930, Khurshedben was halted along with other revolutionaries for endeavouring to hoist the Indian flag at Ahmedabad in a Government College.

Conclusion

During Dadabhai Naoroji’s administration, his time in the British Parliament, Naoroji articulated India’s wealth drain, the advantages of providing equal employment opportunities to Indians, and the country’s industrialisation. He played a vital role in forming the Indian National Congress and was a member of the Second International. He also worked for the welfare of Indian society for personal reasons. Naoroji is one economist who uplifted the Indian economy through various moves and strategies. Dadabhai had the vision and mission to improve the financial and education sectors worldwide. Thus, he is considered the ‘Unofficial Ambassador of India.’

Pherozeshah Mehta: Early Life, Political Career, Contributions

Sir Pherozeshah Mehta: Overview

Pherozeshah Mehta, also known as Firoz Shah Mehta or Sir Pherozeshah Mehta. He was a prominent figure in Indian history, particularly during the British Empire. He grew up to become one of the most influential leaders in Bombay. Mehta was often referred to as the "uncrowned king of Bombay" or the "lion of Bombay." Due to his immense popularity and influence over the city's politics and society.

Pherozeshah Mehta Information	
Full Name	Pherozeshah Merwanjee Mehta
Date of Birth	August 4, 1845
Died	November 5, 1915
Other Names	○ Firoz Shah Mehta ○ Feroz Shah Mehta ○ Uncrowned King of Bombay ○ Lion of Bombay ○ Sir Pherozeshah Mehta
Occupation	○ Lawyer ○ Politician
Known for	Co-founder and President of the Indian National Congress
Pherozeshah Mehta Political Party	Indian National Congress

Born on August 4, 1845, in Bombay, Sir Pherozeshah Mehta spent much of his life there. His father, Merwanji Mehta, hailed from a merchant family. He pursued legal studies at Lincoln's Inn, becoming a barrister in 1868. While in England, he frequented Dadabhai Naoroji's home, shaping his liberal perspective. Among his liberal-minded friends were Telang, Badruddin Tyabji, Ranade, Gokhale, and Wacha. Mehta, Tyabji, and Telang were referred to as 'the three bright boys of Bombay'.

Pherozeshah Mehta Early Life and Education

- Firoz Shah Mehta, was born Pherozeshah Mehta in 1845. He came from a prominent Parsi family, and his father was a successful merchant.
- At the age of 21, Pherozeshah Mehta earned a law degree and began practicing as a lawyer.
- Pherozeshah Mehta gained a reputation for his skills in litigation and became a respected member of the Bombay Bar.
- Pherozeshah Mehta legal career allowed him to become familiar with the workings of the British.

- Firoz Shah Mehta was born on August 4, 1845, in Mumbai (then Bombay), India, into a wealthy Parsi family. He received his early education in Mumbai and later studied law at the University of Bombay, where he excelled academically.
- He highlighted the injustices faced by the Indian people under British rule.
- He saw the economic and social disparities faced by his fellow Indians.
- Pherozeshah Mehta became involved in various organizations that advocated for social and political reform.

Pherozeshah Mehta Political Career

Pherozeshah Mehta efforts toward promoting Indian nationalism marked Pherozeshah Mehta's political career.

After completing his legal studies, Firoz Shah Mehta began his career as a lawyer and quickly gained recognition for his legal acumen and advocacy skills. He established a successful legal practice in Mumbai and became known for his integrity and commitment to justice.

- In 1861, Pherozeshah Mehta founded the Zoroastrian trust funds of Europe.
- He also helped in the launching the East India Association.
- In 1874 Pherozeshah Mehta was appointed as the governor of Baroda.
- Pherozeshah Mehta was first Indian in the British Parliament.
- Mehta's political career began in the 1870s. He became involved in the foundation of the Indian National Congress.
- He became a close associate of leaders such as Dadabhai Naoroji and Gopal Krishna Gokhale.
- Pherozeshah Mehta is known to be a well-known author. Pherozeshah Mehta work mainly included Rast Goftar, an Anglo-Indian newspaper, and The European and Asiatic races. In these pieces, he criticized the policies of the British government.
- In the British parliament he addressed the economic hardships in India.
- He argued for equal employment opportunities amongst Indians.
- One of Mehta's major contributions to Indian politics was his leadership in the Bombay Municipal Corporation.
- Pherozeshah Mehta was elected to the corporation in 1873.
- In 1885, Sir Pherozeshah Mehta founded The Bombay Presidency Association, along with Badruddin Tyabji and K.T. Telang.
- It served as its president from 1884 to 1885 and from 1896 to 1897.
- Pherozeshah Mehta introduced several reforms aimed at improving the living conditions of the people.
- Pherozeshah Mehta also played a key role in the Indian Reform Association.
- In 1907, Mehta was knighted by the British government.

Sir Pherozeshah Mehta Contributions & Achievements

- Pherozeshah Mehta played a key role in establishing the Central Bank of India, a Swadeshi bank.
- He is renowned as the founder of the modern Bombay Municipal Corporation and served with distinction for almost 50 years.
- Pherozeshah Mehta was instrumental in establishing the Bombay Chronicle, an English newspaper that provided a platform for expressing Indian public opinion during the nationalist movement.
- Pherozeshah Mehta actively participated in the formation and administration of political organizations and government institutions.
- Pherozeshah Mehta held a prominent position within the Indian National Congress, aiming to prevent extremists from dominating the organization.
- He presided over the Calcutta Congress session in 1890 and served as President of the Reception Committee twice during Congress meetings in Bombay (1889 and 1904).
- Pherozeshah Mehta consistently advocated for administrative reforms during various Congress sessions.
- He co-founded the Bombay Presidency Association in 1885 and served as its Secretary.
- Pherozeshah Mehta received honors such as the C.I.E. in 1894 and a knighthood in 1904.
- The University of Bombay awarded him an honorary Doctor of Law degree in 1915.
- Mehta was deeply influenced by the socio-political conditions of colonial India and became actively involved in the Indian nationalist movement. He was a staunch advocate for Indian self-rule and played a key role in mobilizing public opinion against British colonialism.
- Mehta was one of the founding members of the Indian National Congress (INC) and served as its President in 1890. He played a crucial role in shaping the policies and direction of the Congress during its formative years.
- As a member of the Bombay Municipal Corporation, Mehta worked tirelessly to improve civic amenities and promote social welfare initiatives for the benefit of the people of Mumbai. He advocated for public health reforms, sanitation measures, and urban development projects.

□ Journalism and Literary Contributions:

- Firoz Shah Mehta was also actively involved in journalism and literary pursuits. He contributed articles to newspapers and journals on various social, political, and economic issues, using his writing to advocate for Indian interests and nationalist causes.
- Mehta's writings reflected his deep commitment to Indian nationalism and his vision for a free and independent India. He used his platform as a journalist to raise

awareness about the injustices of British colonial rule and to mobilize public support for the nationalist movement.

Pherozeshah Mehta Legacy

Pherozeshah Mehta's legacy is a testament to his unwavering commitment to social justice and his efforts toward promoting Indian nationalism. Pherozeshah Mehta's contributions to the Indian national movement have left an indelible mark on Indian history.

Sir Pherozeshah Mehta's life embodies a commitment to liberalism and a deep connection to Bombay. His legal pursuits and influential friendships, notably with Dadabhai Naoroji, fostered his progressive ideals. As one of Bombay's 'bright boys', alongside Tyabji and Telang, Mehta's legacy is marked by his pivotal role in shaping Indian politics and society during a transformative era. His enduring contributions continue to inspire generations, reflecting a dedication to justice, reform, and a vibrant democratic ethos.

Conclusion

Sir Pherozeshah Mehta's life embodies a commitment to liberalism and a deep connection to Bombay. His legal pursuits and influential friendships, notably with Dadabhai Naoroji, fostered his progressive ideals. As one of Bombay's 'bright boys', alongside Tyabji and Telang, Mehta's legacy is marked by his pivotal role in shaping Indian politics and society during a transformative era. His enduring contributions continue to inspire generations, reflecting a dedication to justice, reform, and a vibrant democratic ethos.

Lokmanya Tilak

Lokmanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak, often referred to as Lokmanya Tilak, was one of the foremost leaders of the Indian independence movement. His contributions to Indian nationalism, social reform, and journalism played a significant role in shaping the course of India's struggle for freedom. Here's an overview of Lokmanya Tilak's life and his contributions:

1. Early Life and Education:

- Bal Gangadhar Tilak was born on July 23, 1856, in Ratnagiri, Maharashtra, India. He received his early education in Marathi and Sanskrit, and later pursued higher studies in law at the Government Law College in Bombay (now Mumbai).
- Tilak was deeply influenced by Indian culture, history, and philosophy from a young age. He was particularly inspired by the teachings of ancient Indian texts such as the Bhagavad Gita and the Vedas.

2. Journalism and Political Activism:

- Tilak was a prolific writer, journalist, and social reformer. He founded and edited several newspapers and journals, including Kesari (in Marathi) and

Maratha (in English), which played a crucial role in disseminating nationalist ideas and mobilizing public opinion against British colonial rule.

- As a journalist, Tilak used his writing to critique British policies, advocate for Indian interests, and promote social and political reform. He was known for his fearless and outspoken criticism of British imperialism and his advocacy for Indian self-rule.

3. Promotion of Swadeshi and Boycott Movement:

- Tilak was a strong proponent of the Swadeshi (indigenous) movement and the boycott of British goods as a means of economic resistance against colonial exploitation. He believed in promoting Indian industries, handicrafts, and goods to achieve self-sufficiency and economic empowerment.
- Tilak's advocacy for Swadeshi and boycotts inspired mass mobilization and participation across India, leading to the widespread adoption of Swadeshi goods and the boycott of British-manufactured products.

4. Role in Indian National Congress:

- Lokmanya Tilak was one of the founding members of the Indian National Congress (INC) and played a crucial role in shaping its policies and objectives. He advocated for more radical methods of resistance against British rule and was a leading figure in the extremist faction of the Congress.
- Tilak served as the President of the Indian National Congress in 1896 and 1906, where he emphasized the goal of Swaraj (self-rule) and called for mass agitation and civil disobedience to achieve it.

5. Contribution to Indian Renaissance:

- Tilak's contributions extended beyond politics to the realm of social reform and cultural revivalism. He emphasized the importance of Indian traditions, values, and customs, and promoted cultural renaissance as a means of strengthening national identity and pride.
- Tilak played a key role in popularizing festivals such as Ganesh Chaturthi and Shivaji Jayanti as occasions for public celebration and cultural expression. He saw these festivals as opportunities to foster unity and solidarity among Indians.

6. Imprisonment and Sacrifice:

- Tilak faced persecution and imprisonment by the British colonial authorities for his nationalist activities. He was arrested multiple times and spent several years in prison for his advocacy of Swadeshi, boycotts, and civil disobedience.
- Despite facing personal hardships and sacrifices, Tilak remained steadfast in his commitment to the cause of Indian independence and continued to inspire millions of Indians with his courage and resilience.

7. Legacy and Influence:

- Lokmanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak is remembered as one of the greatest freedom fighters and nationalist leaders of India. His contributions to Indian nationalism, social reform, and journalism continue to inspire generations of Indians.

- Tilak's famous slogan "Swaraj is my birthright, and I shall have it" became a rallying cry for the Indian independence movement and remains etched in the annals of Indian history. He is revered as a national hero and a symbol of courage, patriotism, and resilience in the struggle against colonialism.
8. Lokmanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak, often referred to as Lokmanya Tilak, was a towering figure in the Indian nationalist movement, whose contributions were instrumental in shaping the course of India's struggle for independence. His unwavering commitment to the cause of Indian nationalism, his advocacy for mass mobilization and grassroots organizing, and his fearless opposition to British colonial rule earned him the title of "Lokmanya," meaning "revered by the people." Here's an essay on Lokmanya Tilak's contribution to Indian nationalism:
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- 9.
 10. **Lokmanya Tilak: Architect of Indian Nationalism**
 11. Lokmanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak occupies a revered place in the annals of Indian history as one of the foremost leaders of the Indian nationalist movement. Born on July 23, 1856, in Ratnagiri, Maharashtra, Tilak emerged as a prominent figure in the struggle against British colonial rule, spearheading the fight for Indian independence through his visionary leadership, fiery nationalism, and unwavering dedication to the cause.
 12. From the outset, Lokmanya Tilak demonstrated a deep sense of patriotism and a fervent desire to liberate India from the shackles of colonialism. He recognized the urgent need for Indian unity and self-reliance in the face of British exploitation and oppression. Through his writings, speeches, and political activism, Tilak galvanized the Indian masses, instilling in them a sense of pride, dignity, and collective identity.
 13. Tilak's greatest contribution to Indian nationalism lay in his advocacy for mass mobilization and grassroots organizing. He believed fervently in the power of the people to effect change and saw the masses as the driving force behind the struggle for independence. Through his newspapers, Kesari (Marathi) and Maratha (English), Tilak disseminated nationalist ideas, mobilized public opinion, and galvanized support for the cause of Swaraj, or self-rule.
 14. One of Tilak's most enduring legacies was his role in the Swadeshi and Boycott Movement, which sought to boycott British goods and promote indigenous industries as a means of economic self-sufficiency. He believed that economic independence was essential for India's political freedom and exhorted Indians to reject foreign goods and embrace Swadeshi products. Tilak's call for Swadeshi resonated deeply with the Indian masses and sparked a wave of nationalist fervor across the country.
 15. Tilak's political philosophy emphasized the need for a radical and assertive approach to the struggle against British colonialism. He famously declared, "Swarajya is my birthright, and I shall have it," encapsulating the indomitable spirit of Indian nationalism. Tilak's emphasis on direct action, civil disobedience, and mass agitation inspired countless Indians to join the freedom struggle and challenge the authority of the British Raj.
 16. Despite facing persecution, imprisonment, and personal hardship at the hands of the British authorities, Tilak remained resolute in his commitment to the cause of Indian

nationalism. He refused to be silenced or intimidated and continued to champion the rights of the Indian people until his last breath. His courage, resilience, and sacrifice inspired generations of Indians to fight for their freedom and dignity.

17. In conclusion, Lokmanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak's contribution to Indian nationalism was profound and far-reaching. His vision, leadership, and unwavering commitment to the cause of Swaraj laid the foundation for India's eventual independence. Tilak's legacy continues to inspire millions of Indians to uphold the values of freedom, justice, and democracy, making him a true icon of the Indian nationalist movement.
18. _____
19. Lokmanya Tilak's contribution to Indian nationalism remains unparalleled, and his legacy continues to inspire generations of Indians to strive for a better, more just, and equitable society.

Unit 3-

Early phase :

I. The ideology, Programme and Policy of Moderates

II. Formation of the Muslim League

III. Partition of Bengal.

The ideology, Programme and Policy of Moderates

The Moderates were a faction within the Indian National Congress (INC) during the late 19th and early 20th centuries. They played a crucial role in laying the foundation for India's struggle for independence. The ideology, programme, and policies of the Moderates were characterized by their faith in constitutional methods, gradual reforms, and loyalty to the British Crown, while advocating for greater Indian participation in governance and socio-economic reforms. Here's a detailed look at their ideology, programme, and policies:

Ideology

1. **Faith in British Rule:** The Moderates believed that the British rule in India was generally beneficial and that the British government would respond positively to rational and logical demands for reform. They considered British rule as a means to bring modernization and development to India.
2. **Constitutional Methods:** They firmly believed in constitutional and legal methods of agitation. The Moderates were opposed to violent methods and instead sought to achieve their goals through dialogue, petitions, and representation.
3. **Loyalty to the Crown:** The Moderates expressed loyalty to the British Crown, believing that the British Parliament and public opinion would ensure justice and fair play in India. They aimed to work within the framework of the British Empire to achieve their objectives.
4. **Gradual Reforms:** They advocated for gradual and incremental reforms rather than immediate and radical changes. They believed that a step-by-step approach would lead to sustainable progress and development in India.

Programme

1. **Political Reforms:** The Moderates sought greater Indian representation in legislative councils and administrative bodies. They demanded that educated and qualified Indians should be appointed to high-ranking positions within the colonial administration.
2. **Economic Reforms:** They highlighted the economic exploitation of India under British rule and demanded policies that would promote Indian industries, reduce land revenue, and improve the economic conditions of the Indian populace.
3. **Civil Rights:** The Moderates campaigned for civil liberties, including the freedom of speech, expression, and association. They sought to protect the rights of Indians against arbitrary and unjust colonial laws.
4. **Education:** Emphasis was placed on the expansion of Western education. They believed that educating Indians would lead to greater awareness of their rights and responsibilities and would facilitate the country's overall development.

Policies

1. **Petitions and Memorials:** The Moderates utilized petitions, memorials, and representations to put forth their demands to the British authorities. They believed in persuading the British government through reasoned arguments and documented evidence.
2. **Legislative Councils:** They worked towards expanding the powers of the legislative councils and increasing Indian representation within these councils. The Indian Councils Act of 1892 was a result of their efforts, which allowed for a modest increase in the number of Indian members in the councils.
3. **Economic Critique:** The Moderates were vocal critics of the economic policies of the British government that led to the drain of wealth from India to Britain. Leaders like Dadabhai Naoroji propounded the "Drain Theory," which explained how British policies were impoverishing India.
4. **Social Reforms:** They supported various social reforms, including the abolition of child marriage, promotion of widow remarriage, and efforts to eradicate social evils such as untouchability. They believed that social progress was essential for the overall development of the nation.
5. **Public Awareness:** The Moderates focused on creating public awareness about national issues through the press, public meetings, and discussions. Newspapers like "The Hindu" and "The Amrita Bazar Patrika" played significant roles in disseminating their ideas.

Key Leaders

- **Dadabhai Naoroji:** Known as the "Grand Old Man of India," Naoroji was a prominent Moderate leader who articulated the economic critique of British rule through his "Drain Theory."
- **Gopal Krishna Gokhale:** An influential Moderate leader, Gokhale emphasized the importance of education and social reform, and founded the Servants of India Society to promote these ideals.
- **Surendranath Banerjee:** A key figure in the Moderate movement, Banerjee was an advocate for constitutional methods and played a significant role in the formation of the Indian National Congress.

Conclusion

The Moderates laid the groundwork for the Indian independence movement by advocating for constitutional methods, gradual reforms, and greater Indian participation in governance. Their ideology, programme, and policies were instrumental in creating political awareness among the Indian masses and setting the stage for more radical phases of the nationalist movement that followed. Despite their limited success in achieving immediate goals, the Moderates' contributions were crucial in the broader struggle for India's independence.

Formation and Objectives Of Muslim League: Everything

In British India, there was a political party called the All India Muslim League. Muslim aristocrats, thinkers, and businesspeople established the party in Dhaka. The party supported Muslim rights within British India. Later it contributed to India's independence from the British Empire. But they did have a Pro-British attitude. This is visible in the formation and objectives of Muslim League. The partition of India was a goal of the Muslim League. The division of British India into two independent states took place in 1947.

Formation And Objectives Of Muslim League

British Government implemented the "Divide and Rule" strategy against Hindus and Muslims. It divided two significant communities in British India. This also paved the path for the formation of a Muslim Political Group. This is evident in the formation and objectives of Muslim League.

Formation Of Muslim League

The Muslim community believed that Congress was biased in favor of Hindus. The few notable Muslim leaders then decided to find their political party. The goal was to represent their way of life and issues to the British Government. Both formation and objectives of Muslim League were evidence of their pro-British policies.

- By 1901, it was believed crucial for a national Muslim political group to be formed. Representatives from all over India attended the conference in Lucknow in September 1906. This allowed the leaders to begin the idea of the Muslim League.
- Through the Shimla Delegation, 35 Indian Muslims received Governor General Lord Minto on October 1, 1906. Aga Khan III led the delegation. Lord Minto encouraged the Indian Muslims to find their distinct political party.
- On December 30, 1906, Aga Khan III and Viqar-ul-Mulk invited important leaders to Dhaka to form a new organization. This organization for the welfare of Indian Muslims was called the "All India Muslim League." Both formation and objectives of Muslim League marked a new phase in the Separatist and communal history of India.
- In British India, the All-India Muslim League was founded in 1906. It was established as the Indian National Congress's rival political organization. It was established to advocate for Indian Muslims' interests. Sultan Muhammad Shah (Aga Khan III) was chosen as the organization's first honorary president. But, he did not attend the Muslim League's inaugural assembly in Dhaka.
- Mohammed Ali Jinnah became a member of the Muslim Alliance in 1913. The League originally aimed to train students to work for the British Raj. But, it quickly turned into a hub of political action. Since its start, the Muslim League has called for unity in an independent India. They have also expressed concern that Hindus, who comprise most of the population, will rule it.

The All India Muslim League was established with many goals for the well-being of Indian

Muslims. A few of its goals were:

- Muslims were subject to discrimination. So, the League's first goal was to maintain them from having feelings of hatred towards the other communities in India.
- To convey to the British Government the issues and requirements of Muslim Communities and to meet those needs.
- The Muslims of India wished to show their allegiance and support to the British Government through the All India Muslim League.
- The All-India Muslim League worked to guarantee Muslims' rights. This included their access to equal rights to schooling and employment in Government.
- The All India Muslim League offers the British Government good coordination.
- The party was created in response to the need for Muslim political participation in British India.
- Following demonstrations, the Muslim League staged in India and lobbying in London. The Indian Councils Act finally gave in to the League's demands for separate electorates and reserved seats.
- The Muslim League drove the campaign to split British India into Muslim and Hindu states.

The All-India Muslim League was founded in 1906 and played a significant role in the history of India's struggle for independence and the eventual partition of India and Pakistan. Here's a detailed overview of the formation of the Muslim League, including the context, reasons, key figures, and initial objectives:

Context

1. British Colonial Rule:

- By the early 20th century, India was under British colonial rule, and various socio-political dynamics were shaping the Indian independence movement. The Indian National Congress (INC), founded in 1885, was the primary political organization advocating for Indian self-rule, largely representing the interests of the Hindu-majority population.

2. Communal Tensions:

- As the nationalist movement grew, there were concerns among some Muslims about their representation and interests within the broader nationalist framework. The growing dominance of the Hindu-majority Congress led to fears of marginalization among Muslims.

3. Educational and Social Backwardness:

- Many Muslims, particularly those from the aristocratic and landowning classes, were concerned about their community's educational and social backwardness compared to Hindus, who had benefitted more from British educational policies.

Reasons for Formation

1. Political Representation:

- Muslims sought a separate political platform to ensure their representation in legislative bodies and to safeguard their political rights and interests.

2. Protection of Interests:

- There was a perceived need to protect Muslim cultural, religious, and social interests from being overshadowed by the Hindu-majority Congress.

3. British Encouragement:

- The British colonial administration, following a policy of "divide and rule," subtly encouraged the formation of separate Muslim political organizations to counterbalance the growing influence of the Congress.

Key Figures

1. Nawab Salimullah of Dhaka:

- A key initiator in the formation of the Muslim League, Nawab Salimullah hosted the meeting at his residence in Dhaka where the decision to establish the League was made.

2. Sir Aga Khan III:

- Sir Aga Khan III, the spiritual leader of the Ismaili Muslims, became the first president of the Muslim League and played a crucial role in its early development.

3. Nawab Mohsin-ul-Mulk and Nawab Waqar-ul-Mulk:

- Both were influential in the formation of the League and were instrumental in mobilizing support among the Muslim aristocracy and intelligentsia.

Formation of the Muslim League

1. Simla Deputation (1906):

- In October 1906, a delegation of 35 Muslim leaders, known as the Simla Deputation, met with Viceroy Lord Minto to advocate for separate electorates for Muslims. The success of this deputation highlighted the need for a formal organization to represent Muslim interests.

2. Dhaka Meeting (1906):

- On December 30, 1906, the All-India Muslim League was formally established during a meeting at Shahbagh in Dhaka (now in Bangladesh). The meeting was attended by prominent Muslim leaders from across India.

Objectives of the Muslim League

1. Promotion of Loyalty to the British Crown:

- Initially, the Muslim League sought to promote loyalty to the British government while advocating for Muslim interests within the framework of British rule.
- 2. **Protection of Muslim Rights:**
 - The League aimed to protect and advance the political rights and interests of Muslims in India.
- 3. **Prevention of Muslim Disunity:**
 - The organization sought to foster a sense of unity and solidarity among the diverse Muslim communities across India.
- 4. **Advocacy for Separate Electorates:**
 - One of the primary objectives was to secure separate electorates for Muslims in legislative assemblies, ensuring that Muslim voices were adequately represented in the political arena.

Early Activities and Evolution

1. **Advocacy and Representation:**
 - In its early years, the Muslim League focused on advocating for Muslim representation in legislative councils and promoting educational and social reforms within the Muslim community.
2. **Collaboration with the British:**
 - The League maintained a cooperative relationship with the British government, advocating for reforms that would benefit Muslims while supporting the colonial administration.
3. **Shift towards Nationalism:**
 - Over time, the Muslim League's stance evolved from loyalty to the British Crown to a more nationalist outlook. By the 1930s and 1940s, under the leadership of Mohammad Ali Jinnah, the League became a powerful force advocating for the creation of a separate Muslim state, leading to the eventual partition of India and the formation of Pakistan in 1947.

Role in Partition and Formation of Pakistan:

- The Muslim League, under the leadership of Muhammad Ali Jinnah, played a crucial role in advocating for the partition of British India along religious lines.
- The League's demand for a separate nation for Muslims led to the creation of Pakistan as an independent state in 1947, alongside a separate Hindu-majority India.
- **Dominance in Post-Independence Politics:**
- Following the partition, the Muslim League became the dominant political party in the newly formed state of Pakistan.
- Jinnah served as Pakistan's first Governor-General and the Muslim League played a significant role in shaping the country's political landscape.

- The All India Muslim League played a pivotal role in mobilizing Muslim political consciousness and advocating for the creation of a separate Muslim state, which eventually led to the formation of Pakistan.

The All-India Muslim League played a crucial and complex role in the Indian independence movement. Founded in 1906, the League initially aimed to protect Muslim interests in a Hindu-majority India but eventually became a significant force advocating for the creation of Pakistan. The journey of the Muslim League from its inception to its pivotal role in the partition of India is marked by evolving strategies, shifting alliances, and significant contributions to the broader nationalist movement. Here's an essay detailing the Muslim League's role in Indian independence:

The Role of the Muslim League in Indian Independence

The All-India Muslim League, founded on December 30, 1906, in Dhaka, emerged as a key political organization in the Indian independence movement. Initially conceived to safeguard Muslim interests in a predominantly Hindu India, the League evolved over the decades to become a powerful advocate for the creation of Pakistan, fundamentally shaping the subcontinent's political landscape. The Muslim League's journey was marked by a transition from loyalty to the British Crown to a staunch demand for an independent Muslim state, playing a critical role in the partition of India in 1947.

Early Objectives and Formation

The Muslim League was established in response to growing concerns among Muslims about their political representation and socio-economic conditions. The founding members, including Nawab Salimullah of Dhaka, Sir Aga Khan III, and Nawab Mohsin-ul-Mulk, aimed to:

- Promote loyalty to the British government while advocating for Muslim rights.
- Secure separate electorates for Muslims to ensure their political representation.
- Foster unity and solidarity among Muslims across India.

The League's formation was significantly influenced by the success of the Simla Deputation in 1906, where Muslim leaders effectively lobbied the British Viceroy, Lord Minto, for separate electorates, highlighting the need for a unified Muslim political platform.

Advocacy and Early Political Engagement

In its early years, the Muslim League focused on advocating for Muslim interests within the colonial framework. The League supported British rule, believing that cooperation would lead to favorable outcomes for Muslims. It aimed to protect Muslim cultural, religious, and

educational interests, while also working to improve socio-economic conditions within the community.

The League's initial loyalty to the British Crown gradually gave way to a more nationalist outlook, particularly as the political climate in India changed. The Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms of 1919, which introduced limited self-governance, did not satisfy the aspirations of many Indians, including the League's leaders, leading to increased demands for more substantial political reforms.

Shift Towards Nationalism

The 1920s and 1930s were transformative decades for the Muslim League. Under the leadership of figures like Mohammad Ali Jinnah, the League began to assert itself more strongly in the Indian political arena. Jinnah, who had initially been a member of both the Congress and the League, increasingly found himself at odds with the Congress's policies and its leadership, particularly over issues of Muslim representation and safeguards.

Jinnah's efforts to unite various Muslim factions under the banner of the Muslim League were critical in strengthening the organization. The Lahore Resolution of 1940 marked a turning point, with the League formally adopting the demand for separate states for Muslims in the north-western and eastern zones of India, where they were in a majority. This resolution laid the groundwork for the eventual demand for Pakistan.

The League's Role in the Independence Movement

During the 1940s, the Muslim League's role in the independence movement became increasingly prominent. Key contributions and strategies included:

1. **Negotiations and Political Pressure:** The League participated in negotiations with the British government and the Indian National Congress, consistently advocating for Muslim interests. The Cripps Mission (1942), the Cabinet Mission Plan (1946), and the Simla Conference (1945) were notable instances where the League's demands significantly influenced the political discourse.
2. **Mass Mobilization:** Under Jinnah's leadership, the League successfully mobilized mass support among Muslims, particularly through the slogan "Islam in danger." The League's ability to galvanize widespread support was evident in the 1946 elections, where it won a majority of the Muslim seats, demonstrating its claim to be the sole representative of Indian Muslims.
3. **Direct Action Day:** On August 16, 1946, the League called for Direct Action Day to demand the creation of Pakistan, leading to widespread communal riots in Calcutta and other parts of India. This event underscored the deepening communal divide and the urgency of addressing Muslim demands.
4. **Negotiations Leading to Partition:** The League's persistent demand for a separate Muslim state eventually led to the partition of India. The failure of Congress and the

League to reach a consensus on power-sharing and the structure of post-independence India made partition inevitable. The League's insistence on Pakistan was realized on August 14, 1947, when India was divided into two sovereign states, India and Pakistan.

Legacy and Impact

The Muslim League's role in Indian independence is a subject of complex historical evaluation. On one hand, the League was instrumental in articulating and advocating for Muslim political aspirations, leading to the creation of Pakistan. On the other hand, the partition it championed resulted in significant upheaval, including communal violence, mass migrations, and enduring geopolitical tensions between India and Pakistan.

The League's legacy is therefore dual-faceted: it represents both the successful assertion of Muslim identity and political rights and the tragic consequences of communal division. The formation of Pakistan fulfilled the League's primary objective, but it also left a lasting impact on the subcontinent's socio-political fabric.

Conclusion

The formation and objectives of Muslim League are evidence of the political presence of Muslim community in India. It shows how Muslims were aware of India's situation and the various steps they took to support their community in India. The formation of the All-India Muslim League in 1906 marked a significant development in the political landscape of colonial India. It reflected the aspirations and concerns of the Muslim community and played a crucial role in shaping the trajectory of the Indian independence movement. The League's advocacy for separate electorates and its eventual demand for a separate Muslim state had profound and lasting impacts on the subcontinent's history, leading to the creation of Pakistan and reshaping the region's political and social fabric.

The All-India Muslim League played a pivotal role in the Indian independence movement by advocating for the political rights and interests of Muslims and ultimately demanding a separate Muslim state. Its evolution from a loyalist organization to a forceful proponent of partition highlights the dynamic and often contentious nature of Indian nationalism. The League's contributions, strategies, and the eventual creation of Pakistan remain integral to understanding the complex history of India's struggle for independence and the enduring legacy of partition.

The Muslim League's journey from its formation to its role in the partition of India

encapsulates a significant chapter in the history of Indian nationalism, marked by political advocacy, communal mobilization, and the quest for a distinct Muslim identity.

Muhammad Ali Jinnah

Muhammad Ali Jinnah, known as the "Quaid-e-Azam" or "Great Leader," was a pivotal figure in the history of the Indian subcontinent. His contributions to Indian nationalism and the eventual creation of Pakistan were profound and transformative. Jinnah's political journey is marked by his advocacy for Hindu-Muslim unity, his leadership in the All-India Muslim League, and his unwavering commitment to securing a separate nation for Muslims. Here is an essay detailing Muhammad Ali Jinnah's contributions to Indian nationalism:

Muhammad Ali Jinnah's Contribution to Indian Nationalism

Muhammad Ali Jinnah, a towering figure in South Asian history, played a crucial role in the Indian nationalist movement and the creation of Pakistan. His political career, marked by a transition from a staunch advocate of Hindu-Muslim unity to the leader of the demand for Pakistan, highlights his significant contributions to the nationalist cause and the eventual partition of India. Jinnah's legacy is complex and multifaceted, reflecting his profound impact on the subcontinent's political landscape.

Early Life and Initial Involvement in Politics

Born on December 25, 1876, in Karachi, Jinnah was educated in Bombay (now Mumbai) and later in London, where he trained as a barrister. His early political career was shaped by his association with the Indian National Congress (INC), where he emerged as a prominent leader advocating for constitutional reforms and Hindu-Muslim unity.

Advocate for Hindu-Muslim Unity

Jinnah initially joined the INC, believing in the possibility of a united India where Hindus and Muslims could coexist harmoniously. He was influenced by the liberal and secular ideas of leaders like Dadabhai Naoroji and Gopal Krishna Gokhale. Jinnah's efforts to bridge the communal divide were evident in his role in the Lucknow Pact of 1916, a significant agreement between the INC and the All-India Muslim League that advocated for greater self-governance and mutual cooperation between Hindus and Muslims.

Leadership in the Muslim League

Jinnah's disillusionment with the INC's increasingly Hindu-majoritarian stance led him to focus more on the Muslim League. By the late 1920s and early 1930s, he became the League's prominent leader, advocating for Muslim political rights and representation. Jinnah's leadership was marked by his insistence on safeguarding Muslim interests within the broader nationalist movement.

Lahore Resolution and the Demand for Pakistan

The turning point in Jinnah's political career came with the Lahore Resolution in 1940, where the Muslim League, under his leadership, formally demanded the creation of separate states for Muslims in the north-western and eastern zones of India. Jinnah articulated the vision of Pakistan as a separate homeland for Muslims, arguing that Hindus and Muslims were distinct nations with irreconcilable differences.

Contributions to Indian Nationalism

1. Political Advocacy and Representation:

- Jinnah was a tireless advocate for the political representation of Muslims. His efforts ensured that Muslim voices were heard in the colonial administration, and he played a key role in negotiating with the British government on issues related to Indian self-governance.

2. Negotiations with the British:

- Jinnah was a central figure in several critical negotiations with the British authorities. His participation in the Round Table Conferences and his engagement with the Cripps Mission and the Cabinet Mission Plan were instrumental in shaping the political discourse of the time.

3. Mass Mobilization:

- Jinnah's ability to mobilize the Muslim masses was unparalleled. His leadership transformed the Muslim League from a relatively obscure organization into a powerful political force that represented the aspirations of millions of Muslims across India.

4. Legal and Constitutional Reforms:

- As a trained lawyer, Jinnah emphasized legal and constitutional methods to achieve political objectives. His insistence on constitutionalism and the rule of law laid the groundwork for the future democratic framework of Pakistan.

5. Championing the Two-Nation Theory:

- Jinnah's articulation of the Two-Nation Theory was a significant contribution to Indian nationalism. He argued that Hindus and Muslims were distinct nations with their own identities, cultures, and aspirations. This theory became the ideological basis for the creation of Pakistan.

Legacy and Impact

Jinnah's contributions to Indian nationalism and the creation of Pakistan have left an indelible mark on the subcontinent. His leadership was instrumental in achieving a separate homeland for Muslims, leading to the birth of Pakistan on August 14, 1947. Jinnah's vision for Pakistan was that of a democratic and inclusive state where religious and cultural diversity would be respected.

However, Jinnah's legacy is also viewed through the lens of the partition's tragic aftermath, which saw widespread communal violence, displacement, and enduring tensions between India and Pakistan. The partition remains a contentious and emotional chapter in the history of the subcontinent.

Conclusion

Muhammad Ali Jinnah's contributions to Indian nationalism were profound and transformative. His journey from a proponent of Hindu-Muslim unity to the architect of Pakistan reflects his adaptability, political acumen, and unwavering commitment to securing a better future for Muslims in the Indian subcontinent. Jinnah's legacy continues to shape the socio-political dynamics of South Asia, making him a pivotal figure in the region's history. His vision and leadership not only led to the creation of Pakistan but also redefined the contours of nationalism in the subcontinent.

PARTITION AND INDEPENDENCE INTRODUCTION The Cabinet Mission Plan was accepted by both Congress and the Muslim League though both expected something better. The Congress did not like the provision of grouping the provinces. And the main grouse with the League was that it did not meet their demand for Pakistan. In July 1946 the election to the Constituent Assembly was held all over the country. The Congress secured 205 seats and the League captured 73 seats while the Sikhs got for themselves 4 seats. Thus counting upon the Sikh support the Congress got 209 seats in Assembly of 296 sets. This was naturally disturbing Mohammed Ali Jinnah, since his party was bound to be overwhelmingly overshadowed by the Congress in the Constituent Assembly. Driven by dismay and frustration the League took a resolution which came to be known as the direct Action Resolution and fixed 16 August 1946 as the day of direct Action on which date the biggest genocide took place in Calcutta which came to be known as the great Killing in Calcutta, Which was the capital city of Muslim province. In the hands of the Muslim fanatics the city was reduced into bloody samples. Atrocities of worst description were perpetrated upon the Hindu minorities in other parts of Bengal, of which the most conspicuous were Noakhali and Tipperah. Communal riots spread to Bihar, United Provinces and Bombay when the country was polarized between the Hindu Muslims a division of the country on the communal lines was in the air. It was in the midst of the communal frenzy that Viceroy invited Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, the Congress President to form the Interim Government and he assumed office on 2 September 1946. Although the Muslim League was also invited to join the interim Government it walked away from the Government. So the Interim Government

predominantly was Hindu in composition with the following members Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, Dr. Rajendra Prasad, Chakravarty, Rajagopalchari, Dr. John Mathai, Sardar Ballav Singh, Sir Shafat Ahmad Khan, Jagivan Ram, Syed Ali Zaheer, C.H. Bhabha, Asaf Ali and Sarat Chandra Bose. Although the Muslim League refused to join the ministry at the request of the Viceroy the League changed their decision and on 26 October 1946 five members of the League were inducted in the ministry. They were Liaquat Ali Khan, Ghazanfar Ali Khan, Abdul Rab Nishtar, I.I. Chundrigar and Jogendra Nath Mandal (Scheduled Caste). To accommodate the new ministers in the Interim Government three Congress ministers resigned. They were Sarat Chandra Bose, Syed Ali Zaheer and Sir Shafaat Ahmad Khan. But the inclusion of the League members in the ministry made the Interim Government a house divided and a ship directed in opposite directions. Pandit Nehru did not fight shy to openly declare that the League pursued their aim to enlist British support and tried to establish themselves the King's Party. It may be pointed out that although the League joined the Interim Government, it refused to participate in the Constituent Assembly, Thus the Constituent Assembly had to function minus the League. It met for the first time on 9 December 1946 at New Delhi. It elected Dr. Rajendra Prasad its President on 11 December 1946. After two days Pandit Nehru moved his famous objective Resolutions that was passed by the Assembly on 22 January 1947. According to the resolution passed by the Assembly India was pledged to become independent Sovereign Republic.

4.11.1 Attlee's Announcement for Transfer of Power

The English Government at London was unhappy at the growing difference among the Indian political parties that were hampering the functioning of the Constituent Assembly. The English Prime Minister Clement Attlee made the famous announcement on 20 February 1947 that his Majesty's Government wish to make clear that it is their definite intention to take necessary steps to effect the transference of power to responsible Indian hands by June 1948. Evidently Attlee was worried at the persistent negative role played by the Muslim League in the Constituent Assembly. If the League did not change their stand in boycotting the Constituent Assembly the Government in London might decide to whom the power of the Central Government in British India should be handed over as a whole or in part or if necessary to the provincial government. It was, therefore, clear from the declaration of Attlee that the Government at London might allow partition of the country by June 1948 so as to enable it to transfer power by the deadline. In this way the Cripps Mission Plan was at last acceptable and the postdated cheque was at last honoured by the Crashing bank i.e. the British Empire. The immediate reaction of the Muslim League was a raging fight to set on motion the fanatic monster of Pakistan on the Indian scene and it unleashed violence in Assam, Bengal, North West Frontier Provinces and the Punjab. Since Attlee's declaration suggested that power would be handed over to the provincial government, the League was out to dislodge the anti-League ministries in Assam, North West Frontier provinces and the Punjab by creating disturbances and chaotic conditions. The League was crowned with success in the Punjab where the Governor took over the administration under Section 93 the Government of India Act of 1935. But the Leagues dream did not come true in Assam and the North West Frontier provinces. It was now gaining ground for division of the country, since that was considered the only way out to avoid disturbances and chaos that had rendered the unity and integration of the country.

4.11.2 Mountbatten Plan

The Penultimate Viceroy Lord Wavell was replaced by a more

dynamic Lord Mountbatten who was destined to hand down British India in the hands of the Indians which was not an easy task. The new Viceroy was known for his facts, energy and determination. Immediately after his arrival in India he started dialogue with the representatives of the different political parties. In view of the communal holocaust that beset the country the Congress leader against their will had to accept the partition of the country, particularly when the Muslim League would not budge an inch from their demand for Pakistan. It was an uphill task for the new Viceroy Mountbatten to shuffle the cards to the satisfaction of all the players in the game. The blueprint for partition was handed down by Mountbatten on 3 June 1947. This is known as the Mountbatten Plan and this was the basis along which the transfer of power was effected by the English Government to the Indians. The Preamble of the plan was couched in the following words it is not the intention of His Majesty's Government to interrupt the work of the existing Constituent Assembly. It is clear that any Constitution framed by this Assembly cannot apply to those parts of the country which are unwilling to accept it. His Majesty's Government are satisfied that the procedure outlined below embodies the best practical method of ascertaining the wishes of the people of such areas on the issue whether their constitution is to be framed... (a) in the existing Constituent Assembly or (b) in a new and separate Constituent Assembly consisting of the representative of those areas which decide not to participate in the existing Constituent Assembly. When this is done it will be possible to determine the authority or authorities to whom power should be transferred. The main features of the Mountbatten Plan were as follows: If the people of the Muslim majority areas so desire, they would be allowed to form a separate Dominion. A new Constituent Assembly would be constituted for that purpose. The provincial Assemblies of the Punjab and Bengal were to meet in two parts, one representing the Muslim majority districts and the other representing the rest of the province. The members of the two parts of each Legislative Assembly sitting separately will be empowered to vote whether or not the province should be partitioned. If a simple majority of either part decides in favour of partition, will take place and arrangements would be made accordingly. The Legislative Assembly of Sindh would decide as whether its constitution would be framed by the existing or a new and separate Constituent Assembly. In view of its special position a referendum would take place in the North West Frontier Province to ascertain whether it would join Pakistan or remain in India. In case of partition of Bengal there would be a referendum in the district of Sylhet (Assam) to ascertain whether the people would join Pakistan or remain in India. In case of partition of the Punjab and Bengal a Boundary Commission would be set up to demarcate the exact boundary line. Legislation would be introduced in the current session of the parliament of England for the transfer of power in 1947 on a Dominion Status basis to one or two successor authorities according to the decision taken under the plan. This will be without prejudice to the right of the Constituent Assemblies to decide in due course whether the parts of India which they represent will remain within the British Commonwealth. As a matter of fact, the partition of the country and the Indian Independence Act of 1947 proceeded on the rocky path paved by the Mountbatten Plan of 3 June 1947. Thus the Cripps proposal to transfer power did not mention any date but the Mountbatten Plan did it instantly. Thus the post-dated cheque on the crashing bank was honoured on 15 August 1947.

4.11.3 The Indian Independence Act, 1947 As a follow-up measure of the Mountbatten Plan

came the Indian Independence Act of 1947 which was the swan song of the English parliament's legislative jurisdiction over India. As the Mountbatten's plan of 3 June 1947 was accepted by both the Congress and the Muslim League the English government went ahead to transfer power in India to the Indian hands. A legislation was necessary in the British parliament for that purpose. So on 4 July 1947 the Indian Independence Bill was introduced in the parliament of England and within a fortnight's time it was made into an Act on 18 July 1947. It should be remembered that the Act of 1947 did not introduce any new constitution for India. It was rather an enabling legislation for the representatives of both India and Pakistan to frame their own constitutions to provide for the exceedingly difficult period of transition. As a matter of fact, the Act of 1947 gave a legal coating to Mountbatten's plan of 3 June, 1947. When the Act was on its anvil England's prime minister Clement Attlee said; it is the culminating point in a long course of events the Act of 1935, the declaration at the time of the Cripps Mission, are all steps in the road that led up eventually to the proposals that I announced to the House on 3rd June. This basis is designed to implement these proposals. Two independent Dominions, known respectively as India and Pakistan, shall be set up as from the 15th day of August, 1947. The territories of the two Dominions were defined in such terms that Pakistan was to comprise Sindh, British Baluchistan, N.W.F.P., the west Punjab and East Bengal, it being understood that the exact boundary of the last two would be determined by a boundary. For each of the new dominions, there shall be a Governor-General who shall be appointed by His Majesty and shall represent His Majesty for the purposes of the Government of the Dominion. Provided that, unless and until provision to the contrary is made by a law of the Legislature of either of the new Dominions, the same person may be Governor-General of both the new Dominions. The Legislature of each of the Dominions shall have full power to make laws for that Dominion, and no Act of Parliament of the United Kingdom, nor shall any order in Council passed after 15 August, 1947, have any validity in either of the two Dominions. In short, the jurisdiction of the British Parliament over India will cease from that date. With effect from 15 August, 1947, His Majesty's Government will cease to have any responsibility for the Government of British India and all treaties and agreements between His Majesty's Government and the rulers of Indian States or any authority in tribal areas shall lapse. The words Emperor of India shall be omitted from the Royal style and Titles.

The Constituent Assembly of each Dominion shall exercise the powers of the Central Legislature and the existing Central Legislative Assembly and the Council of States would be automatically dissolved. The Governor-General was vested with all power and authority necessary for bringing the Indian Independence Act into effective operation. Provision was made for safeguarding the interest of the existing officers in India appointed by the Secretary of State, who shall not, of course, have power of making any such appointments in future. Provision was made for the division of the Indian Army between the new Dominions which will exercise authority over them. As to the other forces of His Majesty in India, they will continue to be under the jurisdiction and authority of His Majesty's government in the United Kingdom. Transitory provisions were made for the continuance of the functions exercised by the Secretary of State and the Auditor of Indian Home Accounts. Aden, so long administered by the Government of India, was placed directly under the administration of the British Government.

4.11.4 Partition of India and the Freedom at Midnight

The Mountbatten plan of

3rd June, 1947 was accepted by all the major parties in India. The congress accepted it under duress and to avoid more bloodshed and the Sikhs ultimately agreed to it since it was unavoidable. But there was jubilation in the Muslim League camp, though Mohammed Ali Jinnah said that they were thrusting a moth-eaten Pakistan down the Muslim throat yet he was happy since he did not fight shy to admit that he never dreamt Pakistan coming into existence in his life time. Both the Punjab and Bengal Assemblies voted for partition and it became necessary to decide what would be the boundary of the two provinces. so Lord Mountbatten appointed a Boundary commission to go into the question and asked Redcliff to complete the task as early as possible. west Bengal and East Punjab remained in India and East Bengal and West Punjab joined Pakistan. There was referendum in the Sylhet district of Assam and it voted for Pakistan. Sindh opted for Pakistan. The North west Frontier province by a referendum chose to go to Pakistan. so Jinnah who wanted to get into Pakistan the whole of Assam, Bengal and Punjab rather what he called a truncated Pakistan. But this was a big premium India had to pay for freedom and independence from the English rule. On 15 August 1947 when power was transferred, Mahatma Gandhi, stayed away at Calcutta and described the independence as a sorry affair. One day earlier on 14 August 1947 Pakistan came into being. Although India was free to choose her own Governor-General as the constitutional head, the Indian leader decided that it would be better to make a sudden change and felt that the appointment of Lord Mountbatten would give continuity of policy and administration. It was also thought that Pakistan would reciprocate the same feeling. But at the last moment the Muslim League caused a surprise by appointing Jinnah the Governor-General of Pakistan. A special session of the constituent Assembly of the Indian union was held at Delhi on the midnight of 14 August 1947 'The great moment for which the nation had struggled so long at last came true. Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru in his memorable address to the constituent Assembly and to the nation said at the stroke of the midnight hour, when the world sleeps, India will awake of life and freedom A moment comes which comes but rarely in history, when we step out from the old to the new. The feeling of the nation was one mixed with joy and sorrow. It was indeed rejoicing to get back the independence' It was a matter of sorrow to see the plight of millions of brothers of East Bengal and west Punjab groaning under the weight of Pakistan not compelled to take refuge in India to find a new living. Mahatma Gandhi, the father of the nation was unhappy. In the conversation with Lord Mountbatten he expressed his unhappiness with the partition of the country.

The last phase of the Indian freedom movement was bathed in blood as serious riots broke out in the Punjab, making it plain that both East and west Punjab were determined to go their respective ways. If Jinnah wants his pound of flesh, then he cannot have a single Hindu in his new dominion' The Hindus of the East Punjab the Muslims of the west Punjab virtually affected a violent and bloody transfer of their respective populations of their territories. Train loads of migrants were slaughtered in both the Punjab till the fury subsided in March 1948. In October 1947 raiders of the N.W.F.P. poured in the valleys of Kashmir, thus commencing the Kashmir operations which ceased when Nehru on 1st January magnanimously but mistakenly agreed to a cease-fire arranged through the United Nation at a time when our gallant Jawans were in a position to clear off the Kashmir valley of all Pakistani intruders. This wrong decision froze the situation in Kashmir. Pakistan tried to alter the boundaries by force in 1965 and in 1971 but both these attempts failed reluctantly Pakistan agreed to the

actual line of control in 1972 in Simla after the Bangladesh war. Today the so-called Kashmir Question continues to poison the Indo-Pakistani relations. However, this phase of uneasy peace between the two neighbours continues. India and Pakistan, the two independent nations created from the same embryo of mother India in 1947, after ninety years (1857-1947) of heroic freedom struggle are today poised to enter the 21st century. May the spirit of peace continue to guide both the leaders and the people of both countries?

4.11.5 Concerning Indian Independence, besides other, two assumptions need to be reviewed by the scholars. One, the struggle for Indian Independence was fought only under the leadership of Congress. Second, Independence was achieved by non violent means. Both contentions have partial truth. Of course, the Congress remained in the forefront of struggle. But different other groups also contributed towards it. Different organized groups of peasants and labours protested against the policies of the government and thus, strengthened the national movement. The socialist and communist groups had also come into existence as far back as 1920 and propagated socialist ideas. Even within the Congress, there was a large group of people and leaders who had sincere feelings towards socialism. Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru was also one among them. Most of these groups remained with the Congress to put up a united challenge to British imperialism till Indian Independence. Their contribution has been mostly ignored. But certainly, many of them served useful purpose in the cause of Independence. The same way, the Indian national movement mostly adhered to non-violent means under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi. But violence too was involved in the national movement at frequent intervals and affected favourably the course of Indian Independence.

The activities of the revolutionaries and terrorists inspired the Indians and prepared them to sacrifice their lives in fighting against oppression. Even the votaries of nonviolence were influenced by the sacrifice of these people. The same way the 'Quit India Movement' was violent and stirred the government to think afresh and out. The contribution of the Indian National Army under the leadership of Subhash Chandra Bose can not also be neglected. The spirit of defiance shown by the Indian Navy and Air Force in the last stage of the movement also affected the British attitude towards the Indian Independence. Thus, violence had joined hands with non-violence many times in the national movement and influenced its course favourably to the cause of Indian Independence. The Independence came, legally as an Act of Parliament, but it was the consummation of a long course of suffering and struggle by the people of India. International forces, the condition of the United Kingdom as a result of war, - as well as the leadership of Gandhiji who prepared the nation for unlimited sacrifice, helped the attainment of independence. The stage was cleared of obstacles and the ground was free for the new national government, without hindrance to bring about social and economic freedom and build up a strong and prosperous nation. The new Constitution of India which was prepared by the Constituent Assembly, came into force on 26 January 1950 and provides a legal frame work for the implementation of the socio-economic programme of the Indian National Congress and thus give meaning and substance to freedom of India.

The Partition of Bengal (1905-1911)

The Partition of Bengal in 1905 was one of the most controversial and impactful events in the history of British India. Announced by the British colonial authorities, it was ostensibly a move to improve administrative efficiency in the densely populated and vast province of Bengal. However, the partition had far-reaching political, social, and cultural implications, leading to significant upheaval and resistance. This essay explores the background, motives, reactions, and consequences of the Partition of Bengal.

Background and Motives of the Partition of Bengal (1905)

The Partition of Bengal in 1905 was one of the most significant and controversial administrative decisions taken by the British colonial authorities in India. Announced by Viceroy Lord Curzon, the partition aimed to reorganize the extensive province of Bengal for improved administrative efficiency. However, it also served broader political and strategic objectives that aligned with the colonial policy of "divide and rule." The background and motives behind the partition are multifaceted, encompassing administrative, economic, and political dimensions.

Background

Size and Diversity of Bengal

By the early 20th century, Bengal was the largest and most populous province in British India, with over 80 million inhabitants. The province encompassed present-day West Bengal, Bangladesh, Bihar, and parts of Odisha. Its vast size and demographic diversity presented significant administrative challenges.

Economic Importance

Bengal was an economic powerhouse, known for its fertile land and thriving industries, especially jute and textiles. Calcutta (now Kolkata), the provincial capital, was a major commercial and cultural center, contributing significantly to the colonial economy.

Motives

Administrative Efficiency

The official rationale for the partition was to enhance administrative efficiency. The British argued that governing such a large and diverse province was unwieldy and hindered effective administration and development. By splitting Bengal, the British aimed to create smaller, more manageable administrative units.

1. East Bengal and Assam:

- This new province would have a population of approximately 31 million, with Dhaka as its capital. It was intended to include the Muslim-majority areas, which were seen as underdeveloped and in need of focused governance.

2. West Bengal:

- The remaining part, with Calcutta as its capital, would include the Hindu-majority areas. This reorganization was intended to facilitate better governance and economic development.

Political Strategy: Divide and Rule

A significant motive behind the partition was the British colonial policy of "divide and rule." By creating separate provinces based on religious demographics, the British aimed to:

1. Weaken Nationalist Movement:

- Bengal was a hotbed of nationalist activity, with a burgeoning middle class and intellectual community advocating for self-governance. By partitioning Bengal, the British hoped to disrupt the growing unity and strength of the nationalist movement, particularly the Indian National Congress (INC).

2. Foster Communal Divisions:

- The British sought to create divisions between the Hindu and Muslim populations. By establishing a Muslim-majority East Bengal and a Hindu-majority West Bengal, the colonial authorities aimed to foster communal tensions that would divert attention from the anti-colonial struggle and weaken the united front of Indian nationalism.

Economic and Social Motives

The economic and social landscape of Bengal also influenced the decision to partition:

1. Economic Development:

- The British argued that the partition would facilitate targeted economic development. East Bengal, with its Muslim-majority population, was considered economically backward compared to the more developed West Bengal. The reorganization was presented as a means to focus administrative resources and development efforts on the underdeveloped eastern regions.

2. Social Dynamics:

- There was a perception among British administrators that the Hindu elite in Bengal dominated both the economic and social spheres, often to the detriment of the Muslim population. The partition was thus justified as a means to address these imbalances and provide better opportunities for Muslims in East Bengal.

Immediate Reaction and Implementation

On July 20, 1905, Viceroy Lord Curzon formally announced the partition, which came into effect on October 16, 1905. The immediate reaction to the partition was one of widespread opposition, particularly from the Hindu population in Bengal. The announcement sparked significant political unrest and gave rise to the Swadeshi Movement, which advocated for the

boycott of British goods and the promotion of indigenous industries. Leaders like Surendranath Banerjee and Rabindranath Tagore spearheaded protests, petitions, and public demonstrations against the partition.

The Partition of Bengal in 1905 was driven by a combination of administrative, economic, and political motives. While the official rationale focused on improving governance and development, the underlying strategic objective was to weaken the growing nationalist movement and create communal divisions. The partition had profound and far-reaching consequences, galvanizing nationalist sentiments and laying the groundwork for future communal conflicts. The strong resistance it evoked eventually led to its reversal in 1911, but the episode left an indelible mark on the history of India's struggle for independence.

1. Administrative Challenges:

- By the early 20th century, the province of Bengal was the largest in British India, with a population of over 80 million people. It included present-day West Bengal, Bangladesh, Bihar, and parts of Orissa. The sheer size and diversity of the province posed significant administrative challenges for the British.

2. Economic Considerations:

- Bengal was a major economic hub, with its rich resources and thriving industries, particularly jute and textiles. The British sought to enhance administrative efficiency to better manage economic activities and revenue collection.

3. Political Motives:

- The British were increasingly wary of the growing nationalist sentiments in Bengal. The region was a hotbed of political activity, with a burgeoning middle class and an active intellectual community advocating for self-governance. The partition was seen as a way to curb the rising tide of nationalism by dividing and weakening the cohesive political force.

4. Communal Strategy:

- The British employed a "divide and rule" policy, aiming to create divisions between the Hindu and Muslim populations. By partitioning Bengal along religious lines, the British hoped to foster communal tensions that would divert attention from the anti-colonial struggle.

Implementation and Division of Bengal

The implementation and division of Bengal in 1905 were significant events in the history of British India, marked by both administrative changes and widespread political and social repercussions. The process of dividing Bengal was announced by Viceroy Lord Curzon and came into effect on October 16, 1905. This section explores the specifics of the division, the administrative restructuring, and the immediate aftermath of the partition.

Administrative Implementation

Announcement by Lord Curzon

On July 20, 1905, Viceroy Lord Curzon formally announced the partition of Bengal. The announcement outlined the creation of two new provinces, aiming to address the administrative inefficiencies of managing such a vast and populous region.

The New Provinces

1. East Bengal and Assam:

- **Capital:** Dhaka
- **Population:** Approximately 31 million
- **Demographics:** Predominantly Muslim-majority areas
- **Regions Included:** Eastern Bengal, Assam, Chittagong, Rajshahi, and the hill tracts of Assam

2. West Bengal:

- **Capital:** Calcutta (now Kolkata)
- **Population:** Approximately 49 million
- **Demographics:** Predominantly Hindu-majority areas
- **Regions Included:** Western Bengal, Bihar, Orissa, and parts of Chota Nagpur

The rationale for the division was to create two smaller, more manageable administrative units, with East Bengal and Assam focusing on the eastern and northeastern territories and West Bengal managing the western regions.

Division and Implementation

Formal Division

The formal division of Bengal took effect on October 16, 1905. The implementation process involved:

1. Administrative Restructuring:

- New administrative capitals were established in Dhaka for East Bengal and Assam and maintained in Calcutta for West Bengal.
- Government offices and departments were reorganized to cater to the new provincial structures.
- Officials were reassigned, and new administrative posts were created to manage the separate provinces effectively.

2. Economic Adjustments:

- The economic policies were tailored to address the specific needs of the two regions.
- Efforts were made to promote economic development in the underdeveloped regions of East Bengal, including investments in infrastructure and industry.

3. Educational and Cultural Changes:

- Educational policies were adjusted to reflect the new administrative boundaries.
- Cultural institutions were encouraged to develop regional identities aligned with the new provincial divisions.

Immediate Reaction and Political Unrest

Opposition from the Indian National Congress (INC)

The partition was met with fierce opposition from the Indian National Congress (INC) and various nationalist leaders. Key points of contention included:

1. Perceived Divide and Rule Tactics:

- Nationalist leaders viewed the partition as a deliberate attempt by the British to divide and weaken the growing nationalist movement.
- The INC argued that the partition was a strategy to create divisions between Hindus and Muslims, thereby preventing a united front against colonial rule.

2. Public Protests and Boycotts:

- Massive protests were organized across Bengal, with public meetings, rallies, and demonstrations becoming common.
- The Swadeshi Movement, advocating for the boycott of British goods and the promotion of indigenous industries, gained momentum. People burned British goods, and there was a renewed emphasis on self-reliance and the use of Indian-made products.

Cultural and Emotional Impact

1. Rabindranath Tagore's Involvement:

- The renowned poet Rabindranath Tagore played a significant role in opposing the partition. He composed songs and poems to inspire unity and resistance against the British move.
- Tagore initiated the Rakhi Bandhan ceremony, where Hindus and Muslims tied rakhis (sacred threads) on each other's wrists as a symbol of solidarity and brotherhood.

2. Widespread Unrest:

- The partition led to widespread political unrest, with students, intellectuals, and the general public participating in the anti-partition movement.
- The protests saw significant participation from women and youth, marking a broad-based mobilization against colonial policies.

Consequences and Reversal

Long-term Impact on Nationalism

1. Strengthening of the Nationalist Movement:

- The opposition to the partition galvanized the nationalist movement, leading to increased political awareness and activism across India.
- The Swadeshi Movement, in particular, marked a shift towards economic nationalism and self-reliance, which became enduring themes in the Indian struggle for independence.

2. **Communal Tensions:**

- The partition exacerbated communal tensions between Hindus and Muslims, laying the groundwork for future conflicts. The initial support among some Muslims for the partition created a divide that influenced later political developments, including the demand for separate electorates and eventually the partition of India in 1947.

Reversal of the Partition

Due to the intense opposition and widespread unrest, the British government eventually decided to annul the partition. On December 12, 1911, during the Delhi Durbar, King George V announced the reunification of Bengal. The provinces were reorganized as follows:

1. **Reunification of Bengal:**

- Bengal was reunited, although the administrative capitals and some boundaries were adjusted.
- Bihar and Orissa were separated from Bengal to form a new province, further refining administrative efficiency.

2. **Shift of the Capital:**

- The capital of British India was moved from Calcutta to Delhi, symbolizing a new administrative focus and reducing the political significance of Bengal.

The implementation and division of Bengal in 1905 were significant events with far-reaching consequences. While the British aimed to improve administrative efficiency and curb the growing nationalist sentiment, the partition instead ignited a powerful resistance movement, uniting diverse sections of Indian society against colonial rule. The strong opposition eventually forced the British to reverse the partition in 1911, but the episode left a lasting impact on the political and communal landscape of the Indian subcontinent. The Partition of Bengal remains a pivotal moment in the history of India's struggle for independence, highlighting the complexities of colonial policies and the resilience of the nationalist movement.

1. **Lord Curzon's Announcement:**

- On July 20, 1905, Viceroy Lord Curzon announced the partition of Bengal, which came into effect on October 16, 1905. The province was divided into two parts:
 - **East Bengal and Assam:** A Muslim-majority area with Dhaka as its capital.

- **West Bengal:** A Hindu-majority area with Calcutta (now Kolkata) as its capital.

2. **Rationale:**

- The official rationale for the partition was administrative efficiency. Curzon argued that the vastness of Bengal made it difficult to govern effectively and that the division would allow for better governance and development.

Reactions and Resistance

1. **Opposition from the Indian National Congress (INC):**

- The INC vehemently opposed the partition, viewing it as a deliberate attempt to divide and weaken the nationalist movement. Leaders like Surendranath Banerjee spearheaded the anti-partition campaign, organizing protests, petitions, and boycotts.

2. **Swadeshi Movement:**

- The opposition to the partition gave rise to the Swadeshi Movement, which called for the boycott of British goods and the promotion of indigenous industries. The movement gained widespread support, with mass rallies, demonstrations, and the burning of British goods becoming common.

3. **Cultural and Emotional Impact:**

- The partition was seen as an affront to Bengali identity and culture. For many, it was a violation of their homeland, leading to a strong emotional response. Rabindranath Tagore, the renowned poet, composed songs and poems to inspire unity and resistance.

4. **Muslim Perspective:**

- While many Muslims initially supported the partition, seeing it as an opportunity for better representation and opportunities in East Bengal, the communal divisions it fostered ultimately had detrimental effects on Hindu-Muslim relations.

Consequences and Reversal

1. **Rise of Nationalism:**

- The partition galvanized nationalist sentiments across India, transforming the freedom struggle into a mass movement. The Swadeshi Movement, in particular, marked a significant shift towards economic nationalism and self-reliance.

2. **Communal Tensions:**

- The partition exacerbated communal tensions, planting the seeds for future conflicts between Hindus and Muslims. The initial support among Muslims for the partition created a divide that would later influence the demand for separate electorates and, eventually, the partition of India in 1947.

3. **Reversal of Partition:**

- Due to the intense opposition and widespread unrest, the British government decided to annul the partition. On December 12, 1911, during the Delhi Durbar, King George V announced the reunification of Bengal. The provinces were reorganized, with Bihar and Orissa being separated from Bengal, and the capital of British India was shifted from Calcutta to Delhi.

Conclusion

The Partition of Bengal was a defining moment in the history of British India. While it was presented as an administrative measure, its underlying motives were deeply political, aimed at curbing the growing nationalist movement and fostering communal divisions. The strong resistance it evoked highlighted the Indian populace's capacity for mass mobilization and the depth of nationalist sentiment. The eventual reversal of the partition was a significant victory for the Indian nationalists, but the communal seeds sown during this period had long-lasting repercussions, influencing the trajectory of the subcontinent's history. The Partition of Bengal remains a powerful reminder of the complexities and challenges of colonial rule and the enduring struggle for unity and self-determination.

Unit 4-

Extremist phase :

I. Rise and Development of extremist in India

II. Swadeshi Movement.

III. Congress split in Surat

IV. congress unification and Muslim League pact

The Rise and Development of Extremists in India

The rise of extremist nationalism in India during the late 19th and early 20th centuries marked a significant shift in the Indian struggle for independence. This period saw the emergence of a more radical approach to colonial resistance, diverging from the moderate strategies that had previously dominated the Indian National Congress (INC). The extremists, or radicals, advocated for more direct action against British rule, emphasizing self-reliance, Swaraj (self-rule), and the use of revolutionary tactics. This essay explores the factors that contributed to the rise of extremist nationalism, key figures in the movement, and its impact on the broader freedom struggle.

Factors Contributing to the Rise of Extremist Nationalism

Dissatisfaction with Moderate Policies

1. Limited Success of Moderates:

- The early years of the INC were dominated by moderate leaders like Dadabhai Naoroji, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, and Surendranath Banerjee. They believed in gradual reforms, dialogue with the British authorities, and constitutional methods to achieve self-governance.
- Despite their efforts, the moderates achieved limited success. The British response to their petitions and reforms was often dismissive, leading to growing frustration among younger nationalists.

2. Lack of Immediate Results:

- The slow pace of reforms and the lack of tangible results from moderate strategies led many to believe that a more aggressive approach was necessary to attain independence.

Economic Exploitation and Social Issues

1. Economic Hardships:

- The economic policies of the British, including heavy taxation, drain of wealth, and exploitation of Indian resources, caused widespread poverty and hardship among the Indian populace.
- Famines, economic stagnation, and the adverse impact of British economic policies fueled discontent and anger against colonial rule.

2. Social Reforms and Cultural Revival:

- The socio-religious reform movements of the 19th century, such as the Brahmo Samaj, Arya Samaj, and the works of leaders like Swami Vivekananda, emphasized cultural revival and self-respect.
- These movements instilled a sense of pride in India's cultural heritage and inspired a younger generation to fight against colonial subjugation.

Influence of Global Events

1. International Movements:

- The success of the Japanese in the Russo-Japanese War (1904-1905) demonstrated that an Asian power could defeat a European power, inspiring Indian nationalists.
- Revolutionary movements in Ireland, Russia, and other parts of the world also influenced Indian extremists, providing models for armed struggle and revolutionary tactics.

2. Impact of World War I:

- The global conflict and the subsequent promise of self-governance by the British raised hopes but also led to disillusionment when the promises were not fulfilled adequately.

Key Figures and Developments

Bal Gangadhar Tilak

1. Advocate of Swaraj:

- Tilak, often referred to as the "Father of Indian Unrest," was a prominent leader who demanded immediate self-rule (Swaraj) and declared, "Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it."
- He advocated for direct action, boycotts, and passive resistance against British policies.

2. Role in the Extremist Movement:

- Tilak played a crucial role in popularizing the use of festivals, like Ganesh Chaturthi and Shivaji Jayanti, to mobilize masses and instill a sense of national pride.
- His editorials in newspapers like Kesari and Maratha were instrumental in spreading nationalist ideas and rallying support for the extremist cause.

Bipin Chandra Pal

1. Propagator of Nationalist Ideas:

- Pal was a key figure in the extremist wing, known for his fiery speeches and writings that emphasized the need for self-reliance and direct action.
- He was a strong advocate of the Swadeshi Movement, promoting the use of Indian-made goods and the boycott of British products.

Lala Lajpat Rai

1. Leader in Punjab:

- Lajpat Rai, known as the "Lion of Punjab," was a prominent leader who emphasized the need for vigorous resistance against British rule.
- He played a significant role in mobilizing people through his writings and leadership in various nationalist movements.

Impact on the Indian Freedom Struggle

Swadeshi and Boycott Movements

1. Economic Nationalism:

- The Swadeshi Movement, which emerged in response to the Partition of Bengal in 1905, was a significant manifestation of extremist strategies. It called for the boycott of British goods and the promotion of indigenous industries.
- The movement gained widespread support, leading to the establishment of Swadeshi enterprises, schools, and institutions, fostering economic self-reliance.

Revolutionary Activities

1. Formation of Secret Societies:

- The extremists were involved in forming secret societies like the Anushilan Samiti and the Jugantar group, which aimed to organize armed resistance and revolutionary activities.
- These societies carried out bombings, assassinations, and other acts of violence against British officials, aiming to instill fear and destabilize colonial administration.

2. Prominent Revolutionaries:

- Figures like Aurobindo Ghosh, Bhagat Singh, and Chandrasekhar Azad emerged from the extremist movement, inspiring future generations of revolutionaries.

Conclusion

The rise and development of extremist nationalism in India marked a pivotal phase in the country's struggle for independence. Driven by dissatisfaction with moderate policies, economic exploitation, social reform movements, and global influences, the extremists advocated for more radical and direct methods of resistance. Leaders like Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal, and Lala Lajpat Rai played crucial roles in mobilizing masses, promoting economic nationalism, and organizing revolutionary activities. While the extremist movement had its challenges and controversies, it significantly contributed to the broader nationalist movement, inspiring future generations and adding momentum to the fight for India's freedom.

The Swadeshi Movement in India

The Swadeshi Movement, which emerged in the early 20th century, marked a significant phase in the Indian struggle for independence. It was a direct response to the British colonial policies, particularly the partition of Bengal in 1905, and aimed at promoting self-reliance and economic self-sufficiency. The movement advocated for the boycott of British goods and the promotion of indigenous industries. This essay explores the origins, development, strategies, and impact of the Swadeshi Movement in India.

Origins of the Swadeshi Movement

Partition of Bengal

1. Administrative Reorganization:

- The Partition of Bengal, announced by Viceroy Lord Curzon in 1905, divided the province into East Bengal and Assam (with a Muslim majority) and West Bengal (with a Hindu majority). The official rationale was administrative efficiency, but it was widely perceived as a British tactic to divide and weaken the growing nationalist movement.

2. Nationalist Opposition:

- The partition sparked immediate and widespread opposition among the Indian populace, particularly in Bengal. Nationalist leaders saw it as an attempt to sow communal discord and undermine the unity of the Indian people.

Emergence of Swadeshi Ideals

1. Economic Nationalism:

- The Swadeshi Movement, derived from the Sanskrit word "Swadeshi," meaning "of one's own country," emphasized the need for self-reliance and economic independence. It called for the boycott of British goods and the revival of indigenous industries.

2. Influence of Moderates and Extremists:

- Both moderate and extremist factions within the Indian National Congress (INC) supported the movement. Leaders like Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal, Lala Lajpat Rai, and Aurobindo Ghosh played pivotal roles in propagating Swadeshi ideals.

Development and Strategies of the Swadeshi Movement

Boycott of British Goods

1. Economic Boycott:

- The movement urged Indians to boycott British goods, including textiles, salt, and other manufactured products. This economic boycott aimed to hurt British economic interests and promote indigenous industries.

2. Promotion of Indigenous Products:

- Swadeshi advocates encouraged the use of Indian-made products, such as khadi (handspun cloth), and the revival of traditional crafts and industries. This fostered economic self-reliance and supported local artisans and craftsmen.

Mass Mobilization and Public Campaigns

1. Public Meetings and Rallies:

- Leaders organized public meetings, rallies, and processions to spread the message of Swadeshi and mobilize mass support. These events often included speeches, songs, and slogans that inspired patriotism and unity.

2. Cultural Activities:

- Cultural programs, including the organization of festivals like Ganesh Chaturthi and Shivaji Jayanti, were used to foster a sense of national pride and unity. These events provided a platform to spread nationalist ideas and promote Swadeshi principles.

Educational Reforms

1. National Schools and Colleges:

- The movement led to the establishment of national educational institutions, such as the Bengal National College, which focused on imparting education rooted in Indian culture and values. These institutions aimed to develop a sense of national consciousness among the youth.

2. Rejection of British Education:

- There was a conscious effort to boycott British educational institutions and curricula, which were seen as tools of colonial domination. Nationalist leaders advocated for an education system that reflected India's cultural heritage and promoted self-reliance.

Industrial and Economic Initiatives

1. Swadeshi Enterprises:

- The movement encouraged the establishment of Swadeshi enterprises and industries, such as textile mills, soap factories, and match factories, which produced goods using local resources and labor.

2. Cooperative Societies:

- Cooperative societies and banks were established to provide financial support to Swadeshi enterprises and help them compete with British businesses.

Impact of the Swadeshi Movement

Political Impact

1. Strengthening Nationalism:

- The Swadeshi Movement significantly strengthened the nationalist sentiment in India. It brought together people from different regions, religions, and social backgrounds in a united struggle against colonial rule.
- 2. **Rise of Extremist Nationalism:**
 - The movement marked the rise of extremist nationalism, with leaders like Tilak and Aurobindo advocating for more radical and direct methods of resistance. This shift in approach laid the groundwork for future revolutionary activities.

Economic Impact

1. **Revival of Indigenous Industries:**
 - The boycott of British goods and the promotion of indigenous products led to a revival of traditional crafts and industries. The emphasis on self-reliance and economic self-sufficiency helped to strengthen the Indian economy.
2. **Development of New Enterprises:**
 - The movement stimulated the growth of new enterprises and industries, which provided employment opportunities and contributed to economic development.

Social and Cultural Impact

1. **Cultural Revival:**
 - The Swadeshi Movement played a crucial role in the cultural revival of India. It encouraged the rediscovery and celebration of India's rich cultural heritage, including literature, music, and art.
2. **Empowerment of Women:**
 - The movement saw significant participation from women, who played active roles in boycotts, picketing, and the promotion of Swadeshi products. This involvement helped to break traditional gender barriers and empowered women in the nationalist struggle.

Challenges and Limitations

1. **British Repression:**
 - The British authorities responded to the Swadeshi Movement with severe repression, including arrests, deportations, and the use of force to suppress protests. Leaders like Tilak were imprisoned, and nationalist activities were closely monitored.
2. **Communal Tensions:**
 - The movement, while promoting unity, also saw instances of communal tensions, particularly between Hindus and Muslims. The British exploited these divisions to weaken the nationalist movement.
3. **Economic Constraints:**

- Despite efforts to promote Swadeshi enterprises, they often faced challenges such as lack of capital, technological backwardness, and competition from British goods.

Conclusion

The Swadeshi Movement was a pivotal moment in India's struggle for independence, marking a significant shift towards self-reliance and economic nationalism. It united people across different regions and social strata in a collective effort to resist colonial rule. Despite facing challenges and limitations, the movement had a profound impact on the political, economic, and cultural landscape of India, laying the foundation for future struggles and the eventual attainment of independence. The legacy of the Swadeshi Movement continues to inspire efforts towards self-reliance and national pride in contemporary India.

Mahatma Gandhi's involvement in the Swadeshi Movement was instrumental in shaping its course and impact. Gandhi, who later became the leader of India's independence movement, played a crucial role in popularizing the principles of Swadeshi and incorporating them into the broader struggle for freedom. This essay explores Gandhi's contributions to the Swadeshi Movement, his strategies, and the lasting impact of his involvement.

Gandhi's Early Years and Introduction to Swadeshi Influence of Gokhale and South Africa

1. Educational Background:

- Gandhi's early exposure to the teachings of Gopal Krishna Gokhale, a prominent leader in the Indian National Congress (INC), instilled in him a sense of duty towards his country and its people.

2. Experience in South Africa:

- Gandhi's experiences in South Africa, where he faced racial discrimination and injustice, shaped his worldview and commitment to social justice and nonviolent resistance.

Return to India and Embrace of Swadeshi

1. Arrival in India:

- Gandhi returned to India in 1915, at a time when the Swadeshi Movement was gaining momentum as a response to British colonial policies.

2. Embrace of Swadeshi Ideals:

- Gandhi quickly embraced the principles of Swadeshi, advocating for economic self-reliance, the boycott of British goods, and the promotion of indigenous industries.

Gandhi's Leadership in the Swadeshi Movement Promotion of Khadi and Village Industries

1. Emphasis on Khadi:

- Gandhi promoted the use of khadi (handspun cloth) as a symbol of self-reliance and resistance to British rule. He encouraged people to spin their own cloth as a form of economic empowerment and self-sufficiency.

2. Advocacy for Village Industries:

- Gandhi championed the cause of village industries, such as handloom weaving, pottery, and agriculture, as a means to revitalize rural economies and promote sustainable development.

Nonviolent Resistance and Satyagraha

1. Strategy of Satyagraha:

- Gandhi's concept of Satyagraha, or nonviolent resistance, became central to the Swadeshi Movement. He believed in the power of moral persuasion and passive resistance to challenge unjust laws and policies.

2. Salt Satyagraha:

- Gandhi's famous Salt Satyagraha in 1930, where he led a march to the sea to make salt in defiance of British salt laws, demonstrated the effectiveness of nonviolent protest in mobilizing mass support and international attention.

Promotion of Self-Governance

1. Quest for Swaraj:

- Gandhi's ultimate goal in promoting Swadeshi was to achieve Swaraj, or self-rule, for India. He believed that economic independence was a necessary precondition for political freedom.

2. Emphasis on Constructive Work:

- Gandhi emphasized the importance of constructive work, such as rural upliftment, education, and social reform, as integral components of the struggle for independence.

Legacy and Impact

Influence on Nationalist Movement

1. Inspiration for Mass Mobilization:

- Gandhi's leadership in the Swadeshi Movement inspired millions of Indians to participate in the struggle for independence. His emphasis on nonviolent resistance and moral principles resonated deeply with people across the country.

2. Integration of Swadeshi into Nationalist Agenda:

- Gandhi's advocacy for Swadeshi principles, including khadi and village industries, became integral to the broader nationalist agenda. Swadeshi became not just an economic strategy but a symbol of India's cultural identity and resilience.

Legacy of Nonviolent Resistance

1. Global Impact:

- Gandhi's use of nonviolent resistance influenced movements for social justice and civil rights around the world. His methods inspired leaders like Martin Luther King Jr. and Nelson Mandela in their struggles against oppression.

2. Enduring Principles:

- Gandhi's emphasis on nonviolence, self-reliance, and moral integrity continues to resonate in contemporary movements for peace, justice, and sustainability.

Conclusion

Mahatma Gandhi's leadership in the Swadeshi Movement was transformative, both for India's struggle for independence and for the global understanding of nonviolent resistance. His promotion of Swadeshi principles, including khadi and village industries, mobilized mass support and contributed to the broader nationalist agenda. Gandhi's legacy as a champion of nonviolence and self-reliance endures today, inspiring generations of activists and leaders to pursue social change through peaceful means.

Understanding Gandhi's vision of Swadeshi

Satyagraha and swadeshi are fundamental in Gandhi's philosophy of life. According to Gandhi, the whole gamut of man's activities constitutes an indivisible whole. Life cannot be segregated into watertight compartments like social, economic, political, religious and so on. So the ideas and concepts he developed in the course of his relentless experiments with truth was an attempt to integrate the various aspects of life. The concept of swadeshi was not an exception. It was not merely an economic doctrine. In fact the concept of swadeshi covered all aspects of the human life. Gandhi's vision of swadeshi is a universal concept even though he propounded it in the context of India's struggle for freedom. He used swadeshi as a means to achieve India's swaraj. India's struggle for freedom was a source of inspiration for many non-violent struggles in different parts of the globe. Swaraj through swadeshi is a principle of universal application and it can be emulated by people in their struggle for freedom. It was one of the eleven vows Gandhi prescribed for a satyagraha way of life. In this paper an attempt has been made to understand Gandhi's concept of swadeshi and its manifestation in important facets of human life. Swadeshi as a generic concept covers almost every aspect of human life, all his ideas, concepts, methods and programmes. However, the scope of the present paper has been limited to areas such as economic, political, social, religious, and educational and health. Firstly, we will analyse Gandhi's vision of swadeshi.

Gandhi's vision of Swadeshi

Gandhi described swadeshi as 'law of laws'¹ ingrained in the basic nature of human being. It is a universal law. Like nature's law it needs no enacting. It is self-acting one. When one neglects or disobeys it due to ignorance or other reasons, the law takes its own course to

restore to the original position like the laws of nature. The necessity for the inclusion of swadeshi as a vow is due to the fact that the people have forgotten this law; to use Gandhi's own words, the law is sunk into oblivion. A person by temperament following this law need not follow it as a vow, that is, a rare thing. According to Gandhi swadeshi in its ultimate and spiritual sense stands for the final emancipation of the soul from her earthly bondage. Therefore, a votary of swadeshi has to identify oneself with the entire creation in the ultimate quest to emancipate the soul from the physical body, as it stands in the way of realising oneness with all life. This identification is possible only by performing the primary duty, that is, the service of one's immediate neighbour. In outward appearance, it may look as exclusion or disservice to others, i.e., the rest of humanity. Pure service can never result in disservice to the far away person. In swadeshi there is no distinction between one's own and other people. With the temptation of serving the whole world, if one fails to perform the duty towards the immediate neighbours, it is a clear violation of the very principle of swadeshi. The very first step of serving the world starts with the immediate neighbour. Service to the nearest individual is service to the Universe. According to Gandhi, swadharma in Gita interpreted in terms of one's physical environment gives us the Law of Swadeshi. Gandhi quotes Gita "It is best to die performing one's own duty or Swadharma. Paradharma, or another's duty, is fraught with danger."² Further Gandhi explains: "What the Gita says with regard to swadharma equally applies to swadeshi also, for swadeshi is swadharma applied to one's immediate environment."³ The law of swadeshi demands that one should not take more than required to discharge the legitimate obligations towards the family. In swadeshi there is no space for selfishness and hatred. It is the highest form of altruism and acme of universal service in the Gandhian scheme. In the light of the above understanding and after much thinking and reflection, Gandhi defined swadeshi as the "spirit in us which restricts us to the use and services of our immediate, to the exclusion of the more remote."⁴ This definition is perhaps the best explanation of his concept.

Economic dimension of Swadeshi

Let us first look at the implications of swadeshi in the field of economics. Gandhi was convinced that the deep poverty prevailing among masses was mainly due to the ruinous departure from the path of swadeshi in the economic and industrial life. Gandhi advocated that one who follows the spirit of swadeshi should use only things that are produced by our immediate neighbours and serve those industries by making them efficient, and strengthen them in areas where they are found deficient. During the time of India's struggle for independence Gandhi realised that the economic salvation of India consists in encouraging and reviving indigenous industries. Gandhi found khadi as the necessary and most important corollary of the principle of swadeshi in its practical application to society. Khadi fulfils the kind of service envisaged in swadeshi. Gandhi himself asked the question: "What is the kind of service... the teeming millions of India most need at the present time, that can be easily understood and appreciated by all, that is easy to perform and will at the same time enable the crores of our semi-starved countrymen to live?"⁵ He found the answer, that it was universalising khadi or spinning wheel which fulfill these conditions. For him, khadi is the Sun of the village solar system. The various industries are the planets which can support khadi. Khadi mentality means decentralisation of production and distribution of the

necessities of life. Gandhi advocated the concept of swadeshi in the spirit of universal love and service. A votary of swadeshi will give preference to local products even if they are of inferior grade or dearer in price than things manufactured elsewhere and try to remedy the defects of local manufacturers. Gandhi warned the votary of swadeshi against making it a fetish. "To reject foreign manufactures merely because they are foreign, and to go on wasting national time and money in the promotion in one's country of manufactures for which it is not suited, would be criminal folly, and a negation of the swadeshi spirit. A true votary of swadeshi will never harbour ill-will towards the foreigner: he will not be actuated by antagonism towards anybody on earth. Swadeshism is not a cult of hatred. It is a doctrine of selfless service that has its roots in the purest ahimsa, i.e. Love".⁶ In the swadeshi economic order there will be healthy exchange of products and not cut-throat competition through the play of market forces. Gandhi explains this ideal situation in the following words: "If we follow the swadeshi doctrine, it would be your duty and mine to find out neighbours who can supply our wants and to teach them to supply them where they do not know how to proceed, assuming that there are neighbours who are in want of healthy occupation. Then every village of India will almost be a self-supporting and self-contained unit, exchanging only such necessary commodities with other villages where they are not locally producible."⁷ In such an economic system there will be an organic relationship between production, distribution and consumption.

Political dimension of Swadeshi

The application of swadeshi in politics calls for the revival of the indigenous institutions and strengthening them to overcome some of its defects. Gandhi pleaded the need for internal governance (swaraj) as early as 1909 in his noted booklet *Hind Swaraj or Indian Home Rule*. He wanted to empower the people through political self governance. His vision of decentralized political system was Panchayati Raj by which the innumerable villages of India were governed. He succinctly describes it as follows: "The government of the village will be conducted by the Panchayat of five persons annually elected by the adult villagers, male and female, possessing minimum prescribed qualifications. Since there will be no system of punishment in the accepted sense, this Panchayat will be the legislature, judiciary and executive combined to operate for its year of office. Here there is perfect democracy based upon individual freedom. The individual is the architect of his own government. The law of non-violence rules him and his government. He and his village are able to defy the might of a world."⁸ Gandhi further outlined his vision of village swaraj by introducing the concept of oceanic circle in opposition to pyramidal structure of society, placing individual at the centre of the society. "In this structure composed of innumerable villages, there will be ever widening, never ascending circles. Life will not be a pyramid with the apex sustained by the bottom. But it will be an oceanic circle whose centre will be the individual always ready to perish for the circle of villages, till at last the whole becomes one life composed of individuals, never aggressive in their arrogance but ever humble, sharing the majesty of the oceanic circle of which they are integral units.

Social dimension of Swadeshi

Applying the spirit of swadeshi in the context of Indian social structure, Gandhi initially accepted the institution of Varna associated with it. He welcomed the four-fold division of the society purely based on duties performed by different sections of people. Gandhi considered all professions as equally important. He made an earnest attempt to overcome the defects of the caste system by discarding certain obnoxious practices which he considered as historical accretion, which was not the integral part of original system. He vehemently opposed the prevailing caste system based on birth and the social status attached to it. That was the reason why he launched one of the most relentless battles against the curse of untouchability which was a part and parcel of the caste system in India. Gandhi looked at the scourge of untouchability as a blot on Hinduism. He was so much convinced that he did not even hesitate to take up cudgels on the behalf of untouchables against the upper caste Hindu orthodoxy. In the process so much animosity was created among orthodox upper caste and several attempts were made to eliminate him. Unmindful of the risks involved, he stuck to the position till the end of his life. He totally identified with the untouchables and their uplift became his primary concern. Similarly he was deeply concerned about the problems and plight of the vulnerable sections of the society viz., Dalits , women, tribals, lepers and so on. He believed that true swaraj can be attained only by uplifting these deprived sections of the society. Gandhi included the uplift of these sections in his 18 point Constructive Programme. It was primarily drawn taking into account the social realities of our country. Gandhi's Constructive Programme aimed at reconstruction of society through voluntary and participatory social action. In a sense the constructive work plays the role of civil society/NGOs. Gandhi looked upon Constructive Programme as a 'truthful and nonviolent way of winning Poorna Swaraj'.

swadeshi in Religion

To follow the spirit of Gandhi's swadeshi in the field of religion one has to restrict to the ancestral religion. It calls for the use of one's immediate religious surroundings. It is the duty of a person to serve one's own religion by purging its defects, if necessary, in order to purify and keep it pure. There is no need to renounce one's religion because of imperfections in it and embrace another. On the contrary one should try to enrich one's own religion by drawing the best from other religions. However Gandhi was not against true conversion and he differentiated it from proselytization. According to Gandhi conversion in the sense of self purification, self realisation is the crying need of the hour. His attitude was not of patronising toleration but developing the spirit of fellowship. His veneration for other faiths was the same as that of his own faith. He believed in the fundamental equality of all religions, what he called Sarvadharm Samabhava. Gandhi's swadeshi approach to religion has great significance in the context of growing communal divide and religious fundamentalism in India and other parts of the globe. This approach is essential to promote harmony among the followers of various faiths and preserving the composite culture of a country like India.

Swadeshi in Education

One of the major areas in which Gandhi applied his swadeshi ideal was the field of education. For him education was meant for all-round development of personality and not purely as a means for earning one's livelihood. In Hind Swaraj he rejected the British educational system

prevailing in India. His primary objection against British educational system was that it was primarily meant for 'enslaving' the people of India. It was his firm conviction that the prevailing system of education does not serve the requirements of the country in any form or shape. He believed that education has to be rooted in the culture and traditions of the country. Education through a medium of foreign language put undue stress upon the nerves of the children and they become foreigners in their own country. They are completely cut off from the realities of life. He placed before the nation an alternative system of education called Nai Talim or Basic education. He defined education as follows: "By Education, I mean, an all-round drawing out of the best in child and man-body, mind and spirit. Literacy is not the end of education nor even the beginning. It is only one of the means whereby man and woman can be educated. Literacy in itself is no education. I would therefore begin the child's education by teaching it a useful handicraft and enabling it to produce from the moment it begins its training."¹¹ In his scheme the craft was the pivot and centre of all educational activities. Through the medium of craft he correlated all other subjects to the central craft. It was a self sufficient and self supporting system of education meant for children above the age of seven which was meant to be free and compulsory. He placed before the nation alternative institutions like Gujarat Vidyapith, Kashi Vidyapith and others during the struggle for independence. Later he broadened his concept of basic education and looked upon education as a lifelong process starting from cradle to grave.

swadeshi in Health Care

Gandhi's prescription for health was an application of principle of swadeshi .i.e. to live according to the laws of nature. He strongly opposed the modern medical system in his seminal work Hind swaraj. He went even to the extent of describing hospitals as "institutions for propagating sin."¹² He rejected the modern medical system primarily on the ground that it is purely curative and not preventive. He advocated a new system of medical care wherein one follows the laws of nature with regard to diet, physical exercise, hygiene and sanitation and a new life style based on self restraint. He advocated the system of nature cure to prevent the diseases rather than finding a purely drug based cure for them. In this he underlined the centrality of proper use of earth, water, air sunlight and ether. He primarily emphasised a holistic approach to health care where it will primarily be governed by disciplined way of life. It is also notable that health care was one of his passions since his South African days. He experimented with different kinds of nature cure including the inexpensive and nutritious food which people could easily avail. Not only that, he was instrumental in establishing a nature cure centre at Urulikanchan near Pune and even started practicing nature cure. In fact during the last years of life a new dimension to nature cure practice was added in the form of Ram nam. It must be made clear that for him Ram nam was not like an ordinary mantra to be chanted. It was a part of his spiritual sadhana based on his firm belief that a man with total internal purity would not fall sick or even he would require no medicine other than Ram nam. Here Ram stands for one of the names of God and one can freely choose any other name of God which appeals to him. That was the reason he refused to take medicine in the fag end of his life including the Noakhali mission. Ram nam was nothing but a spiritual means for self purification thereby eliminating all possibilities of illness by keeping the body pure.

Conclusion

It is obvious from the above analysis that swadeshi is key for basic understanding of the edifice of Gandhi's philosophy of life. He successfully demonstrated that the swadeshi spirit could be integrated in every walk of our national life. What is more, he did not stop only at conceptual level of swadeshi. He suggested concrete institutional set up in most of the areas of his concern. As stated earlier for Gandhi life was holistic and indivisible and hence he presented an integrated plan covering virtually all aspects of human life. And that is the most distinctive nature of his thought which could really become a guiding principle for human resurgence. In fact he went beyond it and underlines the oneness of entire creations including the sentient and non-sentient beings. It is real pity that independent India failed to grasp the revolutionary nature of his thought and discarded them in the very initial years of freedom. Now it is more than clear that sooner or later, India, even the world, would have to take to Gandhian path to meet the challenges effectively. If not, it will be totally going against the law of universe which aeons ago ours ancestors called rita.

Surat Split of 1907 –

Background, Major Causes, Aftermath, Reason for Failure and Its Impact

The Surat Split was the division of the Indian National Congress (INC) into Moderates and Radicals (Or extremists), during the Surat session in 1907. However, this division was also visible within the Congress at the Banaras Session (1905), when some leaders, including Tilak, advocated for aggressive resistance rather than the passive resistance employed by the moderates during the Swadeshi Movement or anti-partition movement.

What was Surat Split?

The Surat Split was the split of the Indian National Congress (INC) into two factions, the Moderates and the Extremists, at the Surat session in 1907. The split was caused by ideological differences between the two factions. The Moderates advocated for moderate methods of constitutional agitation. The Extremists advocated for more radical methods, such as boycott and swadeshi.

Background of Surat Split

The role of the Indian National Congress (INC) in the manner of opposing the Partition of Bengal was the main cause of the Split. In 1905, the Banaras session of the INC was presided over by G K Gokhale (moderate). Here the INC took up the issue of the Bengal partition, and both the Moderates and the Extremists supported the cause of Swadeshi and Boycott for Bengal. As time passed by, the Extremists wanted the agitation to be a mass struggle all over

the country. But the Moderates still had faith in the British administration and wanted to confine the boycott to Bengal and foreign goods only.

In 1906, the Calcutta session witnessed four resolutions (Swadeshi, Boycott, Swaraj, and National Education). But the meaning of the four resolutions was not clearly spelt out. The Calcutta session was presided over by Dadabhai Naoroji, a moderate leader.

In the 1907 annual session of Congress, the Extremists wanted BG Tilak or Lala Lajpat Rai to be the President. On the other hand, the Moderates wanted Ras Bihari Ghosh to be the President and wanted the four resolutions to be dropped. At the same time, the venue of the session was changed from Nagpur to Surat. Surat was the hometown of BG Tilak, and as per the Congress convention, he could not be the President in his home province, leading Ras Bihari Ghosh to be the Congress President.

Causes of the Surat Split

Here are some Causes of the Surat Split of Congress;

- The different mindsets of the Moderates and the Extremists regarding the Anti-Partition Movement.
- Four resolutions passed in the Calcutta session were not clearly spelt out.
- In 1906, Morley and Minto started discussing fresh council reforms with the Moderates. As a result, the Moderates wanted the Swadeshi boycott and national education to be dropped.
- The tussle for the presidency in the Calcutta session was intensifying. Extremists believed the loyal moderates could not gain the goal of the Indian Freedom Struggle. Whereas the rising popularity of the Extremists also bore the fruit of fear in the Moderates about their existence.
- Citing the reasons listed above, on the 26th of December 1907, a Congress session was held on the bank of the river Tapti in Surat. Where the INC experienced a split with 1600 delegates. The incident is referred to as the "Surat Split."

The Aftermath of the Surat Split

- After the Surat Split 1907, the government started repressive measures against the Extremists. During 1907 and 1911, various laws were passed to check anti-government activities-
 - The Seditious Meetings Act 1907.
 - The Indian Newspapers (Incitement and Offences Act) 1908.
 - Criminal law amendment Act 1908.
 - The Indian Press Act 1910.
- BG Tilak was sent to the Mandalay jail for 6 years.
- Lala Lajpat Rai left for Britain.
- Aurobindo Ghosh gave up politics and took up religious work in Pondicherry.

- The government came up with a new strategy 'Divide and Rule'. For example, the 1909 reform was made to confuse the moderates and appease the Muslims as well.
- Without the Extremists, the moderates were left with no popular base and lost the respect and support of their own people.

Failures of the Surat Split of Congress

Here are some failures of the Surat Split of Congress;

- Tore down the Swaraj resolution by the Moderates.
- The different working strategies of the Moderates and the Extremists.
- Thinking of minority and majority inside the Congress encouraged the British to suppress the nationalists.
- The faith in the British government by the Moderates.

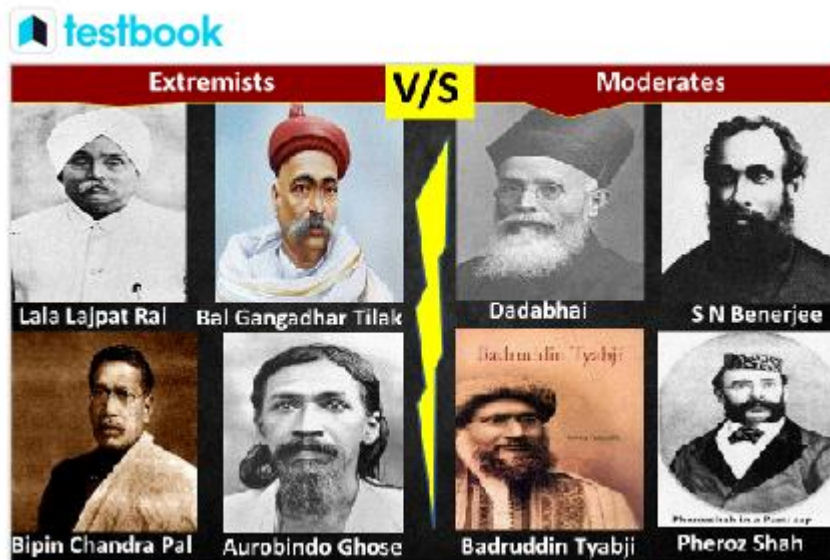
Impact of Surat Split

The Surat Split of the Indian National Congress (INC) resulted in the party's division into two groups, i.e., the Extremists and the Moderates. This division weakened Congress and reduced its effectiveness in the fight for Indian independence. However, the Surat Split marked a turning point in the Indian independence movement, with the extremists becoming more prominent and eventually leading Congress toward a more militant and radical approach to achieving independence. It further signaled a shift in the government's mindset towards and policy toward moderate nationalists. The Surat Split was the driving force behind the 1909 Minto-Morley Reform. The Congress was not resurrected until 1916, following the return of the Extremists and the departure of the Moderates. But by this point, everything had changed significantly. Later, as a newcomer to politics, Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi allied himself with the extremist movement. He represented a new synthesis of faith and reason, law and impulse, ushering in a new era in modern Indian history known as the Gandhian era.

Points on Surat Split

- Congress was divided into two branches according to the ideology.
- The British government saw this as an opportunity and started repressive measures against the nationalist leaders. As mentioned above Aftermath of the Surat Split
- A new method of opposing the British government emerged, and the leaders tried to gain complete freedom from the crown.
- The 1907 annual session of the Congress was considered a dark hour of Indian Politics.

Ideological Difference Between Moderates and Extremists



Moderates working depend on the 3 Ps (Prayer, petition, protest). While the Extremists believe in 3S (self-reliance, sacrifice, and strong will). Moderates had faith in the British administration, while the Extremists did not have the feeling and wanted complete freedom. Moderates believe in active resistance, while Extremists believe in passive resistance.

Surat Split and the Lucknow Session 1916

The Moderates and the Extremists reunited at the Lucknow session in 1916. The session was presided by Ambika Charan Majumdar. After the Surat Split in 1907, the Moderates started losing their popularity and base among their own people. The Extremists helped the people to fight for their freedom in a different manner. People of India also believed that alone the programs of the Moderates would not help to gain the Swaraj objective. Thus, the need for Extremists in the national movement was felt. The Home Rule League, started by Annie Besant and Tilak (extremist), also helped the extremist to open the door again for Congress. The Lucknow pact is also known as the Congress-League pact. The pact was signed between Congress and the Muslim League. It was possible because of the joint efforts of Tilak and Annie Beasant. Tilak's demand for a Congress Working Committee was turned down.

Conclusion

The Congress split at Surat in 1907 was a reflection of the deep-seated ideological differences and personal rivalries within the Indian National Congress. The division between moderates and extremists over tactics, leadership, and strategy led to a formal split in the organization and weakened its ability to present a united front against British colonial rule. While the Congress eventually reunited, the split at Surat marked a turning point in the Indian freedom movement, highlighting the challenges and complexities of seeking independence from British domination.

The moderates and the extremists were like the brain and heart of the nation. The Surat split is termed a national calamity. The exit of the extremists from Congress severely affected the moderates, and the national movement also came to a halt for some time. The Extremists' ideology and revolutionary activities gave the people new hope and strength to fight against the British. After 8 years of separation, the Moderates and the Extremists reunited in 1916 at the Lucknow session.

The Congress split at the Surat session of 1907 was a significant event in the history of India's struggle for independence. The division occurred primarily between the moderates, led by Gopal Krishna Gokhale, and the extremists, led by Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Bipin Chandra Pal. This essay explores the background, causes, and consequences of the Congress split at Surat.

Background

Ideological Differences

1. Moderates vs. Extremists:

- The Indian National Congress (INC) was founded in 1885 with the goal of seeking political reforms and representation for Indians within the British colonial system.
- Over time, ideological differences emerged within the Congress between the moderate faction, advocating for gradual reforms and dialogue with the British, and the extremist faction, demanding more radical action and complete independence from British rule.

Rise of Extremist Nationalism

1. Influence of Swadeshi Movement:

- The Swadeshi Movement, which emerged in response to the partition of Bengal in 1905, marked the rise of extremist nationalism. Leaders like Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Bipin Chandra Pal advocated for direct action, boycotts, and passive resistance against British rule.

Causes of the Split

Differences in Approach

1. Tactics and Strategies:

- The moderates favored a cautious approach, focusing on petitions, negotiations, and legal methods to achieve political reforms within the existing colonial framework.
- The extremists, on the other hand, called for more aggressive tactics, including boycotts, strikes, and civil disobedience, to press for immediate independence.

Leadership Disputes

1. Leadership of the Congress:

- The moderates, led by Gopal Krishna Gokhale, held sway over the Congress leadership, while the extremists, led by Tilak and Pal, sought greater influence and representation within the organization.

Personal Rivalries

1. Personal Animosity:

- Personal rivalries and animosities between leaders, especially between Gokhale and Tilak, exacerbated tensions within the Congress and contributed to the eventual split.

Congress Session at Surat Divisions and Discord

1. Surat Session of 1907:

- The Congress session held in Surat in December 1907 was marked by heated debates and discord between the moderates and extremists.
- Differences over the election of the Congress President and the selection of the venue for the next session highlighted the growing rift within the organization.

Walkout by Extremists

1. Tilak's Proposal:

- Tilak proposed the name of Rash Behari Ghosh, a moderate, for the presidency of the Congress session. However, his proposal was rejected by the moderates.
- In protest, Tilak and his supporters walked out of the Congress session, leading to the formal split of the organization.

Consequences of the Split Weakening of the Congress

1. Loss of Unity and Cohesion:

- The split at Surat dealt a severe blow to the unity and cohesion of the Congress. The division between moderates and extremists weakened the organization's ability to present a united front against British rule.

Impact on the Freedom Movement

1. Shift in Dynamics:

- The split marked a significant shift in the dynamics of the Indian freedom movement. While the moderates continued to pursue constitutional methods, the extremists intensified their efforts towards revolutionary activities and mass mobilization.

Long-term Implications

1. Polarization of Indian Politics:

- The split at Surat laid the groundwork for the polarization of Indian politics between moderate and extremist factions. This division would continue to shape the course of the freedom movement in the years to come.

Congress unification and Muslim League

The Congress unification and Muslim League pact, commonly known as the Lucknow Pact of 1916, was a significant event in India's struggle for independence. It marked a rare moment of unity between the Indian National Congress (INC) and the All-India Muslim League, two major political parties representing different communities in British India. This essay explores the background, key provisions, and consequences of the Lucknow Pact.

Background Divisions in Indian Politics

1. Communal Divide:

- The early 20th century saw growing communal tensions between Hindus and Muslims in British India. The partition of Bengal in 1905 and subsequent events had exacerbated communal divisions and suspicions.

2. Congress and Muslim League:

- The Indian National Congress, predominantly Hindu-led, advocated for a united India with equal rights for all communities.
- The All-India Muslim League, formed in 1906, represented the interests of Muslims and called for safeguards to protect their political and cultural rights.

Congress Split and Extremist Activities

Surat Split and Repercussions

1. Congress Split of 1907:

- The split at the Surat session of 1907 had weakened the Congress, with moderates and extremists parting ways over ideological differences.
- The split had also led to the marginalization of the extremist faction, making the Congress leadership more amenable to reconciliation.

Growth of Extremist Movements

1. Rise of Extremism:

- Meanwhile, the rise of extremist movements, such as the Ghadar Party and the Anushilan Samiti, posed a challenge to British rule and fueled nationalist sentiments among Indians.

Lucknow Pact of 1916

Context and Significance

1. Negotiations:

- Against the backdrop of World War I and British efforts to seek Indian support, negotiations between the Congress and the Muslim League began in 1916.
- The pact was facilitated by leaders like Annie Besant, who worked towards bridging the gap between the two parties.

Key Provisions

1. Representation and Reforms:

- The Lucknow Pact called for increased representation for Indians in the central and provincial legislatures.
- It demanded greater autonomy for provinces and the introduction of reforms to address the grievances of various communities.

2. Communal Representation:

- The pact recognized the principle of separate electorates for Muslims, granting them the right to elect their own representatives in certain constituencies.

3. Congress-League Cooperation:

- The pact emphasized cooperation between the Congress and the Muslim League on issues of common interest, such as constitutional reforms and political representation.

Impact and Consequences

1. Unity and Solidarity:

- The Lucknow Pact marked a rare moment of unity between Hindus and Muslims in India's political landscape. It demonstrated that both communities could work together towards common goals despite their differences.

2. British Response:

- The British government, recognizing the significance of the pact, made concessions to Indian demands and introduced the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms in 1919, which partially addressed the demands outlined in the Lucknow Pact.

3. Long-term Implications:

- While the pact helped foster Hindu-Muslim unity and laid the foundation for future cooperation, it also sowed the seeds of communal politics, leading to the eventual demand for separate electorates and, ultimately, the partition of India in 1947.

Conclusion

The Lucknow Pact of 1916 was a landmark agreement that brought together the Indian National Congress and the All-India Muslim League in a common struggle for political reforms and representation. While the pact symbolized Hindu-Muslim unity and cooperation, it also highlighted the complexities of communal politics in India. Despite its limitations and eventual consequences, the Lucknow Pact remains a significant chapter in India's journey towards independence, reflecting the aspirations and challenges of a diverse and pluralistic society striving for self-rule and self-determination.

Unit 5-

National awakening during First World War :

I. Home Rule Movement.

II. Revolutionary Movement.

III. Chandra Shekhar Azad, Bhagat Singh.

IV. Subhash Chandra Bose and Azad Hind Fauj

The First World War, which lasted from 1914 to 1918, had a profound impact on India and contributed significantly to the national awakening and the growth of the independence movement. This period witnessed a surge in nationalist sentiments and activism as Indians responded to the challenges and opportunities presented by the war. Here's an overview of the national awakening during the First World War:

Background

1. British India's Involvement:

- The British Indian Empire actively participated in World War I as a part of the British Empire. Indian soldiers, known as the British Indian Army, fought

alongside British forces in various theaters of the war, including the Western Front, Mesopotamia, and East Africa.

2. War's Economic Impact:

- The war had significant economic repercussions for India. The British government imposed heavy taxes, requisitioned resources, and diverted funds from India to finance the war effort, exacerbating economic hardships for the Indian populace.

Factors Contributing to National Awakening

1. Contribution of Indian Soldiers:

- The participation of Indian soldiers in the war highlighted their bravery, sacrifice, and loyalty to the British Empire. However, their experiences also led to a growing sense of national identity and aspirations for self-determination.

2. Impact of War Propaganda:

- War propaganda, disseminated by both British and German authorities, influenced Indian perceptions of the war and fueled nationalist sentiments. Indian newspapers and intellectuals began to question the morality and legitimacy of British rule.

3. Political Mobilization:

- The war provided opportunities for political mobilization and activism. Leaders like Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Annie Besant, and Mahatma Gandhi used the war as a platform to demand political reforms, civil liberties, and greater autonomy for India.

4. Emergence of Home Rule Movement:

- The war catalyzed the Home Rule movement, led by Annie Besant and Bal Gangadhar Tilak, which advocated for self-government and Home Rule for India within the British Empire. The movement gained widespread support and momentum during the war years.

Impact on the Independence Movement

1. Widening Political Participation:

- The war provided opportunities for Indians to engage in political activities and organizations. The Indian National Congress, under leaders like Annie Besant and Tilak, expanded its reach and influence, mobilizing masses for the cause of self-rule.

2. Emergence of Gandhi:

- Mahatma Gandhi, who returned to India from South Africa in 1915, emerged as a prominent leader during the war years. He advocated for nonviolent resistance, civil disobedience, and socio-economic reforms as part of the struggle for independence.

3. Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms:

- In response to growing nationalist demands and the impact of the war, the British government introduced the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms in 1919, which aimed to increase Indian representation in governance and provide limited self-government at the provincial level.

Conclusion

The First World War served as a catalyst for the national awakening and the growth of the independence movement in India. It heightened Indian awareness of political, economic, and social injustices under British rule and inspired a generation of leaders and activists to strive for self-determination and independence. The war years saw a surge in political mobilization, activism, and demands for reforms, laying the groundwork for India's eventual independence in 1947.

impacts of World War 1st on India

When the armed conflict kicked off, the British Expeditionary Force in France was a small, as a fighting force. Reinforcing it was essential; thus that led to the deployment of the two Indian divisions. Rushed to the Western Front, Indian soldiers fought tenaciously to stop a German breakthrough. By the time Indian soldiers sailed out from Marseilles 14 months later, they and their fellow countrymen-138,608 **Indians in all had helped to weaken Germany's Schlieffen Plan.**

Schlieffen Plan, It was a battle plan first proposed in 1905 by Alfred, Graf (count) von Schlieffen, chief of the German general staff, that was designed to allow Germany to wage a successful two-front war. The plan was heavily modified by Schlieffen's successor, Helmuth von Moltke, prior to and during its implementation in World War I. Moltke's changes, which included a reduction in the size of the attacking army, were blamed for Germany's failure to win a quick victory.

With the 100th anniversary of the Armistice on 11th November 2018 and the inauguration of monuments to Indian soldiers in France, it is a contribution worth remembering. **The broader impact of the war on India suffers from a lack of attention.**

Why did India support British's war efforts?

- **Indian nationalism**, at that time, was **dominated by moderates who believed that** Indian contribution to the British war efforts would result in British's benevolence towards the natives and **would grant them more constitutional reforms.**
- **Indian army was distant from the nationalist movement** as magazines, newspapers were not allowed in the barracks and so they fought for the British Raj.

WW I's significance for India

- **The world war ended the myth of the indestructible power of the British Empire** in India as the British faced many humiliating defeats during the war. This raised the self-confidence among Indians.
- The soldiers that returned after war **raised the morale of masses**.
- India supported Britain in the world war on its promise of fighting for democracy but serving India with Rowlatt Act immediately after the war served as an eye-opener for Indians. This **led to the rise of national consciousness and soon Non-Cooperation movement was launched**.
- **Formation of USSR after the war** also led to the **rise of communism** in India with the formation of CPI and imparted a socialist influence on the freedom struggle.

What motivated men to fight in war thousands of miles from home?

- Indian soldiers saw it as their duty to bring honour to their clan or caste, by fighting bravely on the battlefield.
- The pay for an Indian infantryman was a modest 11 rupees a month, but the additional income earned from participating in the war would have been useful to a hard-pressed peasant family so, money may have been one motive for enlistment.
- Indian soldiers frequently expressed a strong sense of personal duty to the King-Emperor George V, who is mentioned in their letters more often than anyone else.

The Indian national movement and the country's socio-economic development did not take place in isolation. World War I linked India to global events in profound ways with far-reaching consequences.

Political Impact

- In India, the return of Punjabi soldiers after the end of the war also **aroused political activity** against colonial rule in that province, which became the spark for further wider protests. Punjab which supplied a large proportion of the troops turned into an epicenter of nationalism after the war.
- **There was a surge of nationalism and rise of mass civil disobedience** when the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms' failed to deliver on the expectation of home rule that had led to popular support for the British war effort.
- As the war dragged on, **casualties mounted and recruitment methods grew more coercive, resentment grew to fuel nationalism**.

Social Impact

- Between 1911 and 1921, **literacy rates increased** significantly in heavily recruited communities. This effect is strongest for men of military age, which is consistent with the notion that soldiers learned to read and write on their foreign campaigns.
- Respect for particular communities who participated in the war grew in the society.
- The huge number of non-combatants were also recruited from India- such as nurses, doctors etc. **leaving Indian society deprived of essential services** in a situation where such skills were already scarce in India.

Economic Impact

- There was a **sharp increase in demand for Indian goods** in Britain as production capabilities in Britain itself were diverted to the war effort.
- However, the disruption in shipping lanes because of the war also meant that Indian industry faced inconvenience because of the shortage of inputs that were earlier imported from Britain and Germany. **There was excess demand as well as supply bottlenecks.**
- **Another result was inflation.** Industrial prices nearly doubled in the six years after 1914. Accelerating prices benefitted Indian industry.
- **Farm prices rose as well**, but at a slower pace than industrial prices. The internal terms of trade(ratio of export prices to import prices) moved against agriculture. This trend continued for most of the next few decades, and especially during the collapse in global commodity prices during the Great Depression.
- **Demand for food supplies, particularly cereals, led to rampant food inflation.**
- Exports of cash crops like jute suffered due to the loss of the European market. Meanwhile, rising military demand for jute products compensated for the decline in civilian demand with jute mills in Bengal establishing monopolies; skewed income distribution grew even more so.
- **The drain on the Indian economy** in the form of cash, kind and loans to the British government came to about 367 million pounds.
- **Domestic manufacturing sectors such as cotton benefited** from the decline in British goods that had dominated the pre-war market.
- **The steel sector benefited as well.** For instance, the ailing Tata steel mills were handed a lifeline in the form of a contract to supply rails to the Mesopotamian campaign.
- **British investment was rerouted to the UK**, creating opportunities for Indian capital. In short, the war economy boosted Indian capitalism in some ways at least.

The First World War had a profound impact on the Indian independence movement, shaping its trajectory and accelerating the pace of nationalist agitation against British colonial rule.

Here are the key ways in which the war influenced the independence movement:

1. Economic Impact:

- The war placed significant economic burdens on India. The British government imposed heavy taxes, requisitioned resources, and diverted funds from India to finance the war effort. This exploitation led to widespread economic distress among the Indian population, fueling resentment against British rule.

2. Political Mobilization:

- The war provided opportunities for political mobilization and activism. Leaders such as Bal Ganga dhar Tilak, Annie Besant, and Mahatma Gandhi used the war as a platform to demand political reforms, civil liberties, and greater autonomy for India. The war also widened political participation, with more Indians becoming involved in nationalist activities and organizations.

3. Home Rule Movement:

- The war catalyzed the Home Rule movement, which advocated for self-government and Home Rule for India within the British Empire. Led by Annie Besant and Tilak, the movement gained widespread support and momentum during the war years. It brought the demand for self-rule to the forefront of Indian politics and laid the groundwork for future independence struggles.

4. Emergence of Mahatma Gandhi:

- The war years saw the emergence of Mahatma Gandhi as a prominent leader in the Indian independence movement. Gandhi returned to India from South Africa in 1915 and quickly became a leading figure in the struggle for independence. He advocated for nonviolent resistance, civil disobedience, and socio-economic reforms as part of the fight against British rule.

5. Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms:

- In response to growing nationalist demands and the impact of the war, the British government introduced the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms in 1919. These reforms aimed to increase Indian representation in governance and provide limited self-government at the provincial level. While falling short of nationalist aspirations, the reforms represented a significant concession by the British and further fueled the momentum of the independence movement.

6. Heightened Nationalist Sentiments:

- The war heightened nationalist sentiments among Indians, as they witnessed the sacrifices made by Indian soldiers on behalf of the British Empire. Indian participation in the war, combined with the economic exploitation and political repression by the British, strengthened the resolve of Indians to fight for independence.
- Overall, the First World War served as a catalyst for the Indian independence movement, galvanizing nationalist aspirations and paving the way for India's eventual freedom from British colonial rule. The war years saw a surge in political activism, the emergence of new leaders, and a heightened sense of Indian identity and unity in the struggle against imperialism.

Home Rule Movement

response to the limitations of the Indian National Congress in addressing the needs of the Indian people. The movement aimed at attaining self-rule for India. It would allow Indians to govern themselves without foreign intervention. The movement was launched by Annie Besant and Bal Gangadhar Tilak in 1916. It quickly gained momentum across the country.



Source: myGOV (*Indian Culture Portal*)

What is the Home Rule Movement?

The Home Rule movement was formed in April and September 1916 by Indian nationalist Bal Gangadhar Tilak and British social reformer Annie Besant. The term, derived from a similar movement in Ireland, referred to Indian nationalists' efforts to gain independence from the British Indian government. The Home Rule movement sought to establish a form of self-government along Irish lines.

History of the Home Rule Movement

- The Indian National Congress (INC) was founded in 1885 with the goal of achieving self-government for India. However, the INC's early leaders were moderates. They believed that India could achieve self-government through gradual reforms.
- The First World War (1914-1918) created a new political climate in India. The war effort required the Indian government to increase taxes and recruit soldiers. This led to widespread discontent among the Indian people.
- In 1916, Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Annie Besant launched the Home Rule Movement. This demanded self-government for India within the British Empire. The movement

was inspired by the Irish Home Rule Movement. This had been successful in achieving self-government for Ireland within the British Empire.

- The Home Rule Movement gained widespread support among the Indian people. It helped to create a sense of national unity. The movement also played a significant role in the INC. It adopted a more radical stance on self-government in the wake of the Home Rule Movement.
- The Rowlatt Act of 1919 gave the British government sweeping powers to suppress dissent. This led to a decline in the Home Rule Movement. However, the movement had already helped to lay the groundwork for India's independence movement.

Objectives of the Home Rule Movement

The following were the objectives of the Home Rule Movement:

- To create a sense of nationality within the country and alarm the British by organising demonstrations and agitations, and regular public meetings.
- To use constitutional means to gain self-government within the British Empire.
- To establish a government of councils, with members chosen by the Indian people. The intention was for such a Council to pass the country's budget and hold ministers accountable to the legislatures.
- To mobilize public opinion in support of the organization's core goal, which is to achieve long-term political independence for India.
- To gain self-government within the British empire.
- To demand the formation of linguistic states and vernacular language education.

Members of the Home Rule Movement in India

The Home Rule Movement in India had several prominent members who played a crucial role in advocating for Indian self-rule. Some of the notable members of the movement include:

- Bal Gangadhar Tilak: Tilak, also known as Lokmanya Tilak, was a prominent leader of the Home Rule Movement.
- Annie Besant: Annie Besant, a British socialist and theosophist, played a significant role in the Home Rule Movement. She became the president of the Indian National Congress in 1917.
- Bipin Chandra Pal: Bipin Chandra Pal was a prominent nationalist leader and one of the trio of leaders known as the Lal Bal Pal.
- Lala Lajpat Rai: Lala Lajpat Rai, another member of the Lal Bal Pal trio, was a fervent nationalist leader and a key figure in the Home Rule Movement.
- Surendranath Banerjee: Surendranath Banerjee was a prominent moderate leader. He later became associated with the Home Rule Movement.

Major Causes of the Home Rule Movement in India

- Indians were dissatisfied with British rule and wanted more say in governing their own country.
- Indians had little to no representation in the British government. This led to feelings of marginalization and frustration.
- The repressive policies of the British government, such as the Rowlatt Act and the Jallianwala Bagh massacre, fueled political unrest and discontent among Indians.
- The rise of Indian nationalism, inspired by leaders like Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Annie Besant, sparked a desire for self-governance and independence.
- The success of the Home Rule Movement in Ireland served as an inspiration for Indian leaders. It encouraged them to demand similar self-rule for India.
- The spread of education among Indians, facilitated by institutions like universities and newspapers, raised awareness about political rights and fueled demands for self-rule.
- Indians were subjected to economic exploitation under British rule, with unfair taxation policies and the drain of wealth from India to Britain.
- The movement also aimed to revive and preserve Indian culture and traditions. These were perceived to be under threat from British colonialism.
- Charismatic leaders like Tilak and Besant played a crucial role in mobilizing the masses and galvanizing support for the Home Rule Movement.
- The overarching goal of the Home Rule Movement was to achieve Swaraj, or self-rule, for India, marking a significant shift towards independence from British colonial rule.

Course of the Home Rule Movement

The Home Rule Movement was started by Annie Besant and Bal Gangadhar Tilak in 1916. The course of the movement was marked by several important events.

- The movement started with the formation of Home Rule Leagues in different parts of the country. The leagues were aimed at:
 - mobilizing people for the cause of self-rule and
 - creating awareness about the benefits of self-governance.
- The movement witnessed large-scale participation from various sections of society. It was successful in creating a sense of unity among the people.
- It brought together various factions of the Indian National Congress. It also attracted many members of the Muslim League.
- The movement led to the Montagu Declaration of 1917 or the August Declaration. This was the biggest significance of the movement.
- The Home Rule Movement paved the way for India's struggle for independence. It served as a precursor to the Non-Cooperation Movement launched by Mahatma Gandhi.

Characteristics of the Home Rule Movement

Here are the characteristics of the Home Rule Movement:

- The Home Rule Movement was a movement that aimed to attain self-rule or Home Rule for India.
- It was a mass movement that had the participation of people from different regions and religions across the nation.
- The movement was based on the principles of non-violence and constitutional agitation.
- It was a movement that gave importance to political education and awareness. It had a strong emphasis on the use of vernacular languages.
- The Home Rule Movement aimed to:
 - Mobilize public opinion against British colonial rule and
 - Bring about a united front of all political parties.
- The movement was marked by the participation of many women leaders who actively participated in the movement.
- The Home Rule Movement was a precursor to the Indian Independence Movement. It played an important role in the political awakening of India.

Outcomes of the Home Rule Movement

- In 1917, the Madras government initiated harsh steps against the home rule league in order to put an end to its popularity. Besant, Arundale, and Wadia were among the leaders arrested. This prompted a widespread revolt, with even moderate politicians joining the movement.
- Under the 'Government of India Act 1919,' Secretary of State Montague announced administrative reforms. It aided the emergence of self-governing institutions, which eventually led to the formation of Responsible Governments.
- As a result, India's Provincial and Central governments were established, and the desire for home rule was no longer considered traitorous.
- Due to mounting national hostility, Mrs. Annie Besant, who was detained in June 1917, was eventually released by the British government. As a result, at the Calcutta Session in 1917, she was elected President of the Congress. This was the pinnacle of the Home Rule movement.
- Two key contributions to this movement are remembered.
 - It drew the Congress' ranks together. Mrs. Besant united many moderates and some extremists in Congress, bringing the two parties closer together. As a result, she was able to undo the events of 1907 in Surat.
 - It had a significant impact on the character of Congress. It effectively forced Congress to learn methods of 'demand' and 'agitation,' abandoning its previous methods of 'petition' and 'prayer.'

Significance of the Home Rule Movement

The Home Rule Movement played a significant role in India's freedom struggle.

- The movement gained substantial support from educated Indians. It had approximately 40,000 members in 1917 after the two leagues combined.
- It created a strong sense of national unity and mobilized people across different regions and religions toward a common goal.
 - The movement briefly united moderates, extremists, and the Muslim League.
- The leaders of the Home Rule Movement effectively inspired people to join the freedom struggle.
- It helped to spread the message of self-governance and democratic values among the masses. It spread awareness about India's colonial exploitation, leading to a rise in nationalist sentiments. It paved the way for the later Indian independence movement.
- The movement's most significant impact was the Montague Declaration of 1917. It declared the following:
 - the inclusion of more Indians in the government, and
 - the development of self-governing institutions that ultimately led to responsible governments in India.
- The movement is considered a significant milestone in the history of Indian nationalism. It served as a precursor to the eventual attainment of Indian independence in 1947.
- The Home Rule Movement paved the way for the Non-Cooperation Movement and the Civil Disobedience Movement. These were the key phases in India's struggle for independence.

Decline of the Home Rule Movement

Several factors contributed to the league's dissolution in 1917. Some of the reasons are stated below: –

- Tilak's ideas about passive resistance initially turned off moderate congress workers.
- Besant herself couldn't decide whether to accept or reject the government's promise of reforms.
- Tilak travelled to London to pursue a libel case and was gone for several months. All of these factors meant that the home rule movement lacked a leader.
- The leagues were unable to gain support from Muslims, Anglo-Indians, and non-Brahmins because they believed that home rule would lead to rule by the upper-caste Hindu majority.
- Some moderates were satisfied with the government's assurance of reforms in the Montagu Declaration and thus did not support the movement.
- Annie Besant was unable to provide firm leadership to her followers because she herself was divided.

- The movement began to crumble as a result of Tilak's absence and Besant's inability to lead the people.
- With the rise of Mahatma Gandhi as a leader, the movement eventually merged with Congress.

Major Takeaways

- The home rule movement aimed to achieve self-government or "Home Rule" for India within the British Empire, similar to Canada or Australia.
- It was spearheaded by prominent nationalist leaders Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Annie Besant.
- Utilized strategies like public meetings and the formation of Home Rule Leagues to raise awareness and generate mass participation in the movement.
- While not achieving immediate self-rule, the Home Rule Movement laid the groundwork for later independence struggles.
- The movement bridged the gap between moderate and extremist factions within the Indian National Congress (INC). It created a more unified front against British rule.

The Home Rule Movement in India was a significant phase in the Indian independence struggle, which sought to achieve self-governance (Swaraj) for India within the British Empire. This movement was marked by two parallel Home Rule Leagues, one led by Bal Gangadhar Tilak and the other by Annie Besant. Here's an in-depth look at the history and impact of the Home Rule Movement in India:

Historical Context

Early 20th Century Nationalism

By the early 20th century, the Indian nationalist movement had been gaining momentum, with the Indian National Congress (INC) playing a pivotal role. However, the INC was divided between the moderate faction, which sought gradual reform, and the extremists, who demanded more direct action.

Prelude to the Home Rule Movement

The British government's response to nationalist demands was perceived as inadequate, especially with the partition of Bengal in 1905, which galvanized Indian opposition. The moderates and extremists temporarily united during the Swadeshi Movement but split again by 1907. The repressive measures during and after World War I further alienated Indians.

Formation of the Home Rule Leagues

Bal Gangadhar Tilak's Home Rule League

- **Formation:** Bal Gangadhar Tilak, a prominent extremist leader, founded the first Home Rule League in April 1916.

- **Objectives:** Tilak's league aimed to build a grassroots movement demanding self-governance, focusing on Maharashtra, Karnataka, the Central Provinces, and Berar.
- **Methods:** The league used extensive propaganda through newspapers, pamphlets, and public meetings to mobilize the masses.

Annie Besant's Home Rule League

- **Formation:** Annie Besant, a British social reformer and Theosophist who had settled in India, launched her Home Rule League in September 1916.
- **Objectives:** Besant's league sought to create a broader national movement, covering the rest of India.
- **Methods:** Besant employed her network, including her work with the Theosophical Society, to spread the message. She also used newspapers like "New India" and "Commonweal" to advocate for self-rule.

Movement and Activities

- **Membership and Reach:** The Home Rule Leagues rapidly gained popularity, with Tilak's league amassing around 32,000 members and Besant's league attracting a significant following.
- **Public Meetings and Campaigns:** Both leagues organized extensive campaigns, rallies, and lectures, spreading awareness about self-rule and educating the masses about their political rights.
- **Mobilization of Women and Youth:** The movement saw increased participation of women and youth, who were inspired by the ideals of self-governance.

Government Response

- **Repression:** The British government viewed the Home Rule Movement as a threat. It responded with repressive measures, including censorship of publications, arrests, and detentions of leaders.
- **Annie Besant's Arrest:** In June 1917, Besant was arrested, sparking widespread protests and further galvanizing the movement.

Impact and Legacy

Shift in INC Leadership

- The movement significantly impacted the Indian National Congress, pushing it towards a more radical stance. Leaders like Motilal Nehru and Jawaharlal Nehru were influenced by the Home Rule Movement.
- The INC adopted the demand for self-rule as a central goal, moving away from moderate reforms.

Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms

- The British government, recognizing the intensity of the demand for self-governance, proposed the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms in 1919. These reforms led to the Government of India Act 1919, which introduced a dual system of governance (diarchy) and expanded the legislative councils.
- Although the reforms fell short of full self-governance, they were a step towards increased Indian participation in government.

Foundation for Future Movements

- The Home Rule Movement laid the groundwork for future mass movements, including the Non-Cooperation Movement (1920-1922) and the Civil Disobedience Movement (1930-1934) led by Mahatma Gandhi.
- It also highlighted the importance of grassroots mobilization, a strategy that Gandhi would later perfect.

Conclusion

The Home Rule Movement was a pivotal chapter in the Indian independence struggle, marking a transition from moderate petitions to more assertive demands for self-governance. Through the leadership of Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Annie Besant, the movement inspired a new generation of nationalists, set the stage for subsequent mass movements, and forced the British government to consider constitutional reforms. Its legacy is seen in the heightened political awareness and activism that it fostered among Indians across the country.

INTRODUCTION

The first major attempt at a country-wide mass movement -- the Swadeshi Movement -- all but died out by 1907; the next major effort came after the First World War. In the intervening years, the national movement was to witness three different experiments in political action, all of which contributed in their own way to the furthering and deepening of national consciousness. The first experiment of revolutionary nationalism synchronized with the end of the mass phase of the Swadeshi movement, while the Ghadar Movement spanned the years of the First World War. In the later period, the two broad strands of revolutionary nationalism developed in India after 1922. The revolutionaries were mainly active in Punjab, U.P., Bihar, Madhya Pradesh (old central provinces) and Bengal. Dissatisfaction with Gandhi's leadership and his strategy of non-violent struggle after the suspension of Non-Cooperation Movement gave impetus to the revolutionary nationalist movement. The ideal of freedom which inspired the revolutionary nationalists inculcated the spirit of building a new society free from passion and exploitation. We will discuss all these issues in this

EARLY REVOLUTIONARY TRENDS

Revolutionary nationalism was the form of political action adopted by a generation of highly motivated nationalist youth whose creative energies failed to find adequate room for expression within the existing political trends.

Factors Leading to Early Revolutionary Trends The Extremists' critique of Moderate politics had convinced the youth of the futility of trying to convert the British rulers by petitioning and reasonable argument. They had participated actively in the Swadeshi movement in the hope and belief that Extremist methods of agitation such as boycott, passive resistance, etc., would take the national movement out of its elitist groove. They expected that this movement would bring the British Government to its knees. The Swadeshi movement was only partially successful in mobilizing vast sections of the masses. It also could not secure the reversal of the partition of Bengal. It led to a growing sense of impatience and frustration among the youth who began to feel that perhaps something even more dramatic was needed to arouse the people. The inability of the Extremist leadership to either adequately analyse the weaknesses of the movement or to suggest new ways out of the impasse further strengthened this trend. Some sections of the leadership, such as Aurobindo Ghosh, in fact supported the new trend. Those who did not quite agree preferred to remain silent rather than come out in open criticism, perhaps out of a feeling that this would be playing into Government hands.

Another factor that helped the growth of the trend of revolutionary nationalism was the brutal repression of the Swadeshi movement by the Government. For example the police made the unprovoked assault on the peaceful crowd at the Barisal Political Conference on 27th April, 1906 which had led the nationalist paper Jugantar to give the call "Force must be stopped by force". The Government's ability to repress was considerably enhanced by the split that took place in the Indian National Congress at Surat in 1907 between the Moderates and the Extremists, since it removed or at least reduced the danger of alienating the Moderates in the event of repression of the Extremists. Luring the Moderates with promises of constitutional reforms, the government proceeded to launch an all-out attack on the Extremists. Tilak was sentenced to six years of exile in Burma, Aurobindo Ghosh was arrested in a revolutionary conspiracy case. During this period a whole generation of nationalist youth, especially in Bengal, were:

- angered by repression
- convinced of the futility of the moderate path and
- impatient with the inability of the extremists to either extract immediate concessions from the government or to achieve a full scale mobilization of the masses. This young generation turned to the path of individual heroic action or revolutionary nationalism. Though believing in the necessity, in the longrun, of an armed mass revolt by the people in order to overthrow imperialism, the daunting nature of this task as well as of attempts to subvert the loyalty of the army left them with only one choice for immediate action: assassination of individual British officials, especially the unpopular ones. This was done:
 - in order to strike terror among officialdom;
 - remove the fear and inertia of the people; and
 - arouse their nationalist consciousness.

Early Activities Though the trend of revolutionary nationalism acquired a real force only around 1907-8, there had been earlier examples as well:

- As early as 1897 Damodar and Balkrishna Chapekar of Poona had assassinated two British officers.
- In Maharashtra again, by 1904, V.D. Savarkar and his brother Ganesh had organized the Mitramela and the Abhinav Bharat as secret societies.

- After 1905, many newspapers and individuals started advocating this form of political action. In 1907, there was an attempt, though unsuccessful, on the life of the Lieutenant Governor of Bengal. The real launching of the new trend is, however, identified with the throwing of a bomb in April 1908 by Khudiram Bose and Prafulla Chaki on a carriage in which they believed Kingsford, the unpopular district judge of Musaffarpur, to be travelling. But unfortunately, the carriage was carrying two British ladies who were thus inadvertently killed. Prafulla Chaki shot himself dead.

The government also used the opportunity to involve Aurobindo Ghosh, his brother Barin, and many others in a conspiracy case in which Aurobindo himself was acquitted but his brother and many others were sentenced to deportation and harsh prison terms. The repression by the British triggered off the formation of secret societies and a spate of assassinations and what were termed as ‘swadeshi’ dacoities to raise funds for buying arms, etc. In Bengal, which became the main centre of revolutionaries, the organization of revolutionary activities was spearheaded by the Anushilan and Jugantar societies. In Maharashtra, Poona, Nasik and Bombay became centres of revolutionary activity.

In Madras, Vanchi Aiyar of the Bharata Matha Association assassinated an official who was responsible for firing on a crowd that was protesting the arrest of the Extremist leader Chidambaram Pillai. In London, Madan Lal Dhingra killed Curzon Wylie, an India Office official and Rashbehari Bose organised a daring attempt on the life of the Viceroy, Lord Hardinge, as he entered Delhi on 23rd December, 1912. Other revolutionaries, such as Shyamji Krishna Varma, Lala Har Dayal, V.D. Savarkar, Ajit Singh and Madame Cama established centres in Europe from which they could continue to spread the revolutionary message and render assistance to comrades at home. In all, it was estimated that 186 revolutionaries were either killed or convicted in the years 1908-1918. 9.2.3 Decline of the Early Revolutionary Trend Stern repression facilitated by a series of draconian laws and the lack of a popular response led to the gradual decline of this wave of revolutionary nationalism. Individual heroic action undoubtedly earned the revolutionaries a great deal of popular adulation and sympathy, and many of them such as Khudiram Bose and Prafulla Chaki became folk heroes. By its very nature, however, this form of political action could only be emulated by a few individuals, and not by the mass of people, who still awaited a movement that could accommodate their weaknesses and make effective use of their strengths. Check Your Progress 1 1) Give two important causes for the growth of revolutionary nationalism in early period. 2) Write three main actions undertaken by the revolutionary nationalists.

THE GHADAR MOVEMENT

The First World War broke out in 1914 and to many Indian nationalists it appeared that once-in-a-lifetime opportunity had arrived to take advantage of Britain’s difficulty. Being embroiled in the War, it was felt, Britain would not be in a position to effectively answer a nationalist challenge. The Ghadar Movement was one such important revolutionary trend.

Background of the Movement

The Ghadar revolutionaries were recruited largely from the ranks of Punjabi immigrants who had settled on the West Coast of North America at least since 1904. They were mostly debt-ridden and land-hungry peasants from the crowded areas of Punjab, especially Jullundur and Hoshiarpur, many of whom had served in the British Indian Army and had thus acquired the

confidence and the means necessary for emigration. The hostile attitude of the local population including of the white labour unions, the increasingly restrictive immigration laws, helped by the active complicity of the Secretary of State for India -- all pushed the Indian community to the realization that they must organize themselves if they were to resist the blatant racial discrimination being imposed on them. For example, Tarak Nath Das, an Indian student who was one of the first leaders of the Indian community in North America and responsible for starting a paper called Free Hindustan understood very well that while the British government encouraged Indian labourers to go to work to Fiji where they were needed by British planters it discouraged their emigration to North America for they feared that they might get infected by the current ideas of liberty.

Early Activities The first stirrings of political activity among Indian immigrants became evident as early as 1907 when a Circular-e-Azadi (Circular of liberty) was brought out by Ramnath Puri, a political exile, in which he pledged support to the Swadeshi movement. Tarak Nath Das started the Free Hindustan and G.D. Kumar brought out a Gurmukhi paper Swadesh Sevak advocating social reform and asking Indian troops to rise in revolt. By 1910, Das and Kumar had set up the United India House in Seattle in the USA and began lecturing every week to a group of Indian labourers. They also developed close links with the Khalsa Diwan Society which resulted in 1913 in a decision to send a deputation to meet the Colonial Secretary in London and the Viceroy and other officials in India. They failed to meet the Colonial Secretary, despite a wait of a month, but succeeded in securing an audience with the Viceroy and the Lieutenant Governor of Punjab.

Their visit to Punjab became the occasion for a series of public meetings in different Punjab towns and enthusiastic support from the people and the press. Meanwhile, in early 1913, Bhagwan Singh, a Sikh priest who had worked in Hong Kong and the Malay states, visited Vancouver in Canada and openly preached the violent overthrow of British rule. Such was the effect of his exhortations that he was externed from Canada after three months, but his ideas had fired the imagination of his audiences.

Towards Organization Disappointed with the lack of response from the Indian and British governments, convinced that their inferior status in foreign lands was a consequence of their being citizens of an enslaved country, and aroused to nationalist consciousness and a feeling of solidarity by the consistent political agitation, the Indian community in North America felt the acute need for a central organization and a leader. The leader they found was Lala Har Dayal, a political exile from India, who had come to the U.S. in 1911 and had been lecturing at Stanford University as well as to the various American groups of intellectuals, radicals and workers on the anarchist and syndicalist movements but had not shown much interest in the affairs of Indian immigrants. His attitude changed with the news of the bomb attack on the Viceroy in Delhi in December 1912 which convinced him that the The Revolutionaries revolutionary spirit was still alive.

He assumed leadership of the immigrant Indian community and, in May 1913, the need for a central organization was met with the setting up of the Hindi Association in Portland, which later changed its name to Hindustan Ghadar Party. Baba Sohan Singh Bhakna was elected the President, Lala Har Dayal the General Secretary and Pandit Kanshi Ram Maroli the Treasurer at the first meeting of the Association which was also attended by others including Bhai Parmanand and Harnam Singh 'Tundilat'. A sum of \$ 10,000 was collected on the spot and

decisions were taken to set up a headquarter by the name of Yugantar Ashram in San Francisco and start a weekly paper, the Ghadar, for free circulation. 9.3.4 Strategy and Action The plans of political action outlined by Lala Har Dayal and accepted by the Hindi Association were based on the understanding that British rule could only be overthrown by armed revolt and that for this to happen it was necessary that Indian immigrants go to India in large numbers and carry this message to the masses and the soldiers of the Indian army. He also believed that the freedom available in America should be used to fight the British and not the Americans, for in any case Indians would never be accepted as equals abroad till they were free in their own land. Basing themselves on this understanding, the militant nationalists launched a vigorous propaganda campaign, touring factories and farms where Indian immigrants worked. The paper Ghadar was launched on the first of November, 1913; the first issue was in Urdu followed a month later by the Gurmukhi version. The format of the Ghadar paper was designed to convey the message of nationalism in simple and bold terms. Its very name meant revolt, thereby leaving no doubts about its intentions. On its masthead was inscribed the caption: Angrezi Raj Ka Dushman or 'An Enemy of British Rule'. Besides, the front page of each issue carried the 'Angrezi Raj Ka Kacha Chittha' or 'An Expose of British Rule', which consisted of 14 points enumerating the negative effects of British rule. This Chittha was in effect a summary of the entire nationalist critique of British rule on the issues of drain of wealth, high land revenue, low per capita income, recurrence of famines which killed millions of Indians, high expenditure on Army and low expenditure on health, the policy of divide and rule by pitting Hindus and Muslims against each other. The last two points of the Chittha also pointed to the way out by highlighting the small number of Englishmen present in India as compared to the crores of Indians and by suggesting that the time had come for another revolt since already fifty-six years had lapsed since the last one in 1857.

The Ghadar was, of course, circulated widely among Indian immigrants in North America, but it soon reached immigrants in the Philippines, Hong Kong, China, Malay states, Singapore, Trinidad and the Honduras as well as Indian regiments stationed in many of these centres. It was sent to India as well. The response it generated among immigrant communities was tremendous, groups were formed to read it and discuss the issues it raised and contributions poured in.

GHADAR MOVEMENT: THE MAIN EVENTS

The subsequent course of the Ghadar Movement was, however, determined by three major events in 1914: the arrest, jumping of bail and flight to Switzerland of Lala Har Dayal, the fateful voyage of the ship Komagata Maru, and the beginning of the First World War. In March, 1914 Har Dayal was arrested. The most likely reason was the pressure exerted by the British government who for obvious reasons would like to see him removed from the leadership of the Ghadar Movement, but the stated reason was his anarchist activities. He was released on bail and it was decided that he would jump bail and go the Switzerland. Meanwhile, in an attempt to defy Canadian immigration laws which forbade entry to all except those who made a "direct passage in their own ship," Gurdit Singh, an Indian contractor living in Singapore chartered a ship, the Komagata Maru, and, with 376 Indian passengers originating from various places in East and South East Asia, set sail for Vancouver. On the way, Ghadar party mobilizers visited the ship, gave lectures and

distributed literature. Receiving prior intimation of the intended immigration, the Press in Vancouver warned of the 'Mounting Oriental Invasion' and the Canadian government prepared to meet the challenge by tightening its laws. On arrival, the ship was not allowed into the port and was cordoned off by the police. Despite the strenuous efforts of the "Shore Committee" in Vancouver led by Husain Rahim, Sohan Lal Pathak and Balwant Singh and a powerful campaign in the USA led by Barkatullah, Bhagwan Singh, Ram Chandra and Sohan Singh Bhakna, the Komagata Maru was forced out of Canadian waters. Before it reached Japan, the First World War broke out and the British government ordered that no passenger was to be allowed to leave the ship till it reached Calcutta. Its return journey triggered off a wave of resentment at every port of call among the communities of immigrant Indians and heightened anti-British feelings. When the ship reached Budge Budge near Calcutta, the hostile attitude of the police led to a clash which resulted in the death of 18 passengers. 202 were arrested and the rest succeeded in running away.

The third and most important event that brought about a dramatic change in the situation was the outbreak of the First World War. This was the opportunity that the Ghadarites had been waiting for to seize and to make the best of Britain's difficulty. It came earlier than they had expected, and their preparations were still in a rudimentary stage. Nevertheless, a special meeting of the leading workers of the party met and decided that the time had come for action and that their biggest weakness, lack of arms, could be made good by persuading the Indian soldiers to revolt. The Ghadar party accordingly issued its Ailan-e-Jung or 'Proclamation of War', which was circulated among Indians living abroad. Ghadar activists also embarked on tours exhorting people to return to India and organize a revolt. The response was tremendous, with large numbers offering themselves and their entire belongings to the cause of the nation. Encouraged by this the Ghadar party began the exodus to India, and batches of revolutionaries began to arrive in India by different routes in the latter half of 1914.

The Government of India was lying in wait, armed with the new Ingress The Revolutionaries into India Ordinance. Returning immigrants were carefully scrutinized, and of an estimated 8,000 who returned, 5,000 who were considered 'safe' were allowed to go unhindered. Of the remaining, some were interned in their villages, others detained. Nevertheless, many hardcore activists succeeded in reaching Punjab. Ghadar activists toured the villages, cyclostyled and distributed party publications, addressed gatherings at melas and made every effort to persuade the people to rise in revolt. But the Punjab in 1914 was very different from what they had expected, and the people were in no mood to embark upon the romantic Ghadar adventure. They had also to contend with the active hostility of loyalist elements such as the Chief Khalsa Diwan who declared them to be apostates or fallen Sikhs and criminals and cooperated fully in the government's efforts to crush them. Disappointed with the popular response, the Ghadar revolutionaries next attempted to spread their message among the soldiers and engineer a mutiny. Attempts at revolt in November 1914 failed for lack of proper organization and centralized leadership. Another, more organized, attempt was made in February 1915 after Rash Behari Bose had been contacted and entrusted the task of leadership and organization. But this too proved abortive as the government succeeded in penetrating the organization and taking preemptive measures. Bose managed to escape, but most of the other leaders were arrested and the Ghadar movement effectively crushed. The repression that followed was the heaviest possible: 42 were sentenced to death and 200 to

long prison terms. As a consequence, an entire generation of the nationalist leadership of Punjab was politically beheaded. Efforts by Indian revolutionaries in Berlin to use German help and organize mutinies among Indian troops stationed abroad and by Raja Mahendra Pratap and Barkatullah to enlist the aid of the Amir of Afghanistan proved equally abortive. Violent rebellion to overthrow British rule was not fated to have much success.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND WEAKNESSES

In this section we will discuss the achievements and failures of the Ghadar movement.

Achievements:

The Ghadarites succeeded in popularizing nationalist ideology -- especially the critique of colonialism and the understanding that Indian poverty and backwardness was a consequence of British rule among vast masses of Indians in India and abroad.

They created a cadre of highly motivated nationalists and, though many of these were lost through repression, some permanently and others for a number of years, continued to play an important role in building up the national and later the left and peasant movements in Punjab and other parts of India for many decades to follow. Ghadar ideology was also strongly egalitarian and democratic in content. Their aim was to set up an independent republic in India. Har Dayal, deeply influenced as he was by the anarchist and syndicalist movements, also imparted to the movement an egalitarian outlook. His constant references to the Irish, Mexican, and Russian revolutionaries also helped in saving the movement from a chauvinist nationalism and in giving it an internationalist character.

But perhaps the most important achievement of the Ghadarites was that, despite the fact that the vast majority of their followers were recruited from amongst Punjabi Sikh immigrants, they never betrayed any communal tendencies and were, on the contrary, strongly secular in their outlook.

Weaknesses:

The Ghadar movement inevitably had its share of weaknesses as well, the chief of which was its over-estimation of the level of readiness of the movement. One might say that they sounded the bugles of war without stopping to examine the state of their own army. The response that they evoked in the immigrant Indian community, whose nationalist consciousness was aroused by daily experiences of racial insult, alienation produced by living in unfamiliar surroundings, and whose small numbers made the task of its organization relatively easier, misled them into thinking that the vast mass of Indians in India were also in a similar state of readiness. They also underestimated the might of the British rulers, the strength of the ideological foundations of their rule, and thought that all that the people of India needed was a call to revolt. The cost that had to be paid for this crucial weakness not only by the Ghadar movement but by the entire national movement was heavy indeed, for it is not unlikely that if the major part of the Ghadar leadership had not been removed from the scene, the political complexion of the national movement, certainly in Punjab, would have been very different indeed as the Ghadarites with their committed nationalist and

secular ideology would inevitably have played a critical role in checking the communal tendencies that were to raise their head in later years.

Check Your Progress 2

- 1) What were the aims of Ghadar Party?
- 2) What was the main achievement of the Ghadar movement?

HINDUSTAN REPUBLICAN ASSOCIATION

(HRA)

The Sudden suspension of the Non-Cooperation Movement in early 1922 after the Chauri-Chaura incident led to a wave of disappointment and discontent among the young participants in the movement. Many of them were disenchanted with Gandhi's leadership and began to question the very basic strategy of non-violent struggle. Once again they turned to the idea of violent overthrow of British rule. In this respect they also drew inspiration from the revolutionary movements and uprisings in Russia, Ireland, Turkey, Egypt and China. While the old revolutionary leaders revived their organizations, many new revolutionary nationalist leaders emerged from the ranks of enthusiastic non-cooperators. Thus Jogesh Chandra Chatterjee, Sukhdev, Bhagwati Charan Vohra – all had participated in the Non-Cooperation Movement.

Two broad strands of revolutionary nationalism developed after 1922: One in Punjab, U.P., Bihar and Madhya Pradesh (old Central Provinces) and the other in Bengal. Both the strands came under the influence of new social ideological forces.

- One such influence was the growth of socialist ideas and groups all over India.
- Second was the rise of a militant trade union movement.
- And the third was the Russian Revolution of 1917 and the consequent rise of the Soviet Republic.

Revolutionaries of northern India began their reorganization under the leadership of Sachindranath Sanyal, Jogesh Chatterjee and Ramprasad Bismil. In October 1924, they met at Kanpur and founded the Hindustan Republican Association (HRA) and set out the objective of organization an armed revolution against colonial rule and establishing a Federal Republic of the United States of India with a government elected on the basis of adult franchise.

To finance their organization and with the objective of propaganda and collection of arms, etc., the HRA leaders decided to organize dacoities against the Government. The most important of these was the Kakori robbery. On 9th August, 1925, ten revolutionaries held up the 8-Down train from Saharanpur to Lucknow at Kakori, a small village station near Lucknow and looted its official railway cash. The Government, however, succeeded in arresting a large number of HRA members and leaders involved in the dacoity. They were tried in the Kakori conspiracy case. The prisoners were subjected to cruel treatment in the jails; and in protest they had to take recourse to hunger

strikes several times. Asfaqullah Khan, Ramprasad Bismil, Roshan Singh and Rajendra Lahiri were hanged, four others were sent to Andamans (Kala Pani) for life, and 17 were sentenced to long terms of imprisonment.

THE HINDUSTAN SOCIALIST REPUBLICAN ASSOCIATION (HSRA)

The Kakori case decimated the revolutionary ranks, but soon a new batch of young persons came forward to fill the gap. Bejoy Kumar Sinha, Shiv Verma and Jaidev Kumar in U.P. and Bhagat Singh, Bhagwati Charan Vohra and Sukhdev in Punjab started the reorganization of the HRA under the leadership of Chandrashekhar Azad. They also came under the influence of socialist ideas. Finally, the representative revolutionary nationalists of northern India met at Ferozeshah Kotla Ground in Delhi on 9th and 10th September, 1928. They accepted Socialism as their official goal and changed the name of the party of Hindustan Socialist Republican Association.

The leadership of the HSRA was rapidly moving towards the idea of massbased armed struggle and away from individual heroic action. But when Lala Lajpat Rai, one of the greatest of nationalist leaders, died as a result of a brutal lathi-charge when he was leading an anti-Simon Commission demonstration at Lahore on 30 October, 1928, the angry and romantic youth felt that it was necessary to avenge this grave insult to the nation. This compelled them to take recourse once again to the earlier practice of individual assassination. And so, on 17th December, 1928, Bhagat Singh, Chandrashekhar Azad and Rajguru assassinated Saunders, a police official involved in the lathi-charge.

As a part of their advance from positions of individual heroic action, the HSRA leaders now decided to propagate their political thinking among the people so that a mass revolutionary movement could be organized. Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt were deputed to throw bombs in the Central Legislative Assembly on 8 April 1929 to protest against the passage of the Public Safety Bill and the Trade Disputes Bill, which would reduce civil liberties in general and curb the right of workers to organize and struggle in particular, and against the “wholesale arrests of leaders of the labour movement”. The aim was not to kill, for the bombs were relatively harmless. The objective was, as the leaflet they threw into the Assembly proclaimed, “to make the deaf hear”. Bhagat Singh and Dutt made no attempt to escape. Their intention was to get arrested and to use the trial court as a forum for propaganda so that the programme and ideology of the HSRA could get widely propagated among the people.

Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt were tried in the Assembly Bomb Case. Then the police was able to uncover the details of the Saunders assassination and Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru, and several others were tried in the ‘Lahore Conspiracy case’. Bhagat Singh and his comrades turned the court into a forum of propaganda. Their statements were published in the newspapers and widely discussed by the people. Their defiant and courageous conduct

in the court won them the admiration of the people. Even believers in nonviolence loved them for their patriotism. Every day they entered the courtroom shouting “Inquilab Zindabad”, “Down, Down with Imperialism” and “Long Live the Proletariat” and singing patriotic songs. Bhagat Singh became a household name in the land.

The country was also stirred by the prolonged hunger strike the revolutionaries on trial undertook as a protest against the horrible conditions in jail. They demanded that they should be treated not as ordinary criminals but as political prisoners. On 13th September, 1929, Jatin Das, a frail young man possessing an iron-will, died fasting. The entire nation was massively stirred. Thousands came to pay him homage at every station as the train carried his body from Lahore to Calcutta. In Calcutta, a two-mile long procession of more than six lakh people carried his coffin to the cremation ground.

A large number of revolutionaries were convicted in the Lahore Conspiracy Case and other similar cases and sentenced to long-terms of imprisonment. Many of them were sent to the Cellular Jail in the Andamans. Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru were sentenced to be hanged. The sentence was carried out on 23rd March, 1931. As the news of their hanging spread, a death-like silence engulfed the entire country. All over the country, millions of people shed tears and fasted and refused to attend schools or carry on their daily work. Bhagat Singh soon became a legend in the country. His photographs adorned homes and shops. Hundreds of song were composed and sung about him. His popularity rivaled that of Gandhiji.

IDEOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENT OF THE NORTH INDIAN REVOLUTIONARIES

The HRA and HSRA developed a radical social ideology and thought to guide their activities and the forms of revolutionary struggle too were better defined.

The HRA

The HRA had already started evolving a programme within a broad secular, democratic and socialist framework. In 1925, its manifesto had set forth its objective as the establishment of “a Federal Republic of the United States of India by an organized and armed revolution”. The basic principle of the Republic was to be “universal suffrage and the abolition of all systems which make any kind of exploitation of man by man possible”. HRA’s founding council, in its meeting in October 1924 had decided “to preach social revolutionary and communistic principles”. It had decided “to start labour peasant organization”. It advocated nationalization of the railways and large-scale industries such as steel, ship-building and mines.

Bhagat Singh and the HSRA

A major shift in the ideological development of the revolutionary nationalists occurred when young leaders such as Bejoy Sinha, Shiv Varma, Sukhdev,

Bhagwati Charan Vohra and Bhagat Singh turned to Socialism and Marxism. This shift is best epitomized in the life and thought of Bhagat Singh, many of whose letters, statements and writings have now become available. Bhagat Singh was born in 1907 in a famous patriotic family. His father was a Congressman and his uncle was the famous revolutionary Ajit Singh. Bhagat Singh was deeply influenced by the Ghadar hero, Kartar Singh Sarabha. Bhagat Singh was a voracious reader and had read extensive literature on socialism, the Soviet Union and revolutionary movements the world over. At Lahore he and Sukhdev organized study circles for young students. The HSRA leaders carried on intensive political discussion among themselves. After his arrest he studied intensively in the jails. This devotion to intensive reading was also true of other leaders such as Bejoy Sinha, Yashpal, Shiv Varma and Bhagwati Charan Vohra. Chandrashekhar Azad knew little English, but he too fully participated in political discussions and followed every major turn in the field of ideas.

Bhagat Singh had already before his arrest in 1929 had come to believe that broad popular mass-based movements alone could liberate India and mankind from servitude. As he put it, revolution could only be achieved “by the masses for the masses”. That is why he helped found the Naujawan Bharat Sabha in 1926 to carry out political work among the youth, peasants, and workers. He became its founding secretary. It was expected to open branches in the villages. Bhagat Singh and Sukhdev also organized the Lahore Students’ Union for open political work among students. In fact, Bhagat Singh never identified revolution with the cult of the bomb. In the course of their statements and manifestoes from 1929 to 1931, Bhagat Singh and his comrades gave repeated expression to their growing conviction that revolution meant arousing the masses and organizing a mass movement. Just before his execution, Bhagat Singh declared that “the real revolutionary armies are in the villages and in factories”. Bhagat Singh and his comrades also redefined the scope and meaning of Revolution. Revolution was no longer equated with mere militancy or violence. Its first objective was national liberation and then the building of a new socialist society. In their statement in the court at Delhi in the Legislative Assembly Bomb Case they made a clear statement of what they meant by revolution: “Radical change, therefore, is necessary, and it is the duty of those who realize this to reorganize society on a socialistic basis”. What was necessary was to end “exploitation of man by man and of nation by nation”.

REVOLUTIONARY NATIONALISTS IN BENGAL

In Bengal too the revolutionary nationalists began reorganization after 1922. They resumed large-scale propaganda in the press and developed their underground activities. At the same time they continued to work in the Congress organization from the village to the provincial levels. This was because they realized that the Congress had developed under

Gandhiji's leadership a mass base, and work inside the Congress enabled the revolutionaries to get access to the masses, in particular the youth. At the same time their role within the Congress enabled it to acquire active workers in the small towns and rural areas. In many ways, C.R. Das acted as an emotional link between the revolutionaries and the Congress. After his death, the Congress leadership gradually got divided into two wings, one led by Subhas Chandra Bose and the other by J.M. Sengupta. The revolutionaries too got divided. The Yugantar joined forces with the Bose wing and the Anushilan group with the Sengupta wing.

Already, by 1924, major revolutionary nationalists had understood the utter inadequacy of individual heroic action, and intellectually and programmatically accepted the strategy of national liberation through armed seizure of power by mass uprisings. But, in practice, they still relied upon small scale 'actions', in particular dacoities and assassination of officials. One of the several such 'actions' was Gopinath Saha's attempt in January 1924 to assassinate Charles Tegart, the hated Police Commissioner of Calcutta. Even though the attempt failed, Gopinath Saha was arrested, tried and hanged on 1 March 1924 despite massive popular protest. The Government now took alarm and started large scale repression. It arrested a large number of revolutionary leaders and activists under a newly promulgated ordinance. Moreover, a large number of Congressmen, including Subhas Bose, suspected of being sympathetic to the revolutionaries were also arrested. Nearly all the major leaders being in jail, revolutionary activity suffered a severe setback.

Revolutionary activity also suffered because of factional and personal quarrels within the ranks of the old revolutionary leaders. Quarrels on the basis of Jugantar vs. Anushilan were endemic. However, after their release after 1926 many of the younger revolutionaries, critical of the older leaders, began to organize themselves into a large number of new groups which came to be known as Revolt Groups. These groups tried to base themselves on the experience of Russian and Irish revolutionaries. Learning from the past experience, the new Revolt Groups developed friendly relations with the active elements of both the Anushilan and Jugantar Samitis. Among the new groups, it was the Chittagong group led by Surya Sen that acquired great fame and prominence.

THE CHITTAGONG ARMOURY RAID

Surya Sen gathered a large band of revolutionary youth including Anant Singh, Ganesh Ghosh, Ambika Chakravarty and Loknath Paul. In early 1929 they formed a plan to organize an armed rebellion, even though on a small scale, to demonstrate that British rule could be challenged through arms. In order to equip themselves adequately with arms, they planned to raid armouries in several districts. They also started a vigorous propaganda campaign.

The first action was to be in Chittagong. Their action-plan was carefully prepared and included the occupation of the two main armouries in Chittagong and the arming of a large band of revolutionaries with the seized arms. The telephone, telegraph and the railway communication systems between Chittagong and the rest of the Bengal were to be disrupted. The young band of revolutionaries, who were to participate in the armoury raid, were selected and trained with great care. The plan was put into operation at 10 O'clock on the night 18 April 1930. Six young men, led by Ganesh Ghosh, captured the police armoury shouting "Inquilab Zindabad", "Down with Imperialism" and "Gandhiji's Raj has been established". Another group of revolutionaries captured the Auxiliary Force Armoury. The raid was undertaken in the name of Indian Republican Army, Chittagong Branch. All the revolutionary groups gathered outside the Police Armoury. Surya Sen was formally declared the President of the Provisional Revolutionary Government. The Union Jack was pulled down and the National Flag was hoisted instead among slogans of "Bande Matram" and "Inquilab Zindabad". Since it was not possible to fight the British forces which were expected to arrive soon, the revolutionary band took its positions on the Jalalabad hill where on 22 April they were surrounded by thousands of enemy troops. After a fierce and heroic fight in which 12 revolutionaries died, Surya Sen decided to abandon frontal warfare and launch instead guerilla warfare from the neighbouring villages. Despite severe suppressive measures, the revolutionaries survived for nearly three years because of shelter and support provided by the villages, most of them Muslim. Surya Sen was finally arrested on 16 February 1933, tried and hanged on 12 January 1934. The Chittagong Armoury Raid had an immense impact on the people of Bengal. Consequent upon the Armoury Raid, there was a major revival of revolutionary activity. In Midnapore alone, three British magistrates were assassinated. Two Inspector-Generals of Police were killed and attempts were made on the lives of two Governors. The Government responded with massive repression. It armed itself with 20 repressive acts. In Chittagong, it burnt several villages and imposed punitive fines on many others. It arrested the revolutionaries indiscriminately.

The new phase of revolutionary nationalism in Bengal had certain new aspects. One was the large-scale participation by young women. It also showed that, unlike the older Bengal revolutionaries and the northern Indian revolutionaries, the Revolt Groups in Bengal had moved into group action aimed at an armed uprising. Though they failed to organize an armed uprising on a significant scale, the direction of their activities was clear.

DECLINE OF THE REVOLUTIONARY NATIONALIST MOVEMENT

The revolutionary nationalist movement gradually declined in the 1930s. This was for several reasons. The mainstream of the national movement,

led by Gandhiji, was opposed to violence even when its leaders admired the heroism of its youthful practitioners and defended them in the courts and condemned the police repression directed against them. Government's strong action also gradually decimated the revolutionary ranks. With the death of Chandrashekar Azad on 27 February 1931 in an encounter with the police in a public park at Allahabad, the revolutionary movement in northern India came to a virtual end. Surya Sen's martyrdom marked the virtual collapse of revolutionary nationalism in Bengal. Revolutionaries in jail or in Andamans started a serious rethinking about their politics. A large number of them turned to Marxism as Bhagat Singh and many of his comrades had already done in the 1920s. Many joined the Communist Party, the Congress Socialist Party, the Revolutionary Socialist Party and other left parties and groups. Others joined the Gandhian wing of the Congress. Even though the revolutionary nationalists of the 1920s and 1930s failed in their stated objective of leading a mass-based armed struggle or failed even to establish contact with the masses, they made a major contribution to the ongoing national struggle against colonialism. Their courage and sacrifice and their deep patriotism aroused the Indian people, especially the youth and gave them pride and self-confidence. In north India, Bhagat Singh and his comrades also sowed the seeds of socialist thought and movement.

Check Your Progress 3

- 1) Discuss the ideology and strategy of HRA and HSRA.
- 2) Discuss the main activities of revolutionary nationalists in Bengal.
- 3) What were the factors responsible for the decline of revolutionary nationalist movement in India?

LET US SUM UP

In this Unit, we have seen how revolutionary trends emerged within the National Movement. The Anushilan and Jugantar societies were important trends in the early revolutionary movement. The Revolutionary activities were not confined to any one region of the country and at times they even crossed the boundaries of India. The Ghadar Party is the best example of this. The Government suppressed these movements with an iron hand. And yet these movements were successful in generating and adding to the anti-British consciousness. However, their major weakness was their isolation from the masses in general.

You also studied the two broad strands of revolutionary nationalism in the later period which developed in India after 1922 – one in Punjab, U.P., Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, and the other in Bengal. In both regions in this period, the revolutionaries were moving away from the idea of individual heroic action to the idea of mass based armed struggle. Although the movement failed in its stated objective of leading a mass-based armed struggle but it made a major contribution to the ongoing national struggle against colonialism. courage, sacrifice and patriotism of the revolutionary nationalists inspired

the Indian youth and restored their pride and self-confidence.

Chandra Shekhar Azad

On 23 July, India paid tribute to the freedom fighter **Chandra Shekhar Azad** on his

Birth: Azad was born on **23 July 1906** in the **Alirajpur district of Madhya Pradesh**.

Early Life: Chandra Shekhar, then a 15-year-old student, joined a **Non-Cooperation Movement** in December 1921. As a result, he was arrested. On being presented before a magistrate, he gave his name as "**Azad**" (**The Free**), his father's name as "Swatantrata" (Independence) and his residence as "Jail".

Therefore, he came to be known as **Chandra Shekhar Azad**.

Contribution to Freedom Movement:

Hindustan Republican Association: After the suspension of the noncooperation movement in 1922 by Gandhi, Azad joined Hindustan Republican Association (HRA).

HRA was a revolutionary organization of India established in 1924 in East Bengal by **Sachindra Nath Sanyal, Narendra Mohan Sen and Pratul Ganguly** as an offshoot of **Anushilan Samiti**.

Members: Bhagat Singh, **Chandra Shekhar Azad**, Sukhdev, Ram Prasad Bismil, Roshan Singh, Ashfaqulla Khan, Rajendra Lahiri.

Kakori Conspiracy: Most of the fund collection for revolutionary activities was done through **robberies of government property**. In line with the same, Kakori Train Robbery near Kakori, Lucknow was done in **1925 by HRA**. The **plan was executed** by Chandra Shekhar Azad, Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan, Rajendra Lahiri, and Manmathnath Gupta.

Hindustan Socialist Republican Association: HRA was later reorganised as the Hindustan Socialist Republican Army (HSRA).

It was established in **1928** at Feroz Shah Kotla in New Delhi by Chandra Shekhar Azad, Ashfaqulla Khan, **Bhagat Singh**, Sukhdev Thapar and Jogesh Chandra Chatterjee.

HSRA planned the **shooting of J. P. Saunders**, a British Policeman at Lahore in 1928 **to avenge the killing of Lala Lajpat Rai**.

Death: He died at **Azad Park in Allahabad** on 27 February 1931.

Source: PIB

If yet your blood does not rage, then it is water that flows through your veins. For what is the flush of youth, if it is not the service to the motherland."

~Chandra Shekhar Azad

On the occasion of the **birth anniversary** of this legendary freedom fighter and nationalist born in India, let us take a peek into the history of this whirlwind of revolution. India has been a devoted mother to all her children through all eras of history and as dedicated have been her children, in their faith and yearning for their motherland, in their own ways and capacities. One such revolutionary son, leader and fighter was **Chandrashekhar Azad**, who embraced martyrdom over slavery, embodying courage at its best.

Introduction to Azad's Revolutionary Activities

Azad was born to parents Pandit Sitaram Tiwari and Jagrani Devi on 23rd July 1906 in the district of Alirajpur in Madhya Pradesh. During his childhood, he mastered skills like swimming, wrestling, and archery, with the advantage of being surrounded by a **Bhil community**. After completing his formal primary education in his hometown, Azad completed his higher education at Kashi Vidhyapeeth, Banares. Initially christened as 'Chandrashekhar Tiwari', the title 'Azad' to his name later symbolizes the yearning for freedom and the metaphor of bravery.

Chandrashekhar pursued his education in the field of **Sanskrit** at Kashi Vidyapeeth, where he was first introduced to and became passionate about the idea of **nationalism**. He was immensely triggered by the **Jallianwalla Bagh massacre** during his early teens. The **Non-Cooperation movement** led by **Mahatma Gandhi** also inspired his patriotic sentiments and he later joined the movement actively. After the calling off of the Non-Cooperation movement, his dissatisfaction with Gandhi's non-violent views made him turn towards a more radical and violent approach towards the British.

Azad's Participation in the Kakori Conspiracy

Azad's contribution to Kakori Conspiracy was significant and crucial. The **Kakori Conspiracy** took place as a train loot by Indian revolutionaries of the Hindustan Republican Association (HRA) on 9 August 1925 near Lucknow. They looted the British Government Treasury and killed a train passenger.

Four of the arrested members were hanged, one was imprisoned for life, and others were jailed, Azad being an unapprehended suspect. He was one of the main planners of the train robbery, along with **Bismil** and Ashfaqulla Khan. He boarded the train at Lucknow and pulled the chain near Kakori to stop it to help his comrades to overpower the guard and other passengers and to loot the cash chest. Azad was also one of the few revolutionaries who managed to escape the police charges and remained underground for several years. He then reorganized the HRA as the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA) and continued to lead the revolutionary movement.

The Kakori Conspiracy was an important event in the freedom struggle because it reflected the courage and sacrifice of the revolutionaries who challenged British rule, created a wave of sympathy, and inspired others to join the cause.

Formation and Ideology of the HSRA

Azad established the HSRA in 1928 with the support of **Bhagat Singh** and other national fighters dissatisfied with the HRA due to its nonviolent methods. The HSRA aimed to eradicate British rule in India and establish a socialist republic by creating a huge movement of workers, peasants, and students to promote revolutionary propaganda,, acquire arms and ammunition for armed rebellion and oppose **communalism** and spread **secularism**.

Guerrilla warfare strategy was adopted and implemented by the HSRA on the principles like striking at the weak points of the enemy and avoiding direct confrontation with superior forces, using surprise, speed, and mobility to carry out swift and daring attacks on the enemy, using explosives, firearms, knives, and other weapons to inflict maximum damage and to blend in with the local population for support and enabling quick retreat after each attack to avoid capture and detection by enemies.

Azad's guerrilla warfare principles were based on strong ideas of anti-colonialism, socialism, mass mobilization, and cooperation. His guerrilla warfare examples were the Kakori train robbery, Saunders assassination, Viceroy's train bombing, and the Alfred Park encounter.

Azad recruited, trained and mentored many young revolutionaries, such as Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, **Rajguru**, and others. He also coordinated with other nationalist and anti-imperialist forces by building strong networks in the country such as with **Jayaprakash Narayan and other** influential leaders.

Azad's Contribution to Chittagong Armoury Raid

The Chittagong Armoury raid was an impactful attempt by Indian revolutionaries led by Surya Sen to seize weapons from the British armoury in Chittagong in 1930 which was inspired by Easter Rising in Ireland and Communism in Russia. It challenged the British authority and inspired other revolutionaries and showed the collective strength and courage of the Indian youth. Although the raid failed due to a lack of ammunition and betrayal by informers, it exposed the brutality and the repression inflicted by the British regime.

Azad's contribution to the Chittagong Armoury raid was indirect but significant. He was not physically present but was one of the mentors and supporters of Surya Sen. He also provided him with funds, arms, and ammunition for the raid. He had also sent some of his comrades, such as Ananta Singh and Kalpana Dutta, to join Surya Sen's group in Chittagong. Azad maintained contact with Surya Sen and his associates after the raid and tried to rescue them from the British.

Azad's Role in Lahore Conspiracy Case

The Lahore Conspiracy case (1928) was a series of trials against many Indian revolutionaries involved in the failed Ghadar conspiracy in 1915, led by **Rash Behari Bose** who escaped arrest. Azad's role in the Lahore conspiracy case was instrumental, being one of the masterminds and participants in the assassination of John Saunders, a British police officer, in Lahore in December 1928. Azad was involved in the escape of Bhagat Singh and other revolutionaries after the killing, along with being one of the planners and supporters of the bombing of the Central Legislative Assembly in Delhi in 1929 by Bhagat Singh and **Batukeshwar Dutt**. He claimed responsibility for both actions and was declared an absconder by the British authorities and faced trial in absentia in the Lahore conspiracy case.

Comparison of Azad's Approach with Other Freedom Fighters

Chandrashekhar Azad was different in his vision from other freedom fighters in his approach to nationalism and his methods of struggle. He was one of the few leaders who advocated armed struggle against the British, while most of the others followed Gandhi's non-violence and civil disobedience. He wanted to establish a republican and secular state after independence. He did not believe in the two-nation theory or the communal politics of the Muslim League and opposed the **partition of India**. Azad was also greatly influenced by the Islamic faith and pan-Islamic sentiments and tried to reconcile Islam with modernity and democracy.

Contemporary Relevance of Azad's Revolutionary Ideas

Chandrashekhar Azad's techniques and strategies have ample relevance in present-day India, especially in the context of social movements and protests against injustice and oppression. His courage, commitment, and organizational skills can inspire people to stand up for their rights and dignity. His socialist, secular and humanist vision can also guide people to work for a more inclusive and democratic society.

Azad can be an inspiration to today's generation for his **patriotism**, bravery, and sacrifice. He was a leader who fought for freedom and justice and gave his life to the nation. He was also a visionary who had a socialist, secular, and humanist outlook. He can motivate people to be fearless and committed to the cause of social change.

Conclusion

At a glance, Chandrashekhar Azad was an impactful and influential revolutionary who fought for India's independence from British rule. He died as a martyr at the age of 24, inspiring millions of Indians to join the freedom struggle and leaving an immortal trace in history.

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Chandra Shekhar Azad, born Chandrashekhar Tiwari on July 23, 1906, in Bhavra village in present-day Madhya Pradesh, was one of the most fearless and influential revolutionaries during India's struggle for independence. Here's an overview of his life and contributions:

Early Life and Education

- **Background:** Azad hailed from a humble background. His family had a history of participating in the freedom movement, which influenced his own activism.
- **Education:** He received his early education in Bhavra and later moved to Varanasi for further studies.

Revolutionary Activities

- **Entry into the Movement:** Azad was deeply inspired by the Jallianwala Bagh massacre in 1919 and was drawn to the non-cooperation movement led by Mahatma Gandhi.
- **Hindustan Republican Association (HRA):** He joined the HRA, a revolutionary organization founded by Ram Prasad Bismil, and became one of its key members.

Role in the Kakori Conspiracy

- **Planning and Execution:** Azad played a significant role in the Kakori Conspiracy (1925), in which members of the HRA looted a train carrying government funds near Kakori, Uttar Pradesh.
- **Symbol of Resistance:** His daring actions during the Kakori Conspiracy made him a symbol of resistance against British rule and earned him the nickname "Azad," meaning "free."

Leadership and Ideology

- **Leadership:** After the arrest of many leaders of the HRA, including Ram Prasad Bismil, Azad emerged as one of the key leaders of the revolutionary movement.

- **Ideology:** He believed in the use of armed struggle to overthrow British rule and achieve complete independence for India. He advocated for socialism and the rights of the oppressed.

Formation of the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA)

- **Vision:** Azad, along with Bhagat Singh and others, transformed the HRA into the HSRA, which aimed to establish a socialist society based on equality and justice.
- **Activities:** The HSRA engaged in several acts of resistance against British rule, including the assassination of British police officer J.P. Saunders in Lahore in 1928.

Final Stand at Alfred Park (now Chandrashekhar Azad Park)

- **Encounter with Police:** On February 27, 1931, Azad was surrounded by British police in Alfred Park, Allahabad. Rather than surrendering, he chose to fight to the end.
- **Death:** In the ensuing gun battle, Azad kept fighting alone, sustaining multiple bullet wounds. Realizing he was trapped and would be captured alive, he shot himself to avoid being taken prisoner.

Legacy

- **Inspiration:** Chandra Shekhar Azad's courage, dedication, and sacrifice continue to inspire generations of Indians. He remains an icon of the Indian independence movement.
- **Memorials:** Several memorials, parks, and institutions across India are named after him to honor his memory and legacy.
- **Celebration:** His birth anniversary on July 23 is celebrated across India as Chandra Shekhar Azad Jayanti, commemorating his contributions to the freedom struggle.

Chandra Shekhar Azad's unwavering commitment to the cause of Indian independence and his refusal to bow down to British oppression have earned him a revered place in the annals of Indian history. He symbolizes the indomitable spirit of resistance and sacrifice that characterized the struggle for freedom.

Bhagat Singh, born on September 28, 1907, in Banga village in present-day Pakistan, was one of the most iconic figures of India's struggle for independence. His life, actions, and ideology continue to inspire generations of Indians. Here's an overview of Bhagat Singh's life and contributions:

Early Life and Education

- **Background:** Bhagat Singh came from a family deeply involved in the freedom movement. His father, Kishan Singh, and uncle, Ajit Singh, were both active participants in the struggle against British rule.
- **Education:** He was a voracious reader from a young age and was deeply influenced by the works of revolutionaries like Lenin, Marx, and Bakunin. He attended National College in Lahore, where he became involved in nationalist politics.

Revolutionary Activities

- **Entry into the Movement:** Bhagat Singh was drawn to revolutionary activities from a young age. He was deeply affected by the Jallianwala Bagh massacre in 1919 and became actively involved in the struggle for independence.
- **Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA):** Along with Chandrashekhar Azad and others, Bhagat Singh founded the HSRA, a revolutionary organization that aimed to overthrow British rule through armed struggle.

Kakori Conspiracy and Lahore Conspiracy Case

- **Involvement:** Bhagat Singh was involved in several acts of resistance against British rule, including the Kakori Conspiracy (1925) and the killing of British police officer J.P. Saunders in Lahore (1928).
- **Lahore Conspiracy Case:** Following the killing of J.P. Saunders, Bhagat Singh and his associates went into hiding. They were eventually arrested and tried in what came to be known as the Lahore Conspiracy Case.

Assembly Bombing and Hunger Strike

- **Central Legislative Assembly Bombing:** In April 1929, Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt threw bombs in the Central Legislative Assembly in Delhi to protest against the repressive Public Safety Bill and Trade Disputes Bill.
- **Arrest and Trial:** Bhagat Singh was arrested for his involvement in the assembly bombing and underwent a lengthy trial. During the trial, he and his co-accused used the court as a platform to espouse their revolutionary ideals.

Execution and Martyrdom

- **Execution:** Bhagat Singh, along with Rajguru and Sukhdev, was sentenced to death for the killing of J.P. Saunders. Despite widespread appeals for clemency, they were executed by hanging on March 23, 1931, in Lahore Central Jail.
- **Legacy:** Bhagat Singh's execution sparked widespread outrage and led to massive protests across India. He became a symbol of resistance and martyrdom in the struggle for independence.

Ideology and Legacy

- **Socialism and Secularism:** Bhagat Singh was deeply influenced by socialist and Marxist ideologies. He believed in the establishment of a classless society based on social and economic equality.
- **Secularism:** He also advocated for secularism and opposed communalism and religious intolerance.
- **Legacy:** Bhagat Singh's legacy as a revolutionary and martyr continues to inspire movements for social justice, democracy, and freedom not only in India but also around the world. His writings and speeches remain influential, and his name is synonymous with courage, sacrifice, and patriotism.

Bhagat Singh's life and actions embody the spirit of resistance and sacrifice in the fight against oppression and injustice. He remains an enduring symbol of courage and idealism, inspiring countless individuals to stand up for their beliefs and fight for a better world.

Bhagat Singh: Revolutionary with a Difference

If Gandhi and Subhas deserve a bust in the remote corridors of human consciousness then there must be a room for an effigy of Bhagat Singh. The revolutionaries made an abiding contribution to the struggle for Independence of India. They made supreme sacrifices. They helped in spreading national consciousness among the people. The slogan of "Inquilab Zindabad" by Bhagat Singh still echoes in the minds of freedom loving people of our country. The revolutionaries discovered their fount of inspiration in the 'trio' of the Congress - B.G. Tilak, B.C. Pal and Lala Lajpat Rai. Almost all the revolutionary groups joined the Congress while maintaining and endeavouring to strengthen their secret organization. Many of their leaders obtained responsible positions in district congress committees and used their positions to consolidate their followers. This penetration of the congress had a very important consequence for it helped the revolutionaries internally in the matter of recruitment and organization, and externally in the matter of public sympathy. During 1920-22 no major extremist activities were planned. Early in 1922 the failure of the Non-Cooperation movement led to the controversy over the means-non-violent or violent to be employed. The revolutionaries got disillusioned with Gandhian techniques. The revolutionaries discarded the "Philosophy of nonviolence as a philosophy arising out of despair." Bhagat Singh played a dominant role in revolutionary activities in the post non-cooperation movement. Earlier he was drawn to Gandhi's peaceful movement when he got

disturbed by the Jalianwala Bagh massacre. But due to the sudden cancellation of the movement after Chauri Chaura incident, he lost faith on Gandhi and his technique, alongwith other revolutionaries.

Inspiration :

Throughout his short life, Bhagat Singh emulated the examples of his ancestors. The generations of the Singh family i.e. Arjun Singh and his sons - Kishan Singh, Ajit Singh and Swaran Singh- had set an example for the service of the nation. After the occupation of Punjab by the British, a large part of the family's Jagir was confiscated. Bhagat Singh's ancestors were among those who were not reconciled to the foreign domination. Bhagat Singh's father was influenced by the Hindu reformist movement Arya Samaj. His uncles, Ajit Singh and Swaran Singh as well as his father were part of the Ghadar party led by Kartar Singh Sarabha. Bhagat Singh was born in Lahore and it was in the city that the British launched the first Lahore conspiracy case in 1915, sentencing more than two dozen youths to death and hundreds of others to life imprisonment and other harsh jail sentences. Though the govt was able to crush the Ghadar Party revolutionaries through such brutal repression, their saga left an indelible impression on the minds of later generations of Indians. Those who went to the gallows in this case included Kartar Singh Sarabha, a youth of merely 16 years, whose image got etched in Bhagat Singh's psyche. As for revolutionaries who were seriously disillusioned after the withdrawal of the Non-cooperation movement, then began to regroup all over north India. Sachindranath Sanyal formed the Hindustan Republican Association in 1924. Bhagat Singh and his friend in Lahore joined it. This grouping soon led, in August 1925, to a train hold up at Kakori, a small station near Lucknow, where the Hindustan Republican association revolutionaries looted government money as a direct challenge to the British authority. In the Kakori conspiracy case, Ram Prasad Bismil and his three friends were hanged. The sacrifice of these great freedom fighters influenced Bhagat Singh immediately. September 8 and 9, 1928 was a milestone in the history of national revolutionary movement in India because of its momentous decision. First, the movement accepted socialism as its goal and, as its reflection, the Hindustan Republican Association was renamed as Hindustan Socialist Republican Association. Secondly, the meeting also realised the futility of individual violence and decided to abstain as far as possible, from killing British officials or approvers. Here Bhagat Singh was allowed to play a key role.

Dominant Ideas :

Bhagat Singh spent the years from 1924 to 1928 in studying the history of revolutionary articles in Kirti and Pratap. Moreover in the court on 6th June 1929, a full text of the statement of Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutta was read by Asaf Ali.

Marxism :

Bhagat Singh's political thought evolved gradually from Gandhian nationalism to revolutionary Marxism. By the end of 1928 he and his comrades renamed their organisation the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association. He had read the teachings of Karl Marx, Friedrich Engels and Vladimir Lenin and believed that with such large and diverse population, India could only survive properly under a socialist regime. These ideals had been introduced to him during his time at the National College at Lahore and he believed that India should reenact the Russian revolution. In the case that

Indians were not socialist, he believed that the rich would only get richer and poor would only get poorer. His aggressive stance of violence, put him at odds with Gandhi and members of the congress. Socialist leaders sometimes refer back to him as the founder of Indian Socialism.

Atheism

While in a condemned cell in 1931, he wrote a pamphlet entitled 'why' I am an Atheist in which he discusses and advocates the philosophy of atheism. This pamphlet was a result of some criticism by fellow revolutionaries on his failure to acknowledge religion and God while in a condemned cell, the accusation of vanity was also dealt with in this pamphlet. He supported his own beliefs and claimed that he used to be a firm believer in the Almighty, but could not bring himself to believe the myths and beliefs that others held close to their hearts. In this Pamphlet, he acknowledged the fact that religion made death easier, but also said that unproved Philosophy is a sign of human weakness.

Anarchism :

Bhagat Singh's articles written in Kirti gives an idea about his leaning for anarchism. Proudhon is the father of Anarchism and Bakunin and Kropotkin are its other advocates. The ultimate goal of anarchism is complete independence, according to which, no one will be obsessed with Government or religion nor will any body be crazy for money or other worldly desires. Bhagat Singh being imbibed with these lofty ideals had made the supreme sacrifice.

Significant Actions :

In 1924, Bhagat Singh joined Hindustan Republican Association formed by Sachindranath Sanyal. Along with other members of the Association he joined Lala Lajpat Rai to protest the Simon Commission. In 1928 the London Commission constituted a commission under Sir John Simon to review the Montagu Chelmsford reforms of 1919 and suggest constitutional changes for India. The Commission was not welcomed since it was a wholly British Commission. It was greeted by the people with the cries of "Simon go Back", 'Angrej Murdabad' "Down with the British" and Inquilab Zindabad. A slogan coined by Bhagat Singh to give a new edge, a new meaning to that of revolt. The crowd was also chanting a rhyme. *Hindustani Hain hum, Hindustan Hamara Murjao Simon, Jahan hai Desh Tumara* Meaning : We are Indians and India is ours. Go back Simon to the country to which you belong. In 1928 at Lahore, a great protest rally was organized. It was led by Bhagat Singh. In the protest when police resorted to brutal lathi charge, Lalaji got seriously injured and died. The members of the Association under the leadership of Bhagat Singh avenged Lalaji's death by assassinating J.P. Saunders, the police officer responsible for Lalaji's death. As the next significant action by Hindustan Socialist Republican Party (the rechristened name of Hindustan Republican Party) Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutta threw bombs in the central Assembly on April 8, 1929, in protest against the Trade disputes Bill and Public safety Bill. Though for this action of their bravery they were punished deportation, Bhagat Singh had to sacrifice his life along with his other two comrades for the Lahore conspiracy case.

Modern Day Legacy

Bhagat Singh's death had the effect that he desired and he inspired thousands of youths to assist the remainder of the Indian Independence movement. After his hanging, youths in regions around Northern India rioted in protest against the British Raj and also against the

indifference of the congress. The Communist Party of India (Marxist) itself acknowledges Bhagat Singh's contribution to Indian society and in particular the future of socialism in India. To celebrate the centenary of his birth, a group of intellectuals have set up an institution to commemorate Singh and his ideals. Several popular Bollywood films have been made capturing the life and times of Bhagat Singh. The 2006 film "Rang De Basanti" is a film drawing parallels between revolutionaries of Bhagat Singh's era and modern Indian youth. Here it is apt to mention that through his organization *Naujawan Bharat Sabha* he trained the youths for fighting against the British Raj. He expected the youth to be courageous and brave and to work with a sense of patriotism which is lacking in modern day. (Smruti Ranjan Mishra is working in the Utkal University of Culture, Orissa, Bhubaneswar.)

Subhas Chandra Bose, often referred to as Netaji, was one of the most prominent leaders of the Indian independence movement. His leadership, vision, and dedication played a significant role in shaping the course of India's struggle for freedom. One of the key aspects of his legacy is the formation of the Azad Hind Fauj (Indian National Army), which remains a symbol of Indian nationalism and military valor. Here's an overview:

Subhas Chandra Bose:

Early Life and Political Career:

- **Background:** Subhas Chandra Bose was born on January 23, 1897, in Cuttack, Odisha, to a prominent Bengali family.
- **Education and Ideals:** He studied at Presidency College in Kolkata and later at Cambridge University in the UK. Bose was deeply influenced by nationalist ideals and was drawn to the Indian National Congress and its struggle for independence.

Leadership in Indian National Congress:

- **Rise to Prominence:** Bose quickly rose through the ranks of the Indian National Congress and was elected its president in 1938 and 1939. He advocated for complete independence and was critical of the Congress leadership's approach towards British rule.

Formation of Forward Bloc:

- **Split from Congress:** Disillusioned with the Congress's policies, Bose resigned from its presidency and formed the Forward Bloc in 1939. The Forward Bloc advocated for more radical and direct action against British colonialism.

Escape to Germany and Japan:

- **Alliance with Axis Powers:** With the outbreak of World War II, Bose saw an opportunity to gain support for India's independence struggle. He escaped from house arrest in Calcutta in 1941 and traveled to Germany via Afghanistan and the Soviet Union.
- **Formation of Azad Hind Government:** In 1943, Bose established the Provisional Government of Free India in Singapore, with the support of the Japanese authorities.

Azad Hind Fauj (Indian National Army):

Formation and Objectives:

- **Formation:** Bose established the Azad Hind Fauj (Indian National Army or INA) in 1942, comprising Indian prisoners of war and civilians in Southeast Asia.
- **Objectives:** The INA's primary objective was to liberate India from British rule and establish a free and independent nation.

Military Campaigns:

- **Battles in Burma:** The INA fought alongside Japanese forces in several battles in Burma (now Myanmar) against the British Indian Army.
- **March to India:** Bose led the INA's "March to Delhi" in 1944, with the aim of liberating India. Although the march did not reach its intended destination, it had a significant impact on the morale of Indian troops and civilians.

Legacy and Impact:

- **Symbol of Nationalism:** The Azad Hind Fauj became a symbol of Indian nationalism and military valor. Its soldiers, often referred to as "Netaji's soldiers," fought with courage and determination for the freedom of their motherland.
- **Legacy of Bose:** Subhas Chandra Bose's leadership and the formation of the Azad Hind Fauj remain important chapters in India's struggle for independence. Bose's legacy continues to inspire generations of Indians, symbolizing the spirit of sacrifice, patriotism, and determination in the quest for freedom.

Subhas Chandra Bose's role in the Indian independence movement, particularly through the establishment of the Azad Hind Fauj, underscores the diversity of strategies and approaches employed by Indian nationalists in their quest for freedom. His vision of a free and independent India galvanized thousands of Indians to join the struggle for liberation from British colonial rule.

Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose: Contributions of a Revolutionary to
Indian Social Reforms and Indian Industrial Relations

Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose –the fiery Indian revolutionary has been in the news during 2015 and 2016 in connection with the declassification of files about his mysterious disappearance

after 18th of August 1945. Of late, maximum research and writings on the leader have been about the mystery and associated theories connected with his disappearance, with the Indian Prime Minister himself taking a keen interest. It is largely History and to some extent Political Science, which as academic disciplines, has incorporated Subhas Chandra Bose as “Topic of Study/Research”. Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose had an in-depth knowledge of not only the Indian Society but also Japanese and European Society. He was a very keen observer of Indian Society and with his keen observation and constant interaction with a wide section of the general public during his constant travels, both within India and abroad, he was aware of various social problems particular to India and its magnitude. Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose was also fully aware of the British Colonial interests (the cunning-oppressive Agenda) who did not want the total eradication of social problems, especially that of caste and communal rivalry. Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose had practical experience in Indian Industrial Relations as an Outside Trade Union Leader of various major trade unions and President of the first Indian Trade Union Federation-The All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC). As the President of India’s most powerful political party, the Indian National Congress (INC), for two consecutive terms, Netaji’s contacts with Indian leaders belonging to different groups/associations including trade unionists, and general public those days was next only to Mahatma Gandhi. All these broadened his horizon and called for constant observation and study of Indian Society on a day to day basis. Netaji also donned the role of conciliator and arbitrator during industrial disputes. Thus his ideas and writings on these areas were a result of practical experience. Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose also tried his level best to ameliorate the social status of Indians and was particularly concerned about the plight of Indian labour and farmers. This Article focuses on the role of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose in Social Reforms and Industrial Relations and aims at highlighting the fact that Bose can be an interesting ‘Topic of Research’ even in Sociology, especially Sociology of Indian Social Reforms, Sociology of Indian Industrial Relations and Military Sociology.

Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose: Contributions
of a Revolutionary to Indian Social Reforms
and Indian Industrial Relations

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Anuplal Gopalan

Abstract

Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose –the fiery Indian revolutionary has been in the news during 2015 and 2016 in connection with the declassification of files about his mysterious disappearance after 18th of August 1945. Of late, maximum research and writings on the leader have been about the mystery and associated theories connected with his disappearance, with the Indian Prime Minister himself taking a keen interest. It is largely History and to some extent Political Science, which as academic disciplines, has incorporated Subhas Chandra Bose as “Topic of Study/Research”. Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose had an in-depth knowledge of not only the Indian Society but also Japanese and European Society. He was a very keen observer of Indian Society and with his keen observation and constant interaction with a wide

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Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose had practical experience in Indian Industrial Relations as an Outside Trade Union Leader of various major trade unions and President of the first Indian Trade Union Federation-The All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC). As the President of India's most powerful political party, the Indian National Congress (INC), for two consecutive terms, Netaji's contacts with Indian leaders belonging to different groups/associations including trade unionists, and general public those days was next only to Mahatma Gandhi. All these broadened his horizon and called for constant observation and study of Indian Society on a day to day basis. Netaji also donned the role of conciliator and arbitrator during industrial disputes. Thus his ideas and writings on these areas were a result of practical experience. Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose also tried his level best to ameliorate the social status of Indians and was particularly concerned about the plight of Indian labour and farmers. This Article focuses on the role of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose in Social Reforms and Industrial Relations and aims at highlighting the fact that Bose can be an interesting „Topic of Research“ even in Sociology, especially Sociology of Indian Social Reforms, Sociology of Indian Industrial Relations and Military Sociology. Keywords: Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose, Sociology, Industrial Relations, Caste, Social Reforms, Indian National Army (INA), Trade Unions. Introduction: An in-depth study of Social Reforms is integral to Sociology of Indian Society; Similarly, Industrial Relations constitutes the bulk of Industrial Sociology. Among all the Indian Freedom Fighters, Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's ranking concerning his contribution to Indian freedom struggle and popularity is next only to Mahatma Gandhi. Historians, military strategists, anti-colonialists and political scientists have had the veteran revolutionary as a subject of serious academic discussions. The towering charisma of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose as a military leader at the forefront of Indian Independence movement (particularly outside India) has dwarfed many of his other contributions-especially as a Social Reformer and Industrial Relations Expert. Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose was a great orator, prolific writer and a doer - one who practised what he preached. Though Netaji has never been a student of Sociology, he was always a keen observer of Indian Society. During his stay in Europe Netaji did establish and develop contacts with Sociologists apart from political leaders, Economists, literati, scientists and people from the cultural world. Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's ideas, writings, and actions provide enough material for serious Sociological research, especially in the field of Sociology of Indian Social Reforms and Sociology of Indian Industrial Relations. The principal objective of this paper is to highlight the contributions of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose to Social Reforms in India and Indian Industrial Relations-primarily as an Outside

Trade Union Leader and Champion of Labour Welfare and to argue for a serious study of the Revolutionary through the Sociological and Industrial Relations viewpoint. Apart from the speeches delivered by Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose and official letters and

special (Military) orders written by him during his illustrious public life in various capacities, secondary sources have formed a bulk of the data in this paper to give us a better understanding of the issue at hand. Some of the positions Bose held were the President of the Indian National Congress, Mayor of Calcutta, President of TATA Steel Workers Union & All India Trade Union Congress-AITUC, Head of the Provisional Government of Free India and Supreme Commander of the Indian National Army. Besides the use of Secondary sources, some data in connection with Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose and Social Reforms has also been gathered via expert interviews of ex-Indian National Army (INA) and Azad Hind Dal Personnel. These interviews will serve as a part of our primary data.

The Role of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose as a Social Reformer Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's efforts at Social Reforms in a full-fledged manner took off on foreign soil as he took over as Prime Minister of India in Exile and Supreme Commander of the INA. True to his secular and egalitarian outlook with its base in Social Justice and Social Equality, Netaji's policy decisions and actions as Head of State in exile, actually initiated a series of Social Reforms

which is indeed of much use and interest to students of Sociology. Netaji's constant interaction with Indians of all strata and his wide travel and political activity right from a young age had made him aware of the wide divisions in Indian society. He was concerned with Caste inequality and associated disadvantages resulting in disunity in Indian society and with communal disunity and rivalry among different religious groups in India. During one of his travels (before getting into active politics) he had been at the receiving end of the Indian Caste System. The British Colonialists had used the caste and communal differences and disunity in India to nurture their policy of divide and rule and institutionalised the same even in the Colonial British Indian armed forces.

On the 19th of October 1929, while delivering the Presidential Address at the Punjab Students Conference held at Lahore, Netaji had stated: "By freedom I mean all round freedom... his freedom implies not only emancipation from political bondage but also equal distribution of wealth, the abolition of caste barriers and social inequalities, and destruction of communalism and religious intolerance...so long as social repression and economic inequality weighed heavily on these people, the idea of political independence could not inspire them". During his first term as the President of the Indian National Congress, he decided to set up a National Planning Committee under the aegis of the INC with Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru as its Chairman with the definite aim of transforming an impoverished India into an economically and industrially advanced nation. (Ayer, 1972, p.18).

After taking over direct command of the INA/Azad Hind Fauj, on the 25th of August 1943 and with the establishment of the Provisional Government of Free India on the 21st of October 1943 at Singapore, Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's proclamations and commands resulted in a series of social reforms which were indeed very revolutionary. The banning of untouchability and all other detrimental caste practices was one of the major social reforms introduced by Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose through the INA. and

the Azad Hind Government. The British Colonial rulers had always made it a point to have soldiers predominantly from the so-called „ martial races“ in their colonial army in India. These soldiers, belonging to different communities-Castes, sub-castes, and religions, often dined in separate areas and had separate barracks. This practice indeed was also a convenient means for the calculative British Colonial Masters to avoid „total unity“ of the Indian Soldiers in the Colonial Forces (very much necessary for maintaining command by a much smaller number of British Officers). In short, Indian caste system became another handy tool for their notorious „Divide and Rule policy“. Nurturing caste practises/caste based restrictions was indeed an agenda of British colonialists to serve their interests in their most prized and biggest colony – India (Hartog, 2001, p.69).

For the first time in the modern military history of India, this caste based practise was given up when Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose ordered and introduced in his Indian National Army, the inter-dining of Indian soldiers and officers belonging to all castes and all four major religions (Hindu, Muslim, Sikh and Christian). Netaji's first and foremost condition when he took up the reigns of the INA was that the companies of this „truly Indian“ Army should never be grouped into different communities, unlike the way British did.

The INA was to be a mixture of various Religions, Races, and Castes with total social equality of all soldiers with no one being inferior or superior on account of their religion, caste or race. They were served food cooked in the common kitchen and shared space in common barracks breaking the age old caste bonds and practices. These were indeed first major successful steps in eradicating casteist feelings and nurturing feelings of „being Indian“ above everything else among the soldiers. Any Indian irrespective of his caste (including non-martial caste) and religious community could enroll in the INA (Hartog, 2001, p.70). To strengthen the secular feelings and thereby foster National unity, common worship and celebrations of all religious festivals

were introduced in the INA. It is interesting to note that the Indian Armed Forces, undoubtedly the most secular Armed Forces in the world, has incorporated these practices initiated by Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose in his INA. The literacy of soldiers and civilians, who were organised under the Azad Hind Dal, was given top priority and with the introduction of Romanized Hindustani, learning Hindustani as a common language for command words in the Indian National Army became easy. It may be noted that shortly after Independence, the mighty Indian Armed Forces incorporated Hindustani words for military commands/instructions. Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose even commissioned a German-Hindustani Military Dictionary-whose main purpose was to provide

Hindustani equivalents for commands in German Army (whose help was initially sought by Netaji for formal training of INA Personnel). Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose in fact successfully experimented with applied linguistics (Hartog, 2001, p.89). Though Hindustani was widely used for military commands and

administrative use, all other Indian languages were considered equally important. Also, the Azad Hind Radio Station, which had broadcast stations in Singapore, Bangkok, Rangoon, Tokyo and Saigon beamed to India in some Indian Languages like Bengali, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Gujarati, Marathi, Punjabi, Gurkhali and Pushtu apart from Hindustani and English (Ayer, 1972, p.52).

Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose had an inherent faith in “Nari Shakti” or „Women's Power“.

He favoured Women's empowerment and breaking the social bondage of women-a bane of Indian women for centuries. Netaji was one of the early champions of „women rights“ who strongly believed in the equality of men and women in Civil and Military life and considered the participation of women in the Indian freedom struggle extremely important. Netaji greatly admired Rani Lakshmi Bai of Jhansi, one of the heroines of the First War of Indian Independence. His ideas on „women empowerment“ were not mere lip service. It may also be noted that Netaji was a great devotee of the Mother Goddess-Durga. Netaji

Subhas Chandra Bose created a history of sorts on the 22nd of October 1943, by establishing the world's first all Women Regiment within the Indian National Army and christened it "The Rani Jhansi Regiment (as a tribute to the legendary Rani Lakshmi Bai of Jhansi). It was a full-fledged combat regiment with its Indian women soldiers receiving all necessary military training on par with their male counterparts. In his capacity as the Supreme Commander of the INA., Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose personally took great care in the selection of the trainers for the lady recruits of the Rani of Jhansi Regiment. Also, he strictly instructed the veteran trainers to avoid inadvertent use of rough and vulgar language while training the ladies, whom Netaji referred to as „Ranis'(Arya, 2008, p.172).

The traditionally groomed and traditionally dressed Indian woman (in sarees/salwar-kameez) switching over to military attire with guns in their hands was something unthinkable for the times. An Indian lady doctor practicing at Singapore, Dr. Lakshmi Swaminathan was appointed Captain of the first ever modern women's regiment of the World. Dr. Lakshmi was later promoted to the rank of Colonel, thereby becoming the first Woman to hold that rank in modern military history. Col. Lakshmi married her INA Colleague Col. Prem Kumar Sehgal. Lt. Manwati Arya, Lt. Mrs. Thevar and Lt. Mrs. Thomas were other important women officers commissioned in the Indian National Army. It was indeed a great achievement to induct traditional homebound Indian girls and women of South East Asia into the armed forces as combat soldiers with full rigorous military training and also Military-Nurses with basic military training. Netaji's militant nationalism coupled with his personal charisma and respect cum encouragement for all irrespective of sex, age, race, caste and religion endeared him to the Indian Diaspora in Germany, Japan, Singapore, Malaya, Thailand and Burma (Ayer, 1972, p.52). Though the British Colonial Armed Forces in India had a large chunk of Indian soldiers with exceptional military qualities, none of them were given higher ranks. „Racial Supremacy“ of the British was very evident in the Colonial Armed Forces in matters of promotion and other privileges. The Indian National Army enabled the Indian soldiers to move up on the Military hierarchy and occupy high ranks of Major-General. The Indian soldiers were provided opportunities to move up the hierarchy by their merit irrespective of their caste, race or religion. It is only after taking note of high ranks being conferred on Indian soldiers in the Indian National Army, that the British Colonial Army elevated an Indian, K.M.Cariappa, who later rose to the ranks of First Indian General & Commander-in-Chief, was conferred the Rank of Field Marshall-much later, after his superannuation, to the ranks of a Brigadier (Hartog, 2001, p.70).

Netaji's secular credentials were something which even Mohammed Ali Jinnah, the

founder of Pakistan, was convinced of. It is interesting to note that a large number of Indian Muslims occupied high ranks in the Azad Hind Government and the Azad Hind Fauj (INA) by their own merit-something unthinkable in the British Indian Army. Unlike the Colonial British, caste, race, sex or religion was never the criteria for occupying high Military and Civilian offices in the Government of India in Exile (Provisional Government of Free India) and the Indian National Army under Netaji's command and leadership. There are also many who strongly feel that the Partition of India on communal lines would never have happened if Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose was present in India and was present for discussions with Jinnah and others. Many Indians from the Minority Communities occupied high positions in the Provisional Government of Free India and the Azad Hind Fauj. Lt. Col. Aziz, Lt. Col. M. Zaman Kiani, Lt. Col. Ehsan Qadir, Lt. Col. Shah Nawaz, Lt. Nazir Ahmed, Lt. Col. Gulzar Singh, Janab Karim Ghani, Janab D. M. Khan, Sardar Ishar Singh, Lt. Mrs. Thomas etc. were prominent members of the Minority community. Col. Dr. Lakshmi Sehgal nee Swaminathan was the Cabinet Minister in charge of Women's Organisation. It is indeed a matter of Pride that Free India and her mighty armed forces have emulated the noble secular values propagated by Netaji and his colleagues. One of the greatest legacies left behind by Netaji is the highly popular National Salute-"JAI HIND". Netaji has proclaimed and instructed to the INA Personnel and Indian Civilians in South East Asia that "JAI HIND is our National Salutation, as Indian meets Indian." The marching song of the Indian National Army „Kadamkadam badhayecha" has been incorporated by free India's Armed Forces. All these have a very strong secular ethos (Ayer, 1972, p.54). Netaji was always for social ownership and a Socialist state in India where there will be freedom of Individuals in matters of religious worship, equal rights for all, equality and social justice for all citizens. He never believed that economy is the sole cause of social change. He was very clear about the Spiritual grounding of the Indian People. It is interesting to note that though a Leftist by ideology, Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose never negated spirituality and wanted a separate brand of Socialism for India. He was among the very first Leftist-Socialists who found nothing wrong with being spiritual as far as it was not communal/fanatic-spiritualism.

Netaji was conscious of the deep-rooted spirituality of Indian Society. It is very interesting to note that post-1950s a band of Leftists who never negated spirituality (though they were not followers of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose) emerged in the Latin-American/ South American political scene; Dr. Fidel Castro, Daniel Ortega, and Hugo Chavez to name a few.

Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose and Indian Industrial Relations During his eventful years in India, before his great escape from house arrest and subsequent departure to Europe and then to South East Asia, Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose was very closely associated with Indian Industrial Relations. His writings and activities in this field provide sufficient material for research in Industrial Sociology/Sociology of Industrial Relations. Among the top Indian Nationalist Leaders, the contributions of Netaji to Industrial Relations in India is next only to Mahatma Gandhi.

Sociology of Indian Industrial Relations is blessed with a large quantity of data about various facets of Industrial Relations contributed by Netaji as an outstanding Industrial

Relations expert. Like Mahatma Gandhi, Netaji too had a clear understanding and views on Indian Industrial Relations. Mahatma Gandhi's approach to Industrial Relations is popularly known as the Trusteeship Approach. We can seriously think of a „Subhashite Approach“ to Industrial Relations. His views, writing, and actions about Industrial Relations will be of much interest to students of Industrial Sociology and Industrial Relations. Netaji's first association with Indian Industrial Relations was in the year 1922 when his political mentor and veteran Indian Nationalist Desh Bandhu Chittaranjan Das got him associated with the Lahore Trade Union Congress. His contributions to Indian Industrial Relations is a direct result of his association with the Indian working class and their trade unions, especially as the Outside Trade Union Leader[President] of Jamshedpur Labour Association, Tinplate Workers Union, and TISCO Worker's Union. He was elected President of India's first Central Trade Union Federation, the All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC) in 1931 there by emerging as the most important Trade Union Leader of not only British India but also in the entire British Colonial Empire. His political ideology was Left Wing Nationalism. Thus, it is well-

known that he was sympathetic to the Indian working class and the stance of the political party he founded in 1939(after his resignation from the Indian National Congress)-The Forward Bloc reflected this (Bose, 2002, p.13). Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose was closely associated with trade union movement in Calcutta, Bombay, Nagpur, Jamshedpur and Bokaro. Indian Trade Unionists of the time including Dr.Varaha Giri Venkata Giri, later President of India, he was the first with a trade union background to be elected he greatly influenced President of a Democratic Country, and so were some of the Communist Labour Leaders of the time. At a time when Indian Industrial Relations is being tilted the employers and foreign MNC giants in the aftermath of Liberalization in 1991, an analysis of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's writings and direct action as an Industrial Relations expert is of special significance. As a Nationalist, Netaji was strongly in favour of employing Indians in all Industries operating from Indian soil. His role as an outstanding outside trade union leader was instrumental in the TATA Group preferring Indian workers and higher officials in all its plants. In his letter dated November 12, 1928, addressed to the then Chairman of TATA Steel Mr. N. B.

Saklatvala, Netaji said, "One of the most important problems before the Company (TATA Steel) is that it lacks senior officials from India. I have no doubt that if you go ahead with your policy of Indianisation of Tata Steel, you will be able to ingratiate yourself with your Indian employees, your countrymen as well as with public leaders of all shades of opinion". This letter was taken seriously by the TATAs and paved way for the appointment of more Indians in key positions in that Company (Simeon, 1995).

Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose was given the post of the President of TATA Steel Workers Union in the year 1928, as the third President of the union formed in the year 1920. One advantage that Netaji had during his nine-year tenure between 1928-1937 was the Indian Trade Unions Act, 1926 (now known as the Trade Unions Act, 1926) which provides for outside leadership in registered Indian Trade Unions was already in place and his Presidentship in the said union, though not a worker, was perfectly legal. Though the TATA group is now well known as the initiators of various progressive labour

welfare and social security schemes, it was Netaji's relentless fight including the 1928 strike which he led that ultimately resulted in all these. In fact, there was an attack on Netaji during a meeting in the year 1931 (September 20) which resulted in the disruption of the meeting. Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's efforts were indeed responsible for the implementation of maternity benefits for women employees of TATA and also the extension of Gratuity and Pensions for all sections of TATA workers. Netaji's fearless and relentless struggles also resulted in a historic Memorandum of Agreement (signed by the Chairman N.B. Saklatvala, General Manager C.A. Alexander, and Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose) resulting in the first ever profit Sharing bonus for Tata Steel workers. It may be noted that profit-sharing bonus for Indian workers became statutory in free India only in the year 1965 with the introduction of The Payment of Bonus Act, 1965 (Simeon,1995, p.70). It is a fact that initially, the Tatas feared that Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose was a new threat to their capitalist interests. Labour Historians cum Journalists such as Dr. Dilip Simeon and Jane Ajaz Ashraf have brought out evidence to prove the fact that the then TATA big bosses had a role in violently disrupting the meeting of September 20, 1931, addressed by Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose. However, no one could (including the 300 plus hooligans who were involved in attacking Bose's meeting) break his willpower or courage in his fight for worker's rights. The TATAs, who were totally unwilling to negotiate with the strike committee of TATA Steel Workers, had to budge when Netaji Bose took over as the President of the said Union. This was one of the reasons for Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose to strongly advocate the presence of Outside leaders in Trade Unions (Simeon,1995). Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose strongly advocated the „Tri-Partite Scheme“ of Industrial Relations where in the Government or the State should play a major role in every sphere of Industrial Relations. He considered the State as an indispensable Party in the Industrial Relations Scheme and regarded that the State has the duty of providing employment to citizens or take up the responsibility of maintaining the unemployed citizens. He emphasised the need for Social Security and Labour Welfare Programmes

Role of Subhash Chandra Bose in Freedom Struggle

Role of Subhash Chandra Bose in Freedom Struggle is noted as an Indian revolutionary whose resistance to British rule in India established him as a hero among Indians. began when he joined Congress in 1921. Early in 1942, German and Indian officers in the Special Bureau for India in Berlin and Indische Legion's Indian soldiers first addressed Bose as Netaji, which is Hindustani for "Respected Leader". Today, it is employed throughout India.

This article delves into the remarkable life and **contributions of Subhash Chandra Bose**, highlighting his role as a leader, his pursuit of armed resistance, and his lasting impact on India's struggle for freedom.

Role of Subhash Chandra Bose in Freedom Struggle

Subhash Chandra Bose was one of the most esteemed leaders to have come from Eastern India. He was born in Cuttack, in the province of Bengal. His dynamic charisma and leadership remain untouched to date. The role of Netaji in the Indian Freedom Struggle began in 1925 until his plane crash in 1945.

Role of Subhash Chandra Bose in Freedom Struggle Notes PDF

- For his nationalist activities, Subhash Chandra Bose was imprisoned in Mandalay in 1925. After being freed in 1927, he was appointed general secretary of the **Indian National Congress**.
- He collaborated with Jawaharlal Nehru (born November 14, 1889), and the two rose to prominence as the Congress Party's young leaders.
- Subhash Chandra Bose's contribution to the freedom struggle came as a support for the application of force to achieve total Swaraj and encouraged it. He differed from Gandhi in that he wasn't a fan of using nonviolence as a means of achieving independence.
- In 1939, Subhash Chandra Bose ran for office and was elected party president; however, he was compelled to retire because of conflicts with Gandhi's loyalists.
- Subhash Chandra Bose inspired the soldiers with his ferocious speeches. "Give me blood, and I shall give you freedom," is his most well-known quotation.
- The INA seized power of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands while aiding the Japanese army in their conquest of North-East India. However, after the 1944 Battles of Kohima and Imphal, the British forces compelled them to retire.

Contribution of Subhash Chandra Bose to Freedom Struggle

Subhash Chandra Bose's Contribution to Freedom Struggle has been irreplaceable. This has been briefly traced in the pointers below;

- His philosophy of Bose was authoritarian on the left and leaned toward socialism. Netaji established the All India Forward Bloc to support the freedom struggle as a division of Congress in 1939.
- Subhash Chandra Bose denounced the government's lack of consultation with Indians before enlisting them in **World War II**. He was detained when he organized demonstrations in Calcutta to call for the demolition of the monument honoring the Black Hole of Calcutta.
- Following a few days, Subhash Chandra Bose was freed but continued to be monitored. Then, in 1941, he left the nation and fled to Germany through Afghanistan and the Soviet Union. He had earlier visited Europe, where he met with European political figures and Indian students.

- Subhash Chandra Bose met with Nazi commanders there to organize a military uprising against the British to achieve independence. Since the Allied forces were opposed to his “rival,” the British, he intended to make friends with them.
- About 4500 Indian men serving in the British army and who had been captured by the Germans in Northern Africa formed the foundation of the Indian Division.
- Subhash Chandra Bose left Germany for Japan in 1943 after becoming frustrated with the Germans’ lackadaisical backing for Azad Hind.
- The **Indian National Army** (Azad Hind Fauj), which had been established previously with Japanese assistance, was resurrected upon Bose’s introduction in Japan.
- One of the most notable Subhash Chandra Bose’s contributions to the freedom struggle was when he became the leader of the exiled government known as Azad Hind, also known as the Provisional Government of Free India. Its main office was located in Singapore. Its militia was the INA.

About Subhash Chandra Bose

One of India’s most celebrated independence rebels was Subhash Chandra Bose. Born into a wealthy family in Cuttack, Bengal province, Bose received his education in Calcutta, where he earned a philosophy degree.

- Despite being chosen for the Indian Civil Services (ICS), Subhas Chandra Bose declined to begin his employment because he did not wish to work for the British government.
- In 1921, Bose enlisted in the Indian National Congress, which was founded on December 28th, 1885. He also founded the “Swaraj” newspaper. It was one of the most famous **newspapers during Freedom Struggle.**
- Subhash Chandra Bose served as the Secretary of the Bengal State Congress and the All India Youth Congress President.
- He was appointed the Calcutta Municipal Corporation’s CEO in 1924. Subhash Chandra Bose was elected Mayor of Calcutta in 1930.

Subhash Chandra Bose’s Contribution in History

Subhash Chandra Bose remains to be one of the most popular **freedom fighters in India.** Here are some important facts about him.

- Subhash Chandra Bose coined phrases like “Jai Hind,” “Dilli Chalo,” and “Give me blood and I shall give you freedom.” His charisma and strength of character inspired many individuals in the Indian independence struggle, and this inspiration still exists today. He was fondly and popularly called Netaji.
- Subhash Chandra Bose was a true patriotic in the heart. Shri Ramakrishna Paramhansa and Swami Vivekananda profoundly impacted Netaji’s mentality. When he first stumbled upon Swami Vivekananda’s writings at 15 years of age, his innate propensity for spirituality became apparent, and a profound revolution began to take

place well within him. He thought the two spiritual teachers represented different facets of the same invisible personality.

- Netaji accomplished well academically. Despite passing the Indian **civil services exam**, he quit his government job to fight for India's independence.
- Between 1921 and 1941, he was incarcerated 11 times. While he was incarcerated in 1930, he was elected mayor of Calcutta. Netaji founded the Azad Hind Radio station in Germany.
- Subhash Chandra Bose was the editor of the publication "Forward." He also founded another newspaper called "Swaraj."
- Bose's book *The Indian Struggle* describes the movement for Indian independence from 1920 to 1942. The British government introduced a book ban on it.

Subhash Chandra Bose Freedom Fighter – Azad Hind Fauj

During World War II, an Indian temporary administration known as the Provisional Government of Free India, or Azad Hind, was created in Japanese-occupied Singapore. It was established in October 1943 with help from the Empire of Japan, which it also heavily relied upon.

- It was an aspect of the political campaign that began outside of India in the 1940s intending to unite with the Allied forces to free India from British control. In the latter stages of World War II, Indian nationalists in exile founded it in Singapore with financial, tactical, and political support from the Imperial Power of Japan.
- The government, which was established on September 1, 1942, was motivated by the ideas of Subhas Chandra Bose, who served as both the head of government and the state.
- Some Indians believed that because Azad Hind possessed its own government with a legal system, **uniform civil code**, and currency, the fight for independence from the British was more important because of its presence.
- Azad Hind's existence practically coincided with that of the Indian National Army. The Azad Hind Movement is thought to have come to an end with Bose's passing. Azad Hind's legacy is, nevertheless, subject to interpretation.
- After the war, the Raj watched with anxiety as the reputation of Azad Hind changed from that of a conspirator and traitor to one of the liberators.
- It is debatable if its main objective, to incite popular dissatisfaction and rebellions inside the Indian forces of the British Indian Army to topple the Raj, was eventually successful, given the wave of militant and radical nationalism that surged through India and the animosity and uprisings it inspired.

Death of Subha Chandra Bose

The death of Subhas Chandra Bose remains to be one of the biggest controversies in the

- Subhash Chandra Bose passed away on August 18, 1945, from 3rd-degree burns that he sustained in a plane crash in Taiwan. Many Indians, meanwhile, hesitated to accept that he had actually passed away.
- Numerous inquiry panels were responsible for determining what took place that day.
- Both the Shah Nawaz Committee (1956) and the Figgess Report (1946) concluded that Bose passed away in a plane crash in Taiwan. The earlier reports were also supported by the Khosla Commission (1970).
- However, according to the Mukherjee Commission (2005), Bose's passing couldn't be documented. The government disapproved of this report.

Subhash Chandra Bose Jayanti

A national holiday called Parakram Diwas, which means "Day of Valor," is observed in India on the day of Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's birth anniversary. This holiday is also known as Netaji Jayanti or Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Jayanti.

- It is observed every year on January 23. He was crucial to the cause of the Indian freedom struggle. He served as the Indian National Army's commander (Azad Hind Fauj).
 - Netaji Jayanti was observed in Rangoon around five months after Netaji vanished. It is customarily celebrated throughout India. In West Bengal, Tripura, Jharkhand, and Assam, it is a recognized holiday.
 - The Government of India pays its respects to Netaji Bose on January 23rd. Netaji Jayanti has been observed since 2021 as the Parakram Divas, marking his 124th birth anniversary.
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A Study on the Contribution of Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose in Indian Freedom Struggle

(Jugendra Singh Yadav Assistant Professor, Dept. of Political Science, Mewar University, Gangrar, Chittorgarh, Rajasthan)

Introduction

Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose was born on 23 January 1897 in a Kayastha family in Cuttack. His father's name was Jankidas and his mother's name was Prabhavati devi. In 1920 he got the fourth position in the I.C. S. examination, but during the non-cooperation movement, in April 1921, he resigned from this service and started working as an aide to his political guru 'Deshbandhu Chittaranjan Das'. Das established the National College for the education of government college dropouts and made Subhash Chandra its principal. After the establishment of the Swaraj Party, Subhash became the secretary of this party and the editor of the daily newspaper 'Banglar Katha'. Chittaranjan Das moved to Calcutta. After becoming the mayor of the municipal corporation, 27-year-old Subhash was appointed as the chief executive officer. Subhash also operated his English daily 'Forward'. On 2 January 1932, while going from Bombay to Calcutta, Subhash was arrested from Kalyan station and sent to Seuni Jail.

In October 1924, prominent leaders of the Swaraj Party, including Subhash Babu, were arrested on charges of having links with terrorist elements. After some time, Subhash was sent from Alipore Jail in Calcutta to Verma's Mandalay Jail, where Tilak had lived for six years and Lala Lajpat Rai and Ajit Singh had lived for one year each. Subhash was released from there in May 1927 after two and a half years due to ill health. At the time of his release J.J. M. Sen Gupta and B. N. There was a struggle going on between the people to take over the Congress. Ended Sammal's supremacy by supporting Subhash Sengupt, but after some time differences arose with Subhash's Gandhi supporter Sengupt. In September 1929, Jawaharlal Nehru, the nominated president of the Congress, appointed Subhash as a member of his executive, but shortly after, Subhash resigned in a dispute over the elections of the Bengal Provincial Congress Committee. Subhash became the president of AITUC in December 1929 and remained in this position till 1931. During this period emerged as the most influential leftist member within the Congress. In January 1930, the government imprisoned him on charges of treason for leading a procession organized in support of political prisoners in Bengal. He was released three days after the Gandhi Irwin Pact. On 2 January 1932, while going from Bombay to Calcutta, Subhash was arrested from Kalyan station and sent to Seuni Jail. From here he was sent to Jabalpur and Madras respectively. During this time his health deteriorated so much that a medical committee constituted by the Government of India recommended that he be sent to a suitable climatic place. In October 1932, he was sent to Bhuwali Sanitarium in Uttar Pradesh but there was no improvement in his health. He was released from jail on 12 February 1933 on the condition that he would go to Europe for treatment at his own expense. Dr. Shelan Sen was sent along to take care of his health, but two prominent doctors of Bombay, G. B. Deshmukh and B. B. Sathe was not allowed to examine his health. In 1934, Subhash's book 'The Indian Struggle 1920-34' was published. Subhash was under house arrest during the 1937 elections. He was released on 17 March 1937 after being exiled and kept under house arrest for more than five years. He was

elected unopposed to preside over the 1938 Haripura (Gujarat) Congress session. He defeated Pattabhi Sitaramaiya in the election of the President of the Tripuri session to be held next year, but after the internal fight of the Congress, he resigned from the post of the President after the Tripuri session. Expressing satisfaction over this resignation, Rabindranath Tagore called Subhash Babu 'Desh Nayak'. On 3 May 1940, Subhash Babu established the Forward Bloc within the Congress, to which Shilbhadra Baji of Bihar was also among the prominent people to join. On 22-23 June 1939, the first All India Conference of the Forward Bloc was held at Kewasji Jehangir Hall, Bombay. In this session, unity was established among all the leftist parties with the aim of Subhash's nationalization, a 'Left Solidarity Committee' was formed in which representatives of Samajwadi Dal, National Tape Radical People and Forward Bloc were made members. Most of the members of the Congress Samajwadi Party supported the Forward Bloc, but Jayaprakash Narayan criticized it and preferred to maintain unity. MN Roy, a prominent member of the Radical League, also opposed the formation of the Left Solidarity Committee. Thus the Forward Bloc became another nexus of the already divided Left. On the other hand, in the All India Congress Committee, Patel proposed that no member of the Congress could participate in the Civil Disobedience Movement without the prior permission of the State Congress Committees. In protest against this, the Forward Bloc under the leadership of Subhash Babu celebrated All India Protest Day on 9th July. The All India Congress Committee immediately removed Subhash Babu from the post of President of the Bengal Pradesh Congress Committee and declared him ineligible to be elected to any party post for the next 3 years. An ad-hoc committee was formed to run the Bengal Congress in which Gandhians like Azad and P.C. Chap and B.K. Dhankubers like C. Rai and Krishnashankar Rai were included. Later (January 1940) C.F. In a letter written to Antril, Gandhi used the address 'my son' for Subhash and said that it was necessary to teach a lesson to 'a spoiled 'good' of the family for his neck. Due to this entire controversy, its effect on the popularity of the Congress can be seen in the form of its membership which decreased from 4.5 million in 1940-41 to just 1.4 million as compared to 1938-39. Subhash decided to start civil disobedience movement from July 3, 1940 to remove Hallwell memorial of Calcutta by contacting Muslim League.

Regarding this memorial built in memory of the 'Blackhole' tragedy, most of the people believed that this type of incident never happened and was imagined by the British only to tarnish the name of Siraj-ud-daulah. Subhash wanted to use this incident involving the last independent Muslim ruler of Bengal, Siraj-ud-Daula, as a form of Hindu-Muslim unity against the British. Subhash was arrested on July 2, 1940, under Section 129 of the Defense of India Act, even before starting this movement. In August 1940, the Government of Bengal decided to remove the Hallwell Memorial. Subhash Babu was kept in the Presidency Jail in Calcutta. On November 26, he wrote in a letter to the Governor of Bengal and his ministers that 'a man must die so that the nation may live. Today I must die (so that India can achieve freedom and glory). He started a hunger strike from 29 November. In view of his rapidly deteriorating health, he was released on 5 December 1940 and placed under house arrest at Elgin Road, Calcutta. In the midnight of 16-17 January, Subhash escaped from house arrest disguised as a Maulvi, in order to escape from the spies, Subhash Babu along with his nephew Sisir Bose reached Gogoh-Railway Station (about two hundred miles from Calcutta) by car and there Took a train to Delhi. Subhash arrived in Peshawar in Delhi as 'Mohammad

Ziauddin', a traveling inspector of the Empire of India Life Assurance Co. Ltd. He was received in Peshawar by Bhagatram Talwar (pseudonym Rehmat Khan). From there he was entertained by Uttamchand. Arrived in Kabul and disguised himself as a 'deaf-mute pilgrim'. From here the Italian embassy sent him to Germany via Moscow with a fake passport named 'Orlando Mazzotta', where he was welcomed by Ribentrop. The Subhash Chandra Bose Farari reminded of Chhatrapati Shivaji's escape from the captivity of Emperor Aurangzeb. In Germany, Subhash was given the title of 'Netaji' on the lines of fascist leaders, which was the Hindi meaning of Hitler's 'Der Führer', Mussolini's 'Il Duce' and the Frankos' 'El Caidillo'. The slogan of 'Jayhind' was started from here also. (who along with Iqbal Shaidai founded the Azad Hind government in Rome in 1941 and Radio Tare also originated from here. Sardar Bhagat Singh's uncle Ajotsingh Himalaya, a radio station to aid Subhash Babu's efforts moved) to Germany, who was then teaching language at the University of Naples (Italy). In Germany, Subhash Babu made three proposals and asked them- Should be given a chance to do anti-British propaganda through German radio, should be allowed to build 'Azad Hind Fauj' from Indian prisoners of war in Germany and Germany make a joint declaration of Indian independence with your allies Japan and Italy. The first two of these offers were accepted. Bose established the 'Independent India Center' whose prominent members included A.C.N Nambiar, Girja Mukherjee and M.R. Vyas was involved. Vyas hosted daily broadcasts in Azad Hind Radio broadcast in seven languages Persian, English, Bengali, Hindustani, Telugu, Tamil and Pashto used to have. Bose established the 'Indian Legion' of four thousand soldiers in Berlin on 25 December 1941. The responsibility of training was handed over to Adalbert Syafridge from Germany. Bose met Hitler with von Traut as interpreter on 29 May 1942. Unfortunately Hitler could neither speak English and could not understand. Due to this the meeting was unsuccessful. When Germany decided to use them against Russia, he decided to leave Germany and go to South-East Asia. Leaving behind his wife Amelie Shankle and two-month-old daughter Anita, Bose boarded a German submarine (U-180) on 9 February 1943 with Abid Hasan to reach Japan. On 28 April he was transferred to a Japanese submarine I-29. The code name of this submarine was 'Matsu' and Bose was named 'Matsuda'. He was Finally reached Tokyo on 16 May after a dangerous journey of about 25,000 kilometers for three months. Japanese-controlled Singapore arrived on 2 July 1943. On July 4, Subhash Chandra Bose became the President of the 'Indian Independence League' after Rasbihari Bose handed over the reins of East Asia. On his arrival in Tokyo from Singapore, the Japanese Prime Minister announced that Japan did not want to occupy India. After reaching Singapore in Japan, Bose gave the slogan 'Delhi Chalo' and established the Azad Hind Government on 21 October 1943. He kept the posts of President, Prime Minister and Commander-in-Chief with himself and the charge of finance, propaganda and women's organization was given to AC Chatterjee, S. A. Iyer and Dr. Lakshmi Swaminathan. Bose took the oath in Cathay Hall that 'in the name of God, I take a holy oath that I will free India and 38 crore people of my country'. After this, his speech got blocked due to emotions and tears started flowing down his cheeks. The whole hall was stunned and most of the people could not hold back their tears. Netaji took care of himself and after this, falling forward said 'I Subhash Chandra Bose will continue the holy war of freedom till the last moment of my life. I will always be a servant of India and consider the welfare of 38 crore brothers and sisters as my highest duty. Even after attaining independence, I will always be ready to shed

the last drop of my blood to protect India's independence.' Other members of the cabinet took oath after him. The Azad Hind Fauj adopted the tricolor flag of the National Congress, with the only difference being that instead of the charkha in the middle of the Congress tricolor flag, the flag of the army had a 'leaping lion' which was the symbol of India's freedom struggle.

Azad Hind Fauj's slogan 'Delhi Chalo', salutation 'Jai Hind' and national anthem 'Shubh Sukh Chain Barkha Barse' (Hindustani adaptation of Rabindranath Tagore's hymn 'Bharat Bhagya Vidhata') were adopted. Their motto was 'freedom or death'. This Azad Hind government, which declared war with Britain and America, was first recognized by Japan on 23 October, following which eight other countries followed: Verma (24 October), Croatia (27 October), Germany (29 October), Nanking (1 November), Manchaco (1 November), Italy (9 November), Thailand (19 November) and the Philippines gave recognition. The President of the Free State of Ireland, Dr. Belera also personally greeted Netaji. Subhash reorganized the Azad Hind Fauj with headquarters in Rangoon and Singapore. The Shere Dil guerrilla group was divided into three regiments named after Gandhi, Azad and Nehru. Later, under the leadership of Shahnawaz Khan, a fourth regiment was formed in the name of 'Subhash'. Under the leadership of Captain Lakshmi Swaminathan, a women's military force named Rani Jhansi Regiment was formed. Subhash Chandra Bose's contribution to the national movement On 6 November 1943, Japanese Prime Minister Tojo announced the handing over of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands won by the British to the Azad Hind Fauj, after which these islands were renamed 'Shaheed' and 'Swaraj' respectively.

Given. Lieutenant Colonel A.D. Loganathan was appointed as the administrator of these places. The Provisional Government also had a small territory called Jiyawadi whose area was about 50 square miles. In 1944, when the Azad Hind Fauj along with the Japanese army attacked Assam, then two places named Manipur and Vishnupur also came under its authority.

The campaign of Azad Hind Fauj's invasion of India was named 'Operation U-Go'. On 4 February 1944, the Subhash Brigade advanced from Rangoon to the Arakan hills, where it inflicted a crushing defeat on the British contingent on the Arakan front. On 18 March 1944, the Azad Hind Fauj entered the Indian border for the first time. Colonel S. A. Under the leadership of Malik, a contingent of this army went deep inside the Indian territory and on 14 April he hoisted the national tricolor at a place called Morang in the state of Manipur. A. C. Chatterjee was appointed as the first governor of the liberated areas. On the other hand, on 7 April 1944, Azad Hind Fauj surrounded Imphal.

It seemed that Imphal would fall in three weeks, but in the meantime, due to heavy rains, Azad Hind Fauj lost contact with the Japanese army. In May, the Azad Hind Fauj set foot on Indian soil at Mathdok (an outpost located south-west of Chittagong in Bangladesh) near Cox's Bazar, but due to lack of necessary equipment in the weakened conditions of the Axis countries in World War, it was retreated. Had to move A detachment left under the leadership of Surajmal unsuccessfully tried to protect this place for some time. Thus the Azad Hind Fauj remained active during March-June 1944 on Indian soil. It is surprising that the Bengalis who were considered by the British to be the 'least fighting among the Indian castes'. This armed struggle was carried out under the leadership of the same Bengali (Subhash Babu). On July 6, 1944, Bose used the address 'Father of the Nation' for Gandhi for the first time on Azad Hind

Radio and said - 'India's last war of independence has begun. Father of the Nation! We seek your blessings and best wishes in this holy war of liberation of India. A battalion of the Azad Hind Fauj led by Shahnawaz was sent to attack Imphal along the Bharat Verma border with Japanese forces, where their morale was broken due to the ill-treatment meted out to them by the Japanese. They were not only denied supplies and weapons, but were forced to do menial jobs for Japanese soldiers. After the failure of the Imphal attack, the Japanese forces began to retreat, after which the hopes of India's independence by the Azad Hind Fauj ended forever. Netaji's India campaign started at a time when the chances of the Axis Powers winning the war had almost waned. Even before he left Germany for Japan, the defeat of fascists had started in Stalingrad. It is said that Netaji have died in a plane crash on 18 August 1945 at Taihoku Airport in Japan, a few days after Japan's surrender.

Habibur Rahman was with him at the time of this accident. The incident of Netaji's death became quite controversial, with many famous people claiming to have seen him or to have been at some place in the world after 18 August 1945. It was believed that the news of his death was fabricated to save him from the hands of the victorious Allies. In these circumstances, a three-member committee was formed by Nehru in April 1956, in which Major General Shahnawaz Khan, Subhash Chandra Bose's elder Suresh Chandra Bose and I.C.S. Officer S. N. Mayatra was included. The task of this committee was to find out the circumstances under which Netaji left Bangkok on 16 August and his alleged death in the air crash. Confirming Netaji's death in the plane crash, two members of the committee in their report said that the mortal remains kept in Takis's Renkoji temple were his. Suresh Chandra Bose disagreed with the opinion of both his colleagues and said that 'the decision taken by them is not certified'. During the time of Indira Gandhi, the former Justice of the Punjab High Court, G. D. Khosla, referred to the establishment of one membership Commission, Who was to investigate Netaji's disappearance in 1945. Conclusion In 1992, it was announced to posthumously award 'Bharat Ratna' to Netaji, but a complaint was presented against it in the Supreme Court. In May 1998 the United Nations and in February 1999 England informed India that Netaji would no longer be considered a war criminal.

The Government of India could not present any proof of Netaji's death, due to which the court ordered to withdraw this title given in the posthumous category. In April 1999, the Atal Bihari Vajpayee government once again constituted a one-man commission headed by Manoj Kumar Mukherjee to investigate Netaji's death. Netaji's call 'You give me blood, I will give you freedom' is still an inspiration for all Indians. Gandhi called Subhash a 'compelling personality', 'patriot of the patriots' (head of the patriots) and Sarojini Naidu called him 'the flaming sword of Indian patriotism'. Thus we can say that Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose was a great patriot. He has bore many difficulties and gave a great contribution in freedom struggle of India.